The Household Diary Study

Mail Use & Attitudes in FY 2017



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Executive Summary

This report documents the findings of the United States Postal Service's Household Diary Study (HDS) for Fiscal Year (FY) 2017. The three main study purposes are to:

- Measure the mail sent and received by U.S. households,
- Provide a means to track household mail trends over time, and
- Make comparisons of mail use between different types of households.

The report examines these trends in the context of changes and developments in the wider markets for communications and package delivery.

Background

The Household Diary Study survey, fielded continuously since 1987, aims to collect information on household use of the mail and how that use changes over time. The survey collects household information on demographics, lifestyle, attitudes toward mail and advertising, bill payment behavior, and use of the Internet and other information technologies.

The FY 2017 report covers Government Fiscal Year 2017, with comparisons to 2015, 2016, and other years, as appropriate.

In FY 2017 mail sent or received by households represented 83 percent of all U.S. mail.

Overview

In 2017, U.S. households received 118.4 billion pieces of mail, and sent 8.5 billion, as seen in Table E.1. Mail sent or received by households constituted 83 percent of total mail in FY 2017. Fifty-eight percent of the mail households received was sent via Marketing Mail. Only 2 percent of household mail was sent between households; the rest was sent between households and non-households.

Table E.1:
Mail Received and Sent by Households
(Millions of Pieces)

Mail Classification	Received	Sent
First-Class Mail	39.8	8.1
Marketing Mail-Regular	57.2	—
Marketing Mail Nonprofit	11.6	—
Periodicals	4.9	—
Package & Shipping Services	4.8	0.4
Total	**118.4**	**8.5**
Household to Household	2.6	
Total Mail Received and Sent by Households *	124.3	
FY 2017 RPW Total	149.5	
Non-household to Non-household	25.2	
Unaddressed	1.0	—

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.
* Total (124.3) is less than received (118.4) plus sent (8.5) because household to household mail (2.6) is included in both categories.

Mail Markets

The Household Diary Study examines mail by the markets it serves. This design cuts across classes, but provides a foundation for understanding mail flows and the marketplace changes that affect them. Table E.2 shows the volume of household mail by market for 2015 through 2017.

Thirty one percent of household mail contains correspondence or transactions, a declining share over the last ten years, compared to thirty-five percent in 2007. Correspondence mail volume fell 1.8 percent from 2016 and was relatively flat compared to 2015. However, compared to the prior ten years, correspondence volume experienced a significant runoff as it fell 23 percent from 2007. In part, the decline in correspondence is a continuation of long-term trends but it is also strongly related to changing demographics and new technologies. Younger households traditionally send and receive fewer pieces of correspondence mail; they also tend to be early adopters of new and faster communication

technologies, such as those that grew out of the Internet age, like email and social media.

Table E.2:
Household Mail Volume Received and Sent by Market Served
(Billions of Pieces)

Market	2015	2016	2017
Correspondence	16.3	16.4	16.1
Transactions	25.7	24.5	23.0
Advertising	79.7	79.8	76.7
Periodicals	5.1	5.1	4.9
Packages	4.3	4.9	5.2
Unclassified	2.0	2.7	2.4
Total	**128.4**	**129.0**	**124.3**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2015, 2016, and 2017.
Notes:

1. Correspondence and packages exclude double-counted pieces reported as both sent and received by households.

2. Advertising includes 4.1 billion pieces of First-Class advertising-enclosed mail but excluded from total.

3. Package volumes include 0.4 billion pieces of CD/DVD rental reported in First-Class Mail letters in Tables E.1, 1.5, and 1.6.

In 2017, only about one quarter of household payments were made by mail.

As with correspondence, transaction mail was also impacted by electronic alternatives made possible by the Internet. Over the past ten years, online bill payments and automatic deductions have grown very quickly to account for the majority of household payments. As Table E.3 illustrates, the share of bills paid electronically increased from 35 percent in 2007 to 66 in 2017. Conversely, the share of bills paid by mail fell from 60 percent in 2007 to 30 percent in 2017. The share of payments made in-person also declined, falling from 5 percent in 2007 to 4 percent in 2017.

Table E.3:
Bill Payment Methods

Shares	2007	2017
By Mail	60%	30%
Electronically	35%	66%
In Person	5%	4%
Total Bills Paid	**100%**	**100%**

The Internet also contributed to a decline in the number of bills households received through the mail. Unlike bill payments, however, migration of bills to the Internet has proceeded at a relatively slow pace. Over the last ten years (2007 to 2017), the share of bills received online increased gradually, from 5 percent to 22 percent, so far leaving the majority of bills in the mail-stream.

In 2017, advertising mail (also referred to as Marketing Mail) represented 62 percent of all mail sent and received by households. As Table E.4 shows, 90 percent of all advertising mail received by households consisted of Marketing Mail (68.8 billion pieces). The remainder consisted of First-Class Mail, either stand-alone advertising (3.7 billion pieces), or advertising-enclosed pieces that are sent along with other matter (4.1 billion pieces). The volume of stand-alone advertising has declined almost 60% over the past decade. As a share of total advertising, stand-alone First-Class Mail advertising fell from 9% percent in 2007 to 5 percent in 2017.

Table E.4:
Advertising by Mail Class

Mail Classification	Volume *(Billions)*	Percent of Total Advertising
First-Class Advertising	7.8	10%
Marketing Mail-Commercial	57.2	75%
Marketing Mail Nonprofit	11.6	15%
Total Advertising Mail	**76.6**	**100%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Note: First-Class Advertising includes 4.1 billion pieces of advertising-enclosed pieces.

As Table E.2 above shows, households received 4.9 billion Periodicals by mail in 2017, down from 5.1 billion pieces in 2016. According to Table E.5, magazines made up 73 percent of Periodicals. Newspapers represented 19 percent of total Periodicals, a steep decline from 35 percent in 1987. Over the past decade, readership and circulation levels for all types of periodicals declined as the Internet quickly turned into an inexpensive, and often free, source of news and information.

Table E.5:
Periodical Type Received

Mail Classification	Volume *(Billions)*	Percent of Total Periodicals
Newspapers	0.9	19%
Magazines	3.6	73%
Unclassified	0.4	8%
Total Periodicals	**4.9**	**100%**

Source: Household Diary Study, FY 2017.

In 2016, households received 3.7 billion packages and sent 0.6 billion (see Table E.6). Compared to 2016 and 2015, total packages sent and received increased about 6 percent and 21 percent respectively (see Table E.2), a growth, driven by rapidly rising eCommerce and online-shopping activity**.**

Table E.6
Packages Received and Sent via the U.S. Postal Service
(Millions of Pieces)

Mail Classification	2017			
	Received		Sent	
	Number	Percent	Number	Percent
First-Class Mail	1,132	24%	209	50%
Expedited	640	14%	143	34%
Ground Parcels and Package	2,888	62%	66	16%
Total Packages	4,660	100%	418	100%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.
Notes:
Totals may not sum due to rounding.
Expedited includes Priority Mail and Express Mail.

Chapter 1: Introduction – Volumes & Trends

The United States Postal Service Household Diary Study (HDS) Report documents the findings of the Fiscal Year (FY) 2017 study. The HDS measures the mail sent and received by U.S. households, tracks household mail trends, and compares mail use between different types of households.

> The Household Diary Study provides a means to track household mail trends over time.

The Survey

The Household Diary Study survey, fielded continuously since 1987, aims to collect information on household use of the mail and how that use changes over time. The survey collects household information on:

- Volumes of mail sent and received,
- Demographics,
- Attitudes toward mail and advertising,
- Bill payment behavior, and
- Use of the Internet and other information technologies.

These data are used for market research, forecasting, and strategic planning within the Postal Service.

The Survey Consists of Two Parts:

1) An **entry, or recruitment interview**, conducted by phone or Web, collects demographic and attitudinal information from about 8,500 households.

2) These households then receive a **mail diary**, which collects information on the mail the household sends and receives in a one-week period. Annually, about 5,200 households complete the diary.

The data generated by these two instruments are the basis of the analysis in this report.

The FY 2017 HDS report covers the period from October 2016 through September 2017, roughly equivalent to the Government Fiscal Year (GFY) used by the Postal Service. Data from FY 2015 and FY 2016 are also reported on a GFY basis.

U.S. Postal Service Volumes

Serving a nation containing five percent of the world's population, the Postal Service delivers roughly 45 percent of the world's mail, according to the Universal Postal Union. The Postal Service delivered 148.5 billion pieces of mail in FY 2017—a decrease of 4.8 billion pieces, or 3.2 percent, from 2016.

In 2017, mail volumes continued to be negatively impacted by the migration of transaction, correspondence, and advertising mail to the Internet and other electronic alternatives. On the positive side, the Postal Service experienced a surge in Package volume in response to the growing eCommerce side of the economy.

Marketing Mail volume, consisting mostly of advertising material, decreased 3.2 percent (about 2.6 billion pieces) from 2016 to 2017, driven in part by growing competition from online advertising.

In 2017, First-Class Mail volume fell 4.1 percent (about 2.5 billion pieces), continuing a declining trend that began in the early 2000's, and was mostly driven by the migration of correspondence and transaction mail to electronic substitutes.. First-Class Single-Piece letters and cards were severely impacted by the rapid transition by mail users to online bill payments and emails and volume fell about 6% percent just in 2017. Presort letters and cards (which also include most of the advertising material that is sent First-Class) fell 3 percent, a decline that was also driven in large part by electronic diversion.

The Postal Service estimates the revenues, volumes, and weight of mail pieces going through the postal network by using a combination of statistical sampling systems, mailing statements, and accounting data. These data are published in the Revenue, Pieces, and Weight (RPW) Reports. Table 1.1 presents the RPW volumes for FY 2017, along with data for FY 2015 and FY 2016.

Letters, flats, and parcels are defined as follows:

- L**etters** refer to pieces that are less than 11.5 inches wide by 6.125 inches tall and less than .25 inches thick.
- **Flats** consist of pieces that are greater than 11.5 inches wide, 6.125 inches tall, or .25 inches thick, but less than 12 by 15 by .75 inches.

- **Parcels** are pieces that are larger than 12 by 15 inches, or thicker than .75 inches.

Because of the difficulty involved in recording mail-piece characteristics in the Household Diary, these categories do not correspond precisely to the shape categories used by HDS respondents.

Table 1.1:
Total Mail Volume: FY 2015, 2016, and 2017
(Billions of Pieces)

	2015	2016	2017
Mailing Services:			
First-Class Mail:			
Single-Piece	20.7	19.7	18.5
Presort	40.2	39.9	38.8
Other	1.7	1.6	1.4
Total First-Class Mail	**62.6**	**61.2**	**58.7**
Marketing Mail:			
Regular	54.0	56.2	52.9
ECR	26.0	24.7	25.5
Total Marketing Mail	**80.0**	**80.9**	**78.3**
Periodicals	**5.8**	**5.6**	**5.3**
USPS and Free Mail	**0.4**	**0.5**	**0.4**
Total Mailing Services	**148.9**	**148.2**	**142.7**
Shipping Services	**4.5**	**5.2**	**5.7**
Total All Mail	**153.4**	**153.3**	**148.5**

Source: RPW Reports.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Mail Flows

Mail volume can be broken into four basic flows, based on origin and destination. These flows are:

1) Household to household,
2) Household to non-household,
3) Non-household to household, and
4) Non-household to non-household, which is calculated as the residual of total RPW mail volume and mail volume involving households based on HDS data.

Tables 1.2 and 1.3 show the total mail in each flow, and Table 1.4 shows pieces per household per week.

Table 1.2:
Total Domestic Mail Flows
(Billions of Pieces)

Sent By:	Received By:		
	Household	**Non-household**	**Total Originating**
Household	2.6	5.9	8.5
Non-household	115.8	25.2	141.0
Total Destinating	**118.4**	**31.0**	**149.5**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Table 1.3:
Total Domestic Mail Flows

Mail Flows	Billions of Pieces	Percent of Total Mail
Sent by Household	8.5	7%
Received by Household	118.4	79%
Total Household Mail*	**124.3**	**83%**
Non-Household to Non-Household	25.2	17%
Total Mail	149.5	100%

***Excludes 2.6 billion pieces sent from household to household**

Table 1.4:
Domestic Mail Flows per Household per Week

Sent By:	Received By:	
	Household	Non-household
Household	0.4	0.9
Non-household	17.6	N/A

Source: Household Diary Study, FY 2017.

Household Mail

As Table 1.3 shows, domestic mail to and from households represented 83 percent of total mail volume in 2017, equating to 18.9 pieces per week sent and received by U.S. households. Table 1.5 presents the volumes of mail sent and received by households as estimated from the HDS, in the categories households used to record their mail. Households received 118.4 billion pieces of mail and sent 8.5 billion. Both of these totals include the 2.6 billion pieces of mail that households sent to each other. The total mail received or sent by households in FY 2017 was 124.3 billion pieces.

Table 1.6 presents these data in two other forms, annual volumes per household and pieces per household per week. Many of the subsequent results in this report are presented in terms of pieces per household per week.

Table 1.5:
Mail Received and Sent by Households
(Billions of Pieces)

Mail Classification	Received	Sent
First-Class Mail	39.8	8.1
Marketing Mail Regular	57.2	—
Marketing Mail Nonprofit	11.6	—
Periodicals	4.9	—
Packages & Shipping Services	4.8	0.4
Total	**118.4**	**8.5**
Household to Household	2.6	
Total Mail Received and Sent by Households	124.3	
FY 2017 RPW Total	149.5	
Non-household to Non-household (Residual)	25.2	
Unaddressed	1.0	—

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Table 1.6:
Pieces Received and Sent per Household

Classification	Annual Pieces per Household	Pieces per Household per Week
Mail Received		
First-Class Mail	316	6.1
Marketing Mail Regular	454	8.7
Marketing Mail Nonprofit	92	1.8
Periodicals	39	0.7
Packages & Shipping Services	38	0.7
Total Mail Received	**940**	**18.1**
Mail Sent		
First-Class Mail:	64	1.2
Packages & Shipping Services	4	0.1
Total Mail Sent	**68**	**1.3**
Unaddressed	8	0.2

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Classes and Markets

- **First-Class Mail** is used to send transactional mail, correspondence, and advertising. Because it is limited to pieces weighing thirteen ounces or less, it primarily includes letters and cards.
- **Marketing Mail** is advertising mail. For the most part, Marketing Mail comprises letters and flats, although it contains a few postcards and packages as well.
- **Periodicals** are magazines and newspapers, and are predominantly flat-shaped.
- **Package and Shipping Services** is used to deliver merchandise, books, catalogs, and media. Most of this mail is parcel-shaped.

Table 1.7 crosswalks between classes of mail and the markets they serve.

Table 1.7:
Mail Received and Sent by Households

Class	Market (Billions of Pieces)						
	Correspondence	Transactions	Advertising	Periodicals	Packages	Unclassified	Total
First-Class Mail	16.1	23.0	7.8	-	0.4-	2.1	45.3
Marketing Mail	-	-	68.9	-	-	-	68.9
Periodicals	-	-	-	4.9	-	-	4.9
Packages & Shipping Services	-	-	-	-	5.3	0.3	5.2
Total Mail Received and Sent by Households	16.1	23.0	76.7	4.9	5.2	2.4	124.2

Source: Household Diary Study, FY 2017

1. Correspondence and Packages exclude double-counted pieces reported as both sent and received by households.

2. Advertising includes 4.1 billion pieces of First-Class advertising-enclosed mail but excluded from total

3. First-Class Packages include 0.4 billion pieces of CD/DVD rentals sent to and received from Netflix and other vendors, reported in First-Class Mail letters in Tables E.1, 1.5, and 1.6.

Report Organization

The rest of the Household Diary Study report is organized around the markets the mail serves. Each chapter contains an analysis of the trends in the HDS data, as well as a discussion of how those trends affect and are affected by changes in the broader market. The following provides an overview of each chapter.

Chapter 2: Profile of Mail Usage gives an analysis of household demographics. This chapter examines demographic trends over time and their impact on the mail, and discusses attributing factors, such as access to technology and changing attitudes.

Chapter 3: Correspondence examines mail that is used solely or primarily to deliver (non-sales-related) communications, such as letters and greeting cards. This chapter includes analysis of both personal and business correspondence.

Chapter 4: Transactions reviews financial transactions in the mail and the impact of new technologies on that market. It analyzes household bill payment trends with a focus on technological and demographic change.

Chapter 5: Advertising Mail presents the trends in mail used to deliver sales-related messages. It contains information on household attitudes towards advertising by various media, treatment of advertising mail, and demographic determinants of advertising mail receipt.

Chapter 6: Periodicals examines magazines and newspapers delivered in the mail. It looks at how changing demographics are affecting the market for periodicals, and what the implications are for future volume.

Chapter 7: Packages analyzes household use of various types of packages, and it discusses the household market for merchandise delivery.

In addition, there are three appendices to the report:

Appendix A contains a set of trend tables for major classes and types of mail

Appendix B documents the study methodology and discusses how the data were collected, weighted, and adjusted, and compares demographic data in the sample to that of the population as a whole.

Appendix C contains the instruments used to administer the survey.

Chapter 2: Profile of Mail Usage

Introduction

This chapter provides information on demographic trends and other factors affecting mail volume, thus providing a basis for assessing mail volume changes. The breakouts introduced provide the framework for much of the analyses in subsequent chapters.

The first section looks at growth in mail volume, population, households, and delivery points over recent decades. The next section examines the demographic characteristics of mail users, contrasting higher-mail-volume households with lower-volume households. The third section details the emerging demographic and technological trends that will affect the future of mail. The last section examines some of the factors affecting the use of post offices and mailboxes.

Mail Volume and Demographics

Total U.S. mail volume grew from 110 billion pieces in 1981 to 149.5 billion in 2017, an increase of 36 percent. This growth outpaced the rate of population growth and was close to household formation. Over the same period, according to the U.S. Census Bureau, the adult population grew 41 percent and households grew about 53 percent. The number of places to which the Postal Service delivers increased even faster, growing 61 percent since 1981 (see the USPS annual reports). As Table 2.1 shows, however, volume decreased by an average of 2.0 percent per year since 2001while U.S. population growth, household formation, and delivery points increased by about one percent per year. With falling revenues and rising costs, the Postal Service suffered significant financial losses over the last several years.

Total U.S. mail volume decreased by an average of 2.0 % per year between 2001 and 2017 while population and household formation increased by about 1.0% per year.

As shown in Table 2.1, the 1980s was a time of extraordinary mail volume growth (4.6%) that began in 1978 and continued through 1988. In 1984, mail volume grew more than ten percent. During this period, technology facilitated this growth. Construction of computerized databases and techniques for sorting large amounts of data created a fertile climate for direct mail marketing. Computerization of financial systems encouraged billing by mail and payments through the mail. These innovations in business processes were further encouraged by the expansion of postal rate discounts.

The Postal Service introduced work-sharing discounts, encouraging mailers to prepare the mail in ways that reduce the total system cost of creating and delivering the mail. Mailers could take advantage of these discounts by sorting the mail in advance. The Postal Service would receive the mail presorted to the individual ZIP codes and/or to the carrier routes associated with those ZIP codes.

In the late 1980s and early 1990s, mail volume growth barely kept pace with household growth. The demand for mail was hurt by a recession and two very large rate increases. This was also a period in which the Postal Service absorbed substantial costs that were reapportioned from the Federal government's retirement programs.

Table 2.1:
Mail Volume and Demographics
Average Annual Growth, 1981-2017

	1981-1990	1991-2000	2001-2017
Total Mail Volume	4.6%	2.3%	-2.0%
Delivery Points	1.7%	1.5%	0.8%
Adult Population	1.5%	1.3%	1.1%
Households	1.4%	0.9%	1.1%

Source: U.S. Postal Service, U.S. Census Bureau.

The latter half of the 1990s saw rapid growth in mail volume, spurred by a strong economy and rates that increased by less than inflation. The Postal Service also realigned the incentives built into its price structure. It reduced the incentives mailers had for presorting mail and encouraged them to prebarcode their mail. By 2002, the majority of letters the Postal Service received had qualifying barcodes on them.

This restructuring of the rates took advantage of the extensive automation of mail preparation and sorting that occurred in the previous decade.

During the 1990s, the U.S. economy rapidly embraced information technology and integrated the Internet into its business processes. An economic recession followed that began in March 2001. The 2001 terrorist attacks on the World Trade Center and the Pentagon led to large-scale disruptions of those mail services dependent on air transport, such as First-Class, Priority, and Express Mail. When air service was restored, Priority Mail was no longer allowed on commercial passenger flights. Soon afterwards, lethal anthrax was sent through the mail, which resulted in five deaths and a number of serious injuries. These terrorist attacks, combined with the economic recession, caused mail volume to decline 2.2 percent in 2002, which was, at the time, the largest annual decline since World War II. In 2003, Marketing Mail volume recovered to a new high, but total First-Class volume continued to decline. Work-shared First-Class Mail fell for the first time ever. Since 2003, Marketing Mail volume grew along with the economy, reaching new highs and exceeding First-Class Mail for the first time in 2005. Total First-Class volume, on the other hand, continued to decline, in part due to the diversion of payments, bills, and statements to electronic alternatives and the lower-cost Marketing Mail option as an alternative to First-Class advertising.

The economic recession that began in December 2007 and ended in June 2009 had a severe impact on the mail. Total mail volume plunged 12.8 percent in 2009—the largest decline since the Great Depression. In July 2009, the recession was officially over but was followed by a slow recovery that continued into 2017. As a result, total mail volume declined an additional 15 percent between 2009 and 2017. Both Marketing Mail and First-Class Mail contributed to the overall decline in mail volume, falling 5 and 29 percent respectively.

Between 2001 and 2017, total mail volume fell 28 percent. During the same time period, both the adult population and households increased 20 percent, and the Postal Service added 10 percent more delivery points to its network.

Continued growth in delivery points has become an ongoing source of pressure on postal costs.

The Postal Service depends on mail volume growth to fund universal service. The number of addresses the delivery network serves increases as the number of American businesses and households increases. When mail volume falls, as was the case between 2001 and 2017 the Postal Service's ability to fund delivery service is hampered because the Postal Service charges its customers for piece volume but does not assess connect charges, access fees, or system fees, like many other network enterprises. These costs must therefore be covered by a lower level of volume.

Characteristics of Higher- and Lower-Volume Households

Tables 2.2 and 2.3 show the demographic characteristics of households according to the amount of mail received. It is apparent that household mail use is strongly correlated with both income and education. For example, households receiving 12 or less pieces of mail per week earned an average of only $32,026 annually; in contrast, those receiving 36 to 44 pieces per week earned an average of $90,164 annually. Note, however, the similar correlation between mail receipt and Internet access, which is also related to income and education. Therefore, households that make the most use of the mail are the households with the greatest opportunity to use alternatives to the mail.

Table 2.2:
Characteristics of Higher- and Lower-Mail-Volume Households

Mail Received *(Pieces per Household per week)*	Households *(Millions)*	Median Annual Household Income	Households w/ Internet Access *(Percent)*	Total Bills Paid *(Pieces per Household per week)*	Bills Paid by Internet *(Pieces per Household per week)*	Mail Sent *(Pieces per Household per week)*
45 or more	4.1	$97,120	92%	3.2	1.2	3.8
36-44	6.4	$90,164	93%	3.3	1.3	2.7
30-35	8.8	$90,990	94%	3.1	1.2	2.4
24-29	15.0	$78,685	91%	2.7	1.2	1.7
18-23	22.6	$72,798	90%	2.6	1.1	1.2
12-17	28.2	$58,243	91%	2.4	1.1	1.0
Less than 12	41.1	$32,026	85%	1.9	0.8	0.7
Total	**126.2**	**$59,798**	**89%**	**2.4**	**1.0**	**1.3**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.
Note: Mail received includes USPS and Non-USPS mail.

Table 2.3:
Education of Higher- and Lower-Mail-Volume Households

Mail Received *(Pieces per Household per week)*	Households *(Millions)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household			
		Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate
45 or more	4.1	4%	17%	18%	60%
36-44	6.4	5%	23%	20%	52%
30-35	8.8	5%	22%	21%	52%
24-29	15.0	4%	30%	21%	44%
18-23	22.6	10%	28%	19%	42%
12-17	28.2	10%	26%	25%	38%
Less than 12	41.1	10%	29%	24%	36%
Total	**126.2**	**8%**	**27%**	**22%**	**41%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.
Note: Percentages may not total 100 percent due to heads of households who did not answer the educational attainment question.
Percentages in this table are row percentages.
Excludes households not receiving any mail delivery at their home address (using mailbox only).

Demographic Characteristics of U.S. Households

This section presents breakouts of households by demographic categories that influence the volume of mail sent and received. It looks at both traditional and newly emerging factors. The following chapters will show how mail volume varies with these household characteristics.

Income, Education, and Age

Traditionally, mail use was largely determined by household income, education, and age. As Table 2.4 shows, income and education are strongly correlated with each other, as expected.

The relationship between income and age, shown in Table 2.5, is somewhat more complicated. Up to retirement, household income and age are fairly closely related. After retirement, households earn substantially less. However, by that point, mail behavior is pretty well set, and older households continue to receive similar amounts of advertising and periodicals, and pay similar amounts of bills, even though their income declines.

Table 2.4:
Households by Income and Education
(Percent of Households)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household				Total
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	16%	36%	25%	23%	24%
$35 to $65	7%	33%	25%	35%	21%
$65 to $100	7%	25%	21%	46%	19%
Over $100	3%	13%	18%	66%	19%
Don't know/ Refused	8%	26%	21%	41%	17%
Total	**8%**	**27%**	**22%**	**41%**	**100%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Table 2.5:
Households by Income and Age
(Percent of Households)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household				Total
	Under 35	35 to 54	Over 55	Don't Know/ Refused	
Under $35	23%	29%	47%	0%	24%
$35 to $65	25%	29%	46%	0%	21%
$65 to $100	19%	39%	42%	0%	19%
Over $100	16%	47%	37%	0%	19%
Don't know/ Refused	16%	29%	49%	6%	17%
Total	**20%**	**34%**	**44%**	**1%**	**100%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Household Size

The majority of U.S. households include either one or two adults, but households with three or more adults make up 17 percent of the total. Once considered the norm, nuclear families—two adults and at least one child—now account for less than one-quarter of US households. Over the years, the changing composition of households impacted the amount and kinds of mail sent and received by households, generating more and different kinds of advertising mail, as well as affecting transaction mail trends (bills tend to be tied to households as much as to individuals).

Table 2.6:
Households by Number of Adults
(Millions of Households)

Number of Adults	
One	33.4
Two	71.6
Three or more	21.3
Total Households	**126.2**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Table 2.7:
Households by Size
(Millions of Households)

Household Size	
One person	29.6
Two	50.4
Three	19.7
Four	15.4
Five or more	11.0
Total Households	**126.2**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.
Note: Total may not sum due to rounding.

Internet Access

Access to the Internet and use of Broadband have a large and growing impact on mail use. Bills, statements, and bill payments still represent a significant number of pieces sent and received by households. However, electronic activity in this area is diverting mail once used for these purposes. On the other hand, online shopping adds packages and catalog delivery to the Postal Service mail stream.

Table 2.8 shows that 89 percent of households have Internet access (either Broadband or Dial-up) and almost all of those households now have Broadband access. The highest levels of Internet and Broadband access are within households with incomes over $100,000 (each with 98 percent), as seen in Figure 2.1a. In comparison, households with incomes below $35,000 are less likely to have access to the Internet and Broadband (73 and 71 percent, respectively). As shown in Figure 2.1b, age is also an important determinant of households having Internet access. Younger households (heads of households younger than 35 years old) are more likely to have access to both the Internet and Broadband (96 and 95 percent, respectively). Older households (heads of households older than 55 years of age), on the other hand, are less likely to have access to the Internet and Broadband (77 and 75 percent, respectively).

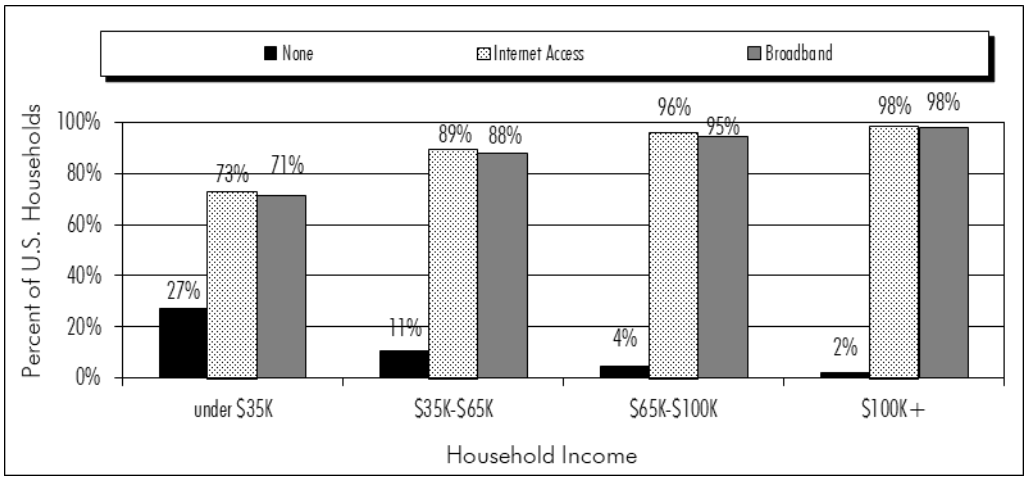
Table 2.8:
Households by Type of Internet Access
(Millions of Households)

Type of Internet Access	
Broadband	110.8
Dial-up	1.7
None	13.7
Total Households	**126.2**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

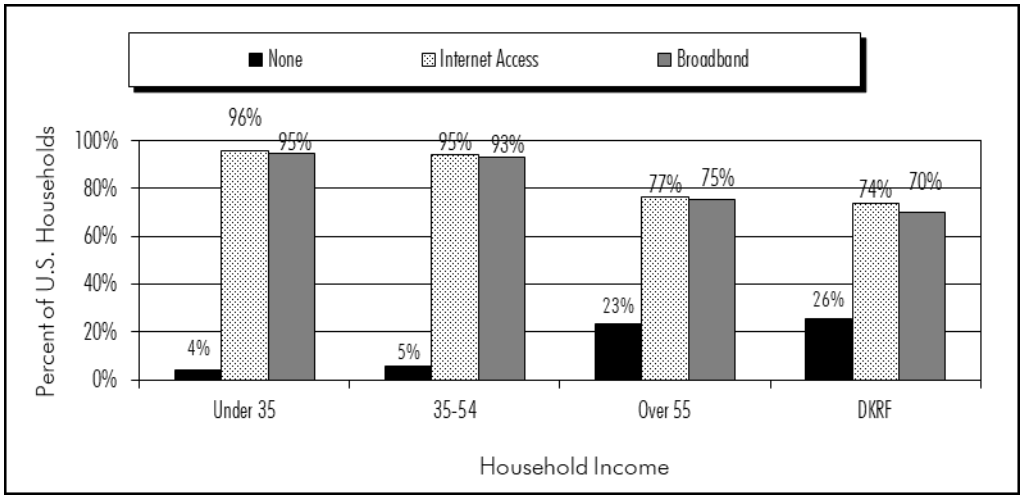
Figure 2.2 shows the trend in Broadband connections. The rapid growth of Broadband has greatly expanded the scope of electronic diversion of the mail. The Internet's fast, always-on connection makes it a stronger alternative medium for the delivery of entertainment, information, and communication. As more households use Broadband, the more that bill payments, bill and statement presentment, periodicals, and even advertising mail, will be affected.

Figure 2.1a:
Internet Access by Income and Type



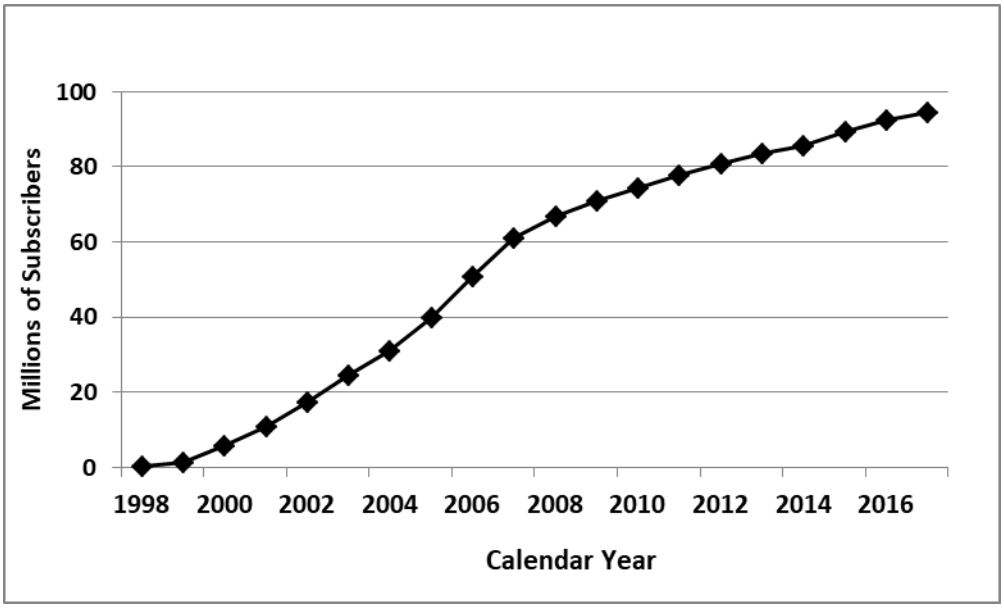
Source: HDS Recruitment Data, FY 2017.
Note: Sum of Internet Access and None does not equal 100 percent due to missing responses and access outside the home only.

Figure 2.1b:
Internet Access by Age and Type



Source: HDS Recruitment Data, FY 2017.
Note: Sum of Internet Access and None does not equal 100 percent due to missing responses and access outside the home only.

Figure 2.2:
Broadband Subscribers



Source: Leichtman Research Group.

Use of the Post Office

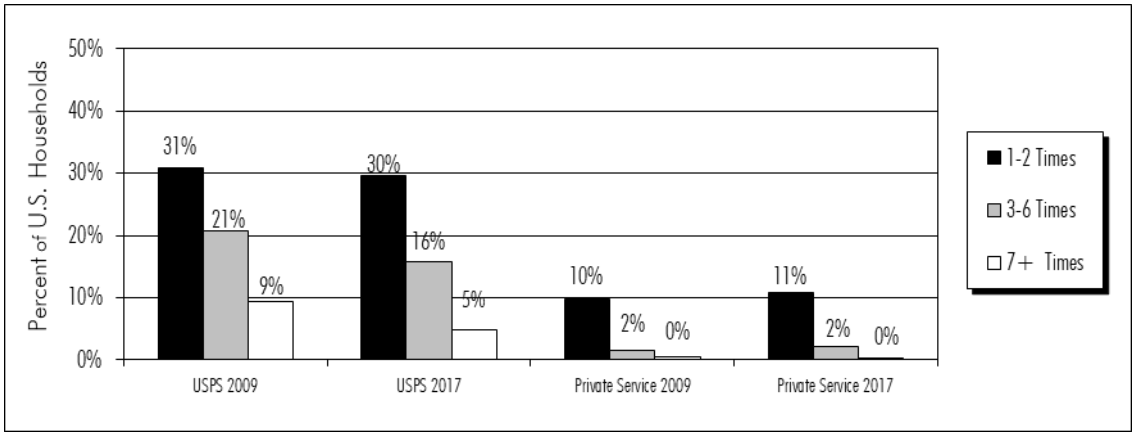
The Postal Service currently owns and operates 35,005 post office locations (including branches) throughout the U.S.

As shown in Figure 2.3, in spite of a declining frequency of visits over the past several years, the use of post offices for mailing services continues to dominate the mail service industry. Fifty one percent of all U.S. households patronize a post office at least once a month, while just 12 percent visit a private mailing company. Over 21 percent of all households in the U.S. visit the post office three or more times a month.

Even with the continued availability of mail-related products and services through alternative modes (such as Internet orders), in-person visits to postal facilities remain strong.

A rented mailbox is one alternative that households use to manage their mail. In 2017, 3.7 percent of all households in the U.S. rented mailboxes from the Postal Service, and 0.9 percent rented a box from a private company. Post office box use, however, declined since the start of the millennium, with 3.7 percent of U.S. households renting a post office box from the Postal Service in 2017, compared to 10 percent in 2001.

Figure 2.3:
Household Visits to Post Office in Past Month



Source: HDS Recruitment Data, FY 2009 and 2017

Chapter 3: Correspondence

Introduction

This chapter examines correspondence mail among households and between households and businesses, including letters, greeting cards, invitations, and announcements. In several cases, this chapter, and several following it, examines comparisons in data between 2015 and 2017, providing an illustration of mail trends over time.

Correspondence Mail Volume

Total correspondence sent and received represents almost 13.0 percent of all household mail volumes, as shown in Table E.2. Table 3.1 provides a recent history of total correspondence volumes, showing a 1.3 percent decline from 2015 to 2017. Personal correspondence, which is essentially household to household mail, fell 3.3 percent from 2015 to 2017, continuing a long-term declining trend which started several years ago. In 1987, households reported receiving 1.6 pieces of personal correspondence each week. By 2017, personal correspondence received declined 69 percent, to just 0.5 pieces per household per week.

In large part, this decline stemmed from competition from an ever-changing landscape of communication technologies, such as affordable long-distance telephone service and, more recently, e-mail, social networking, and cellular communications—all of which provide an alternative to personal letters and business inquiries. Such advances in technological communications completely transformed the marketplace, and continue to have an impact on personal correspondence.

Correspondence Mail and Household Characteristics

The following tables break down correspondence mail sent and received by households using the demographic categories developed in Chapter 2.

Income, Education, and Age

Tables 3.2 and 3.3 on the following page show that both household income and educational attainment have a strong effect on correspondence sent and received by households. In some cases, the volume of correspondence sent and received by households with the highest income or the highest education is almost two times the volume that is sent and received by households with the lowest income or the lowest education.

Table 3.1:
First-Class Correspondence Mail Sent and Received by Sector

Sector	Volume *(Millions of Pieces)*			Change, 2015-2017
	2015	2016	2017	
Household to household	3,249	3,157	3,141	-3.3%
Non-household to household	11,755	11,987	11,894	1.2%
Household to non-household	1,334	1,236	1,086	-18.6%
Total	**16,337**	**16,380**	**16,121**	**-1.3%**
Sector	**Pieces per Household per Week**			**Share of 2017 Total**
	2015	**2016**	**2017**	
Household to household	0.5	0.5	0.5	19.5%
Non-household to household	1.8	1.8	1.8	73.8%
Household to non-household	0.2	0.2	0.2	6.7%
Total	**2.5**	**2.5**	**2.5**	**100%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2015, 2016, and 2017.
Notes: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Table 3.2:
Correspondence Mail Received by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	2.0	1.8	1.3	1.7	**1.7**
$35 to $65	3.3	2.2	1.9	2.0	**2.1**
$65 to $100	1.9	3.2	2.6	2.6	**2.7**
Over $100	2.8	2.2	2.9	2.8	**2.7**
Average	**2.2**	**2.3**	**2.2**	**2.4**	**2.3**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.
Note: Excludes Don't Know/Refused.

Table 3.3:
Correspondence Mail Sent by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	.5	.4	.4	.5	**.4**
$35 to $65	.5	.7	.5	.5	**.6**
$65 to $100	.1	.9	.7	.7	**.7**
Over $100	.5	.5	.8	.9	**.8**
Average	**.4**	**.6**	**.6**	**.7**	**.6**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.
Note: Excludes Don't Know/Refused.

Tables 3.4 and 3.5 show that age also has a significant effect on correspondence mail sent and received by households. Regardless of their income, in most cases, younger households both send and receive fewer pieces of correspondence mail. Young adults have traditionally sent and received less mail than older adults, but the Internet age widened the gap between age groups.

Table 3.4:
Correspondence Mail Received by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 34	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	1.1	1.8	1.9	**1.7**
$35 to $65	1.2	2.0	2.7	**2.1**
$65 to $100	2.0	2.5	3.3	**2.7**
Over $100	2.0	2.6	3.3	**2.7**
Average	**1.5**	**2.2**	**2.7**	**2.3**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Table 3.5:
Correspondence Mail Sent by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 34	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	.2	.5	.5	.4
$35 to $65	.4	.4	.8	.6
$65 to $100	.6	.6	.9	.7
Over $100	.8	.7	1.1	.8
Average	.4	.5	.8	.6

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Household Size

As would be expected, household size has a positive effect on correspondence mail. Tables 3.6 and 3.7 show that the jump from one person to two person household is associated with a considerable increase in correspondence mail. Further increases in size have less significant effects. Table 3.7 shows that these increases are generally due to the presence of an additional adult in the household.

Table 3.6:
Correspondence Mail Received and Sent
by Household Size
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Size	Received	Sent
One person	1.6	.5
Two	2.5	.8
Three	2.5	.6
Four	2.6	.5
Five or more	2.8	.7
Total	2.3	.6

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Table 3.7:
Correspondence Mail Received and Sent
by Number of Adults in Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Number of Adults	Received	Sent
One	1.6	.4
Two	2.4	.7
Three or more	2.9	.7
Average	2.3	.6

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Internet Access

Table 3.8 shows that households with Internet access (Broadband or Dial-up) tend to receive more correspondence mail than households without such service. The explanation for this somewhat counterintuitive result is the high correlation among income, educational attainment, and the presence of an Internet connection in the home. As Table 3.9 shows, households with Internet access have a greater income and education than those without a connection. Such correlations could be a warning sign for mail, since more volume goes to households that are vulnerable to diversion. Correspondence mail sent by households is not affected much by household Internet access.

Table 3.8:
Correspondence Mail Received and Sent by Type of Internet Access
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Type of Internet Access	Received	Sent
Broadband	2.4	.6
Dial-up	2.1	.7
None	1.8	.6
Average	2.3	.6

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Table 3.9:
Income and Education by Type of Internet Access

Type of Internet Access	Median Income	% w/ College Degree
Broadband	65,454	44%
Dial-up	28,824	31%
None	22,719	17%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Personal Correspondence

In FY 2017, personal correspondence accounted for an average of 0.5 pieces of mail per week, which is unchanged from both 2016 and 2015. Table 3.10 shows the total volumes and average number of pieces by personal correspondence type.

Except for a small increase in greeting cards, all other types of personal correspondence declined compared to 2015, a result of the ongoing migration to the Internet. Online correspondence has become households' preferred method of communication by providing several convenient electronic alternatives to letter writing (e.g.: social networks, e-mails, e-cards,). Each year, the rise of these new virtual technologies continues to change the way friends and family stay in touch.

Table 3.10:
Personal Correspondence Sent and Received

Correspondence Type	Volume *(Millions of Pieces)*			Change, 2015-2017
	2015	2016	2017	
Personal Letters	588	493	516	-12.3%
Holiday Greeting Cards	1,218	1,283	1,288	5.7%
Non-Holiday Greeting Cards	1,033	960	981	-5.0%
Invitations/Announcements	397	407	339	-14.7%
Other Personal	13	14	18	41.0%
Total	**3,249**	**3,157**	**3,141**	**-3.3%**
Correspondence Type	**Pieces per Household per Week**			**Share of 2017 Total**
	2015	**2016**	**2017**	
Personal Letters	.1	.1	.1	16.4%
Holiday Greeting Cards	.2	.2	.2	41.0%
Non-Holiday Greeting Cards	.2	.1	.1	31.2%
Invitations / Announcements	.1	.1	.1	10.8%
Other Personal	.0	.0	.0	0.6%
Total	**.5**	**.5**	**.5**	**100.0%**

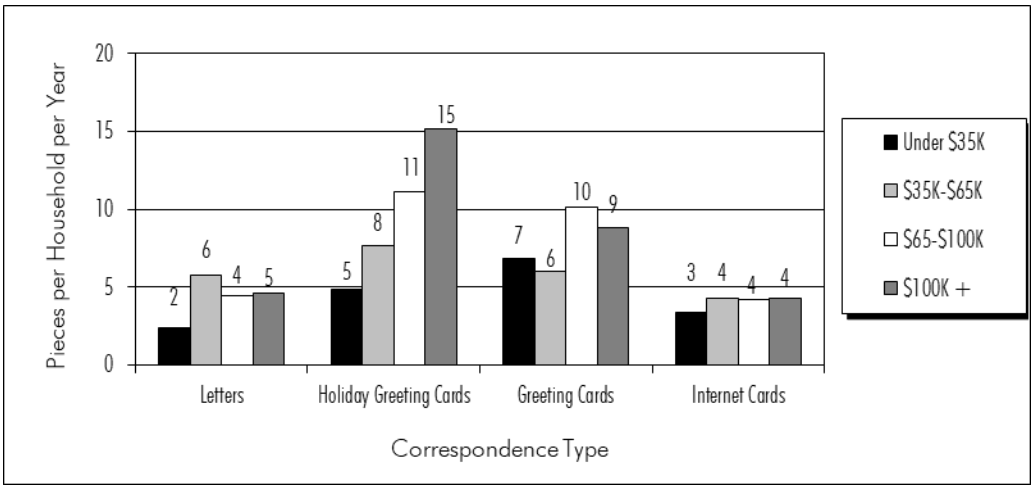
Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2015, 2016, and 2017.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Figure 3.1 shows the major categories of personal correspondence by income. Personal correspondence sent by households seems to follow a pattern of higher-income households being more likely to send letters, holiday cards, and non-holiday greeting cards than lower-income households.

The largest disparity between high- and low-income households is in the volume of holiday greeting cards sent. Households with incomes greater than $100,000 sent an average of 15 holiday greeting cards in FY 2017, compared to the 5 cards sent by households with incomes lower than $35,000. Internet card use is growing very slowly and volume remains relatively minor compared to physical cards.

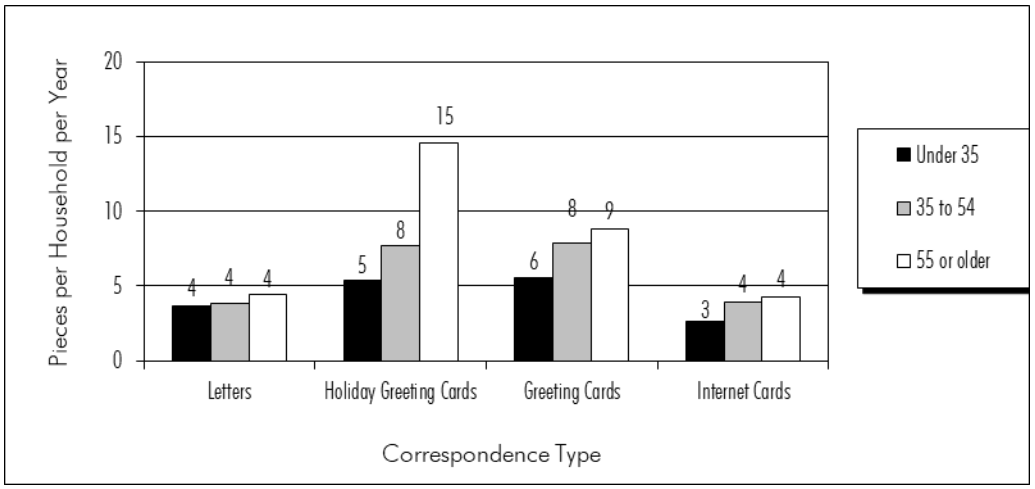
The number of letters and greeting cards sent also seems to follow a pattern where the older the head of household, the more that greeting cards are sent. Figure 3.2 illustrates this point. Use of social media to send greetings at no cost could partly explain why the number of internet cards sent by younger heads of household is not higher than reported.

Figure 3.1:
Personal Correspondence Sent by Income Group
(Pieces per Household per Year)



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Figure 3.2:
Personal Correspondence Sent by Age Cohort
(Pieces per Household per Year)

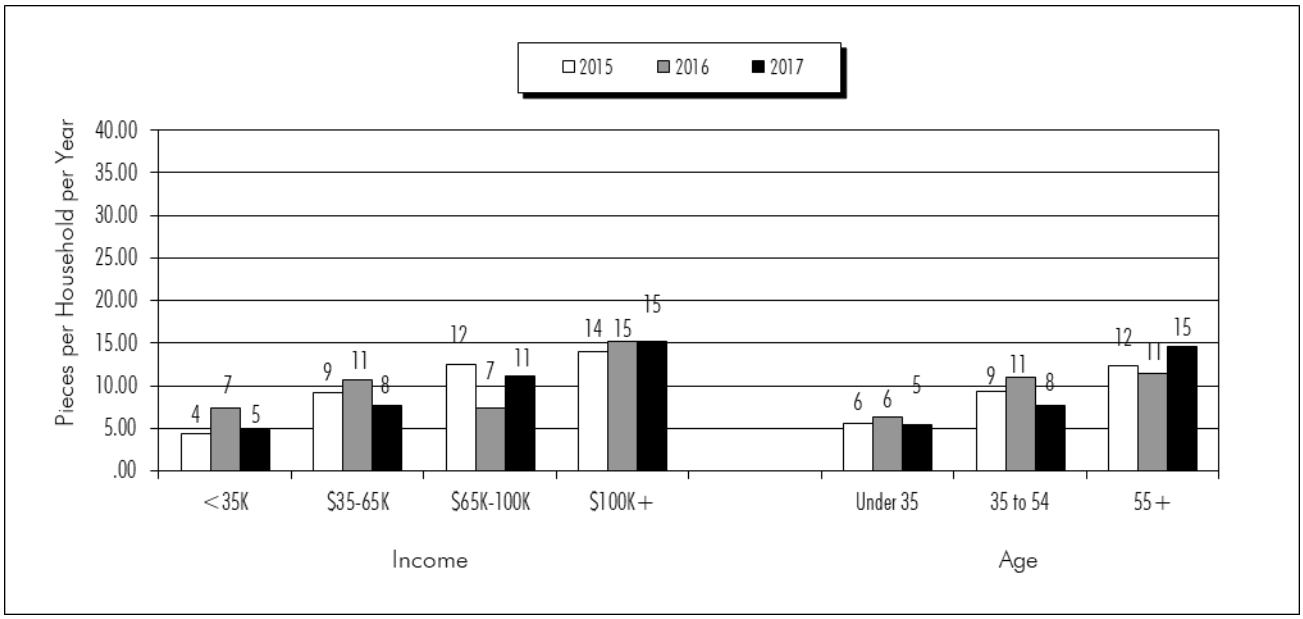


Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Figure 3.3 shows the relationship between holiday greeting cards sent and income over a period of three years. In FY 2017, as in prior years, higher-income households sent the most holiday greeting cards. On average, households with incomes greater than $100,000 sent about the same number of cards each year. Households with lower incomes however sent less holiday greeting cards in FY 2017 compared to FY 2015.

When examined by age, the number of holiday greeting cards sent by households where the head of household is older increased relative to both FY 2016 and FY 2015. Households where the head of household is younger the number of cards sent in FY2017 was lower than in prior years.

Figure 3.3:
Holiday Greetings Sent by Age and Income, FY 2015, 2016, and 2017



Source: HDS Diary data, Diary Sample only, FY 2014, 2015, and 2016.

As shown in Table 3.11, Internet access has a mixed effect on personal correspondence use. Households with Internet access sent more holiday greeting cards but less non-holiday cards than households without Internet access. These results could be a combination of factors: the higher volume of holiday greeting cards by households with Internet access is probably associated with their higher average income; the lower volume of non-holiday cards could be driven by a preference by households with Internet access to use social media for more general types of greetings.

Table 3.11:
Personal Correspondence by Type of Internet Access
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Correspondence Type	No Internet Access	Internet Access
Personal Letters	.08	.08
Holiday Greeting Cards	.11	.21
Non-Holiday Greeting Cards	.22	.14
Total	**.41**	**.43**

Source: HDS Diary Sample FY 2017.

Business Correspondence

This section of the report provides data on correspondence types between households and non-households (primarily businesses but also government and social organizations). In addition to correspondence mail, households and businesses exchange bill payments, statements, and advertising (discussed in Chapters 4 and 5). Table 3.12 outlines volumes by types of correspondence for 2015 through 2017. Although some individual categories of business correspondence fluctuated more significantly than others, in general, the volume of correspondence received by households remained relatively unchanged over the three-year period, with a net increase of 1.2% from 2015 to 2017.

Correspondence received from the non-household sector accounts for 74 percent of all correspondence sent and received by households (see Table 3.1).

Invitations and announcements represent 46 percent of business and government correspondence received by households. Other Business/Government includes mostly tax, DMV, and Social Security related correspondence. Announcements are also the main type of social correspondence households receive; in 2017 they represented 48 percent of all social mail received. Other social correspondence consists mostly of political materials, newsletters and greeting cards.

Table 3.12:
Business Correspondence Type (Sent and Received) by Sector (Millions of Pieces)

Business Correspondence Type	2015	2016	2017	Change, 2015–2017
Business/Government/Social Received by Households				
Invitation/Announcement	5,116	5,051	5,055	-1.2%
Holiday Greeting from Business	313	341	335	6.8%
Other Business/Government	5,221	5,497	5,492	5.2%
Total Business/Government Received	**10,650**	**10,889**	**10,881**	2.2%
Announcement	608	535	487	-20.0%
Other Social	497	562	526	5.9%
Total Social Received	**1,105**	**1,098**	**1,013**	-8.4%
Total Received	**11,755**	**11,987**	**11,894**	1.2%
Business/Government/Social Sent from Households				
Inquiry	54	51	72	34.6%
Other Business/Government	1,131	1,029	892	-21.1%
Total Business/Government Sent	1,185	1,080	965	-18.6%
Letter	44	9	11	-75.7%
Inquiry	7	4	1	-80.1%
Other Social	97	145	109	12.0%
Total Social Sent (Social includes social, political & nonprofit.)	148	157	121	-18.5%
Total Sent	1,334	1,236	1,086	-18.6%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2015, 2016, and 2017.
Notes: Totals may not sum due to rounding

Chapter 4: Transactions

Introduction

This chapter examines the volumes and trends in transactions mail: the bills, statements, payments, donations, rebates, and orders sent and received by households. Information is presented on household bill payment trends, which is of particular interest as the availability of electronic alternatives affects traditional transactions mail.

Transactions Mail Volume

Transactions sent and received constitute 19 percent of all household mail volumes (as seen in Table E.2) and 48 percent of household First-Class Mail; as such, they represent a major component of the mail stream.

As Table 4.1 shows, total transaction volume sent and received by households fell 10.6 percent compared to 2015. All categories contributed to the decline, as volumes were eroded by a continuous growth in Internet usage for a variety of transaction types.

Although many businesses use electronic funds transfer (EFT) or other electronic technologies to settle transactions, households still receive a majority of their recurring bills through the Postal Service. However, as households become more comfortable with receiving personal information online, the transition to electronic bill presentments will likely gain more momentum.

As of FY 2017, Internet access had the most significant impact on bill payments by providing several alternative and convenient ways to make payments. Payments can be made on computers, on mobile devices, or using other electronic devices. Migration of payments to the Internet was the main cause behind the 10.6 percent decrease from FY 2015 to FY 2017, as shown in Table 4.1. The growth in non-mail methods of payments is also evident in Table 4.1, where bills paid by mail were far fewer than total bills received (as shown in Table E-3, in 2017, only 30 percent of all household bills were paid by mail).

Table 4.1:
Transactions Mail Sent and Received (cont.)

Transaction Type	Volume (Millions of Pieces)			Change, 2015-2017
	2015	2016	2017	
Business				
Bills	13,743	13,472	12,569	-8.5%
Bill Payments	4,383	3,753	3,347	-23.6%
Statements	4,204	3,994	4,056	-3.5%
Payments (to HH)	1,039	895	896	-13.8%
Orders	224	189	189	-15.6%
Rebates	120	128	135	12.4%
Other Transactions	862	891	798	-7.4%
Total Business	**24,574**	**23,323**	**21,990**	**-10.5%**
Social/Charitable				
Request for Donation	596	524	501	-15.9%
Donations	288	286	260	-9.5%
Bills	100	122	73	-26.4%
Confirmations	218	256	207	-4.9%
Total Social/Charitable	**1,200**	**1,189**	**1,042**	**-13.2%**
Total Transactions	**25,775**	**24,511**	**23,032**	**-10.6%**

Table 4.1:
Transactions Mail Sent and Received (cont.)

Transaction Type	Pieces per Household per Week			Share 2017
	2015	2016	2017	
Business				
Bills	2.1	2.1	1.9	54.6%
Bill Payments	0.7	0.6	0.5	14.5%
Statements	0.6	0.6	0.6	17.6%
Payments (to HH)	0.2	0.1	0.1	3.9%
Orders	0.03	0.03	0.03	0.8%
Rebates	0.019	0.020	0.021	0.6%
Other Transactions	0.1	0.1	0.1	3.5%
Total Business	**3.8**	**3.6**	**3.4**	**95.5%**
Social/Charitable				
Request for Donation	0.1	0.1	0.1	2.2%
Donations	0.0	0.04	0.04	1.1%
Bills	0.02	0.02	0.01	0.3%
Confirmations	0.03	0.04	0.03	0.9%
Total Social/Charitable	**0.2**	**0.2**	**0.2**	**4.5%**
Total Transactions	**4.0**	**3.7**	**3.5**	**100.0%**

Source: HDS Recruitment Sample, FY 2015, 2016, and 2017.
Historical data was restated as a result of improvements to the 2011 survey questionnaires, which restated previously unclassified mail. The increase in the newly created insurance related category is also related to the changes to the questionnaires.

Transactions Mail and Household Characteristics

The following tables break down transactions mail sent and received by households based on the demographic categories introduced in Chapter 2.

Income, Education, and Age

As seen in Tables 4.2 and 4.3, household income and educational attainment influence the amount of transactions mail sent and received. In most cases, income has a much greater impact on transactions mail received than sent. The basis for this relationship is that higher-income households are more likely to be Internet households and more likely to pay bills through electronic means. The tables also show that, on average, income has a greater impact on transactions mail than education (in general, better-educated households tend to have more financial accounts, insurance policies, and credit cards—all generators of transactions mail volume). Looking across each income category, the impact of education becomes less evident. While in some cases, volume decreases as education level increases, in other cases volume increases or remains unchanged.

Table 4.2:
Transactions Mail Received by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	2.1	2.1	1.9	2.0	**2.0**
$35 to $65	3.4	3.1	2.8	2.6	**2.9**
$65 to $100	4.8	3.7	3.5	3.0	**3.4**
Over $100	4.4	3.7	3.8	3.4	**3.5**
Average	**3.0**	**3.0**	**2.9**	**2.9**	**2.9**

Source: HDS Recruitment Sample, FY 2017.

Table 4.3:
Transactions Mail Sent by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	0.3	0.5	0.4	0.4	**0.4**
$35 to $65	0.6	0.4	0.6	0.6	**0.5**
$65 to $100	0.3	0.8	0.8	0.7	**0.7**
Over $100	0.3	0.6	0.7	0.6	**0.6**
Average	**0.3**	**0.6**	**0.6**	**0.6**	**0.6**

Source: HDS Recruitment Sample, FY 2017.

Tables 4.4 and 4.5 show that age has a strong effect on transactions mail, independent of income. Across all income categories, younger households send and receive less transactions mail. In part, this is because such households are less likely to own their home and have fewer insurance policies, investments, and the like. However, it is also the case that these households are more active users of electronic alternatives for traditionally mail-based transactions. This is particularly evident for transactions mail sent by households (primarily bill payments) in which the heads of household aged under 35 years sent only a small fraction of the mail sent by households where the head of household is 50 or older.

Table 4.4:
Transactions Mail Received by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 35	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	1.2	1.9	2.5	**2.0**
$35 to $65	2.0	2.8	3.4	**2.9**
$65 to $100	2.2	3.3	4.1	**3.4**
Over $100	2.0	3.4	4.3	**3.5**
Average	**1.8**	**2.9**	**3.5**	**2.9**

Source: HDS Recruitment Sample, FY 2017.

Across all income categories, younger households send and receive less transactions mail.

Table 4.5:
Transactions Mail Sent by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 35	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	0.1	0.3	0.7	**0.4**
$35 to $65	0.1	0.4	0.9	**0.5**
$65 to $100	0.3	0.4	1.1	**0.7**
Over $100	0.1	0.6	0.9	**0.6**
Average	**0.1**	**0.4**	**0.9**	**0.6**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Household Size

In terms of household size, Table 4.6 shows that the increase from a one-person household to a two-person household adds 1.0 piece of transactions mail per week received and 0.2 pieces per week sent, but larger household sizes have a much smaller effect on volume.

Table 4.6:
Transactions Mail Received and Sent by Household Size
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Size	Received	Sent
One person	2.1	.5
Two	3.1	.7
Three	3.3	.5
Four	3.3	.5
Five or more	3.4	.4
Average	**2.9**	**.6**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

For transactions mail received, Table 4.7 shows that each additional adult adds about 1.0 piece of mail received per week. However, additional adults do not generate any additional pieces of mail sent.

Table 4.7:
Transactions Mail Received and Sent
by Number of Adults in Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Number of Adults in Household	Received	Sent
One	2.1	0.5
Two	3.0	0.6
Three or more	4.0	0.6
Average	**2.9**	**0.6**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Internet Access

Table 4.8 shows that households with Internet access (Broadband or Dial-up) receive more transactions mail than households without Internet service, even though having an Internet connection at home should make transactions more susceptible to electronic diversion. This apparent contradiction is explained in large measure by the fact that household Internet access is strongly correlated with income and education (see Table 4.9).

Table 4.8 also shows that the number of transactions sent by households with either Broadband or Dial-up is lower than for households without any Internet access. The convenience of using the Internet provides a strong motivation for households to move financial transactions online.

Table 4.8:
Transactions Mail Received and Sent by Internet Access
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Type of Internet Access	Received	Sent
Broadband	3.0	0.6
Dial-up	2.7	0.7
None	2.4	0.8
Average	**2.9**	**0.6**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Table 4.9:
Income and Education by Type of Internet Access

Type of Internet Access	Median Income	% w/ College Degree
Broadband	65,454	44%
Dial-up	28,824	31%
None	22,719	17%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Bill Payment

As mentioned, households use a variety of methods to pay bills. Historically, they were paid in person, via phone, or by mail. However, the Internet and other emerging technologies have created several new payment options. The most popular of these are electronic bill payment, which includes payments made via the Internet (with a computer or a mobile phone), automatic deductions from bank or credit card accounts, and payments over the phone.

The Household Diary Study measures bill payments by all methods. Table 4.10 shows five-year changes (2017 versus 2012) in the percentage of households that pay bills by each method and the average number of bills paid per month for each method. About 63 percent of households paid at least one bill by mail in 2017 (this implies that 37 percent of households no longer paid any bills by mail). Other popular bill payment methods were online, using a mobile phone or a computer (65 percent of households paid at least one bill online) and automatic deductions from bank accounts (52 percent of households). In 2017, households paid an average of 3.3 bills per month by mail, a decline of 30 percent from 4.7 in 2012. This meant that only 30 percent of household payments were made by mail—the lowest percentage to-date.

In 2017, households reported paying 43 percent more payments using the Internet (4.7) than by mail (3.3). Additionally, more payments were made using the Internet (4.7) than by all other electronic methods combined (2.6).

> In 2017, households paid 43 percent more bills using the Internet than by mail.

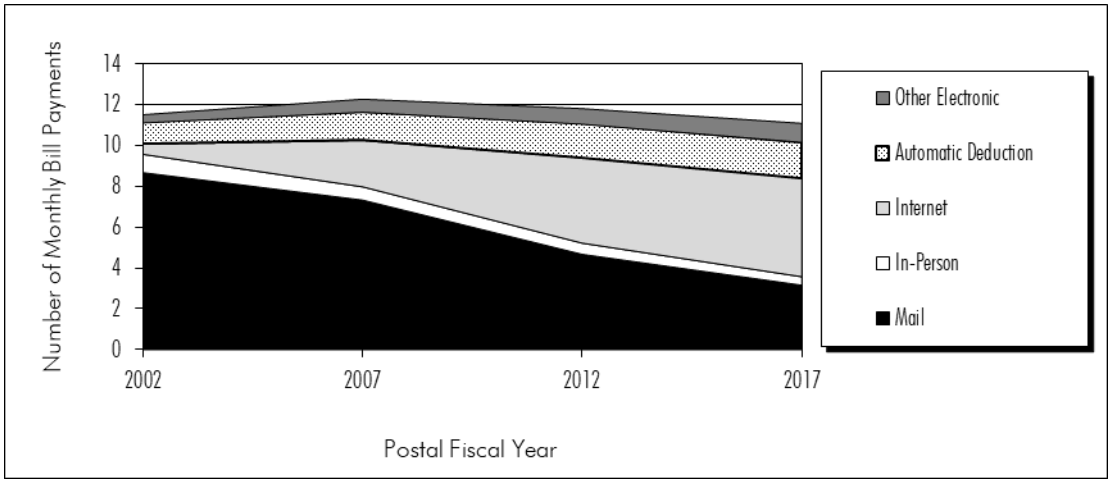
Table 4.10:
Bill Payment by Method, FY 2012 vs. 2017

Bill Payment Method	2012			2017		
	Average Number of Bills Paid per Month	Share of Bills Paid	Percent of Households Using Method	Average Number of Bills Paid per Month	Share of Bills Paid	Percent of Households Using Method
Mail	4.7	40%	78%	3.3	30%	63%
Using Internet	4.0	34%	56%	4.7	42%	65%
Automatic Deduction	1.6	14%	55%	1.7	15%	52%
Credit Card	0.4	4%	21%	0.5	5%	23%
Telephone	0.4	3%	18%	0.4	4%	18%
In-person	0.6	5%	31%	0.5	4%	22%
Total	11.7	100%	—	11.0	100%	—
Total Electronic	6.4	55%	79%	7.3	66%	85%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2015, 2016, and 2017.
Historical data for payments by mail was restated as a result of improved 2011 survey questionnaires which restated previously unclassified mail pieces.

As Figure 4.1 shows, electronic methods account for a growing share of household bill payments over time. In fact, since 2002, the average number of bills paid electronically increased by a multiple of 7, largely at the expense of the mail, which fell 64 percent in that time period.

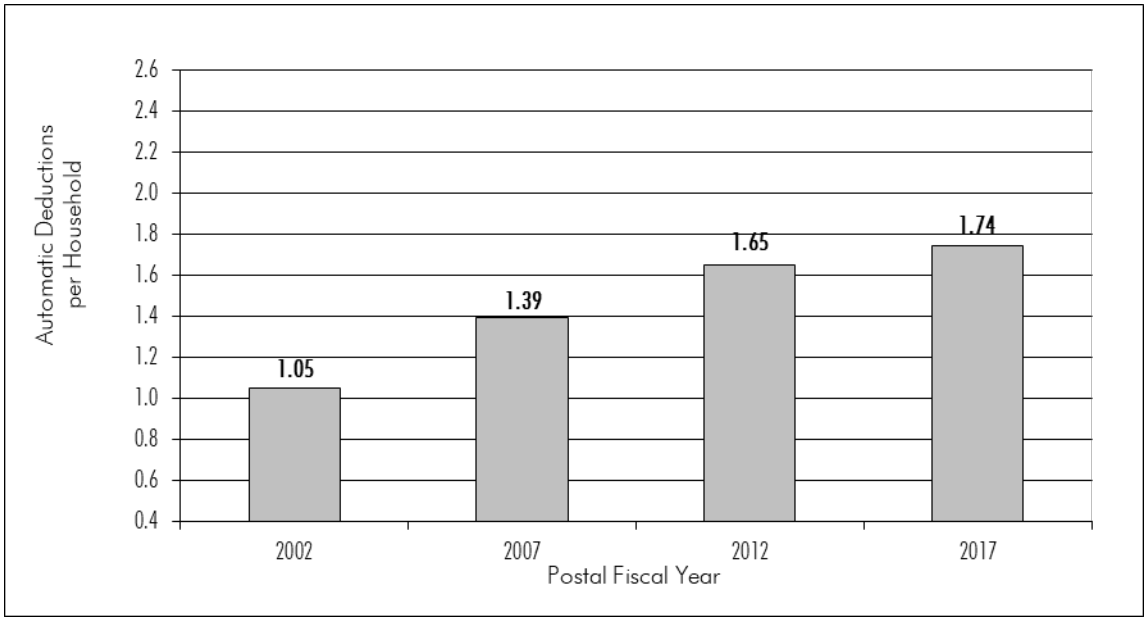
Figure 4.1:
Monthly Average Household Bill Payment by Method



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2002-2017.
Note: Other Electronic includes telephone.

Figure 4.2 shows that automatic deductions increased by more than two-thirds (67%) since 2002. Over time, however, the increasing popularity of the Internet has provided sufficient motivation for many households to transition from automated deductions to online bill payments, in a way similar to the electronic diversion of payments by mail. As a result, the growth in automatic deductions has slowed significantly in recent years.

Figure 4.2:
Average Monthly Automatic Deductions per Household

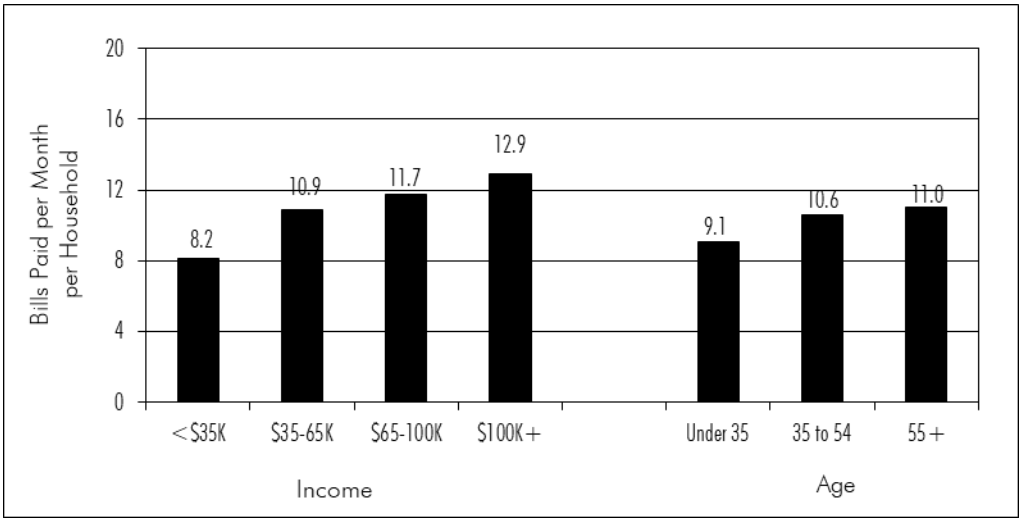


Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2002-2017.

The Household Diary Study has consistently found that the average number of bills paid by mail per month varies by age and income, as does the choice of method used for bill payment. Figure 4.3 shows the total average number of bills paid per month for each income and age group.

Not surprisingly, the number of bills paid per month is positively related to household income. Households with incomes above $100,000 paid an average of 12.9 bills per month in FY 2017, compared to 8.2 bills paid by households with incomes below $35,000. Age has a similar relationship with bill payment levels; younger households (where the head of household was aged 35 or younger) paid fewer bills (9.1 bills par month) than households where the head of household was between the ages of 35 and 54 (10.6 bills per month). For older households (where the head of household was aged 55 or older), the increase in bills paid per month (11.0) was not as significant because they tend to moderate their spending, thus reducing the amount of bills to be paid.

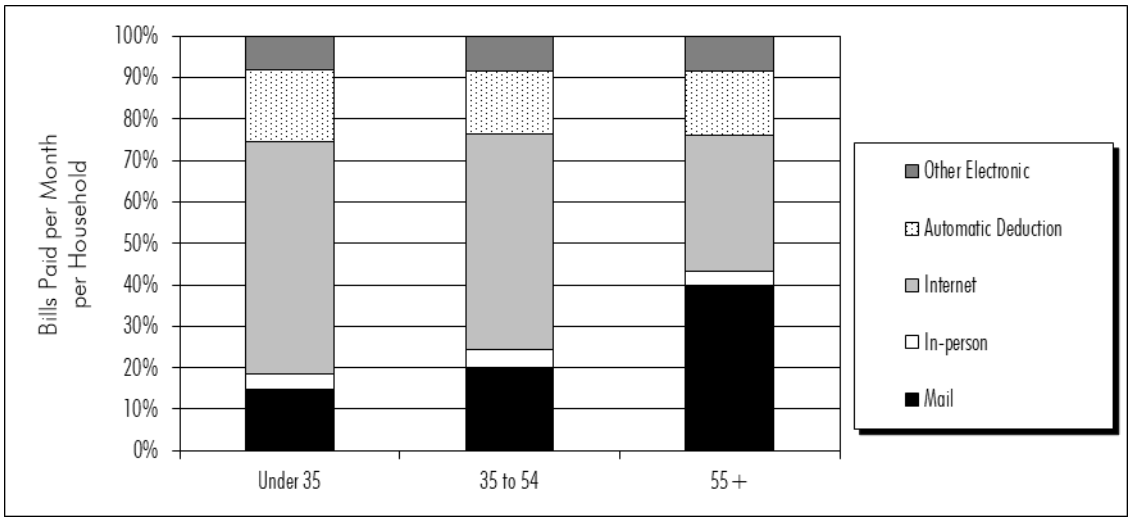
Figure 4.3:
Average Bills Paid per Month by Income and Age



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

As Figure 4.4 shows, younger households paid the majority of their bills electronically and were much more likely to pay bills using the Internet than by any other method. In 2017, households where the head of household was aged 35 or younger paid 56 percent of their bills using the Internet and only 15 percent by mail. Older heads of household, on the other hand, continued to pay the majority of their bills by mail (40 percent). They also paid 33 percent on the Internet and 16 percent by automatic deductions.

Figure 4.4:
Bill Payment Method by Age



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.
Note: Other Electronic includes telephone.

Bills and Statements Received

Table 4.11 shows the overall volume of bills and statements received. In FY 2017, households received a total of 16.7 billion pieces of bills and statements in the mail, representing about 42 percent of total First-Class Mail received). Bills received (12.6 billion pieces) originated primarily from credit card companies (3.5 billion), utilities (2.4 billion), telephone/cable companies (1.6 billion), medical and professional companies (1.5 billion), and insurance companies (1.4 billion).

Statements received (4.1 billion pieces) were predominantly sent by the financial sector (mainly banks, with 2.1 billion pieces).

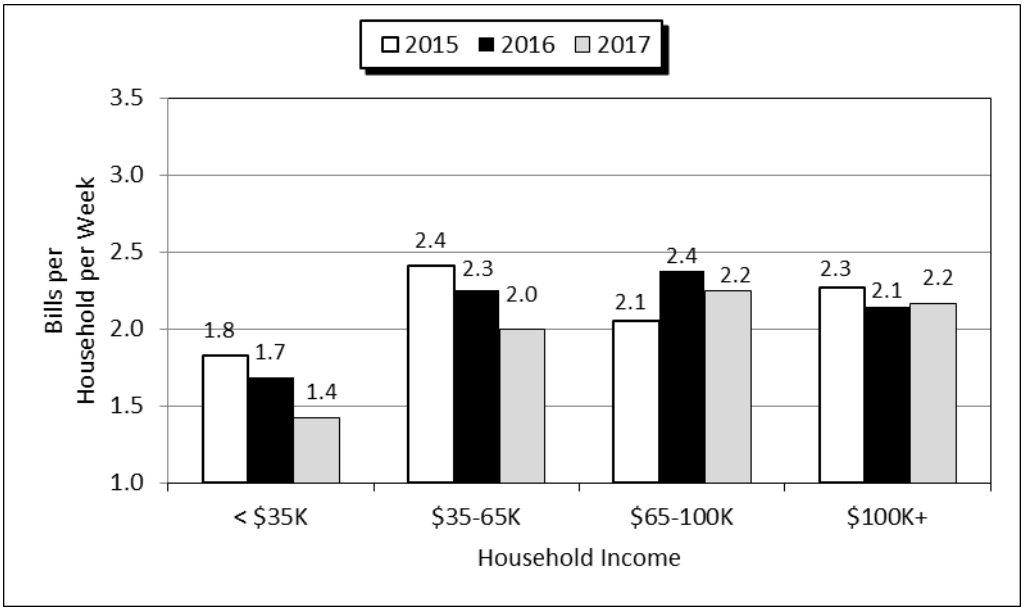
Table 4.11:
Bill and Statement Volumes by Industry

Industry	Volumes	
	Bills ***(Millions)***	**Statements** ***(Millions)***
Financial		
Bank, S&L, Credit Union	804	2,159
Credit Card	3,523	14
Insurance Company	1,415	291
Real Estate/Mortgage	254	103
Other Financial	97	1,185
Total Financial	**6,092**	**3,752**
Merchants		
Department Store	59	3
Publisher	144	3
Mail Order Company	46	3
Other Merchants	125	16
Total Merchants	**374**	**25**
Service		
Telephone/Cable Company	1,621	15
Utility Company	2,359	28
Medical and Other Professional	1,480	96
Other Service	303	7
Total Service	**5,764**	**147**
Manufacturers	19	7
Government	298	91
Social/Nonprofit	0	27
Other/Don't Know/Refused	17	7
Total – All Industries	**12,563**	**4,056**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.
Note: Social/Nonprofit bill and statement volumes were not collected separately.

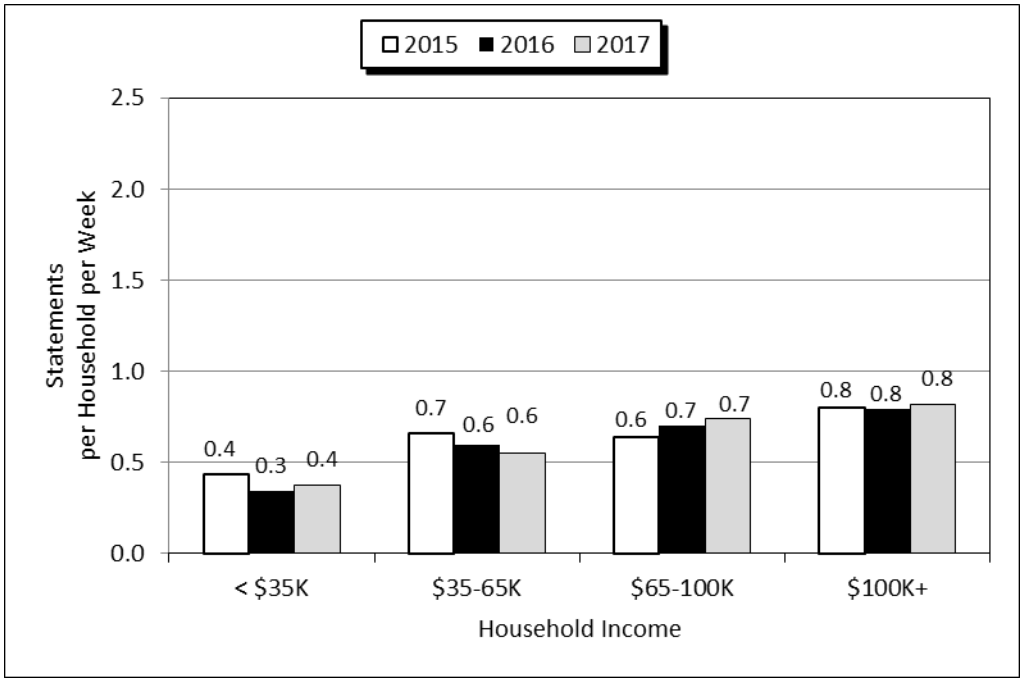
Figures 4.5a and 4.5b, show number of bills and statements received by mail, by income group. Higher income households received more bills and statements because of they typically have more financial accounts. Between 2015 and 2017, there was a general, diversion-driven decline in the number of bills received for most income categories. This was not as much the case for statements in part because there is a general preference for paper copies, mainly for purposes of record keeping.

Figure 4.5a:
Bills Received by Mail Per Week by Income



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2015, 2016, and 2017. Amounts are rounded.

Figure 4.5b:
Statements Received by Mail Per Week by Income



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2015, 2016, and 2017. Amounts are rounded.

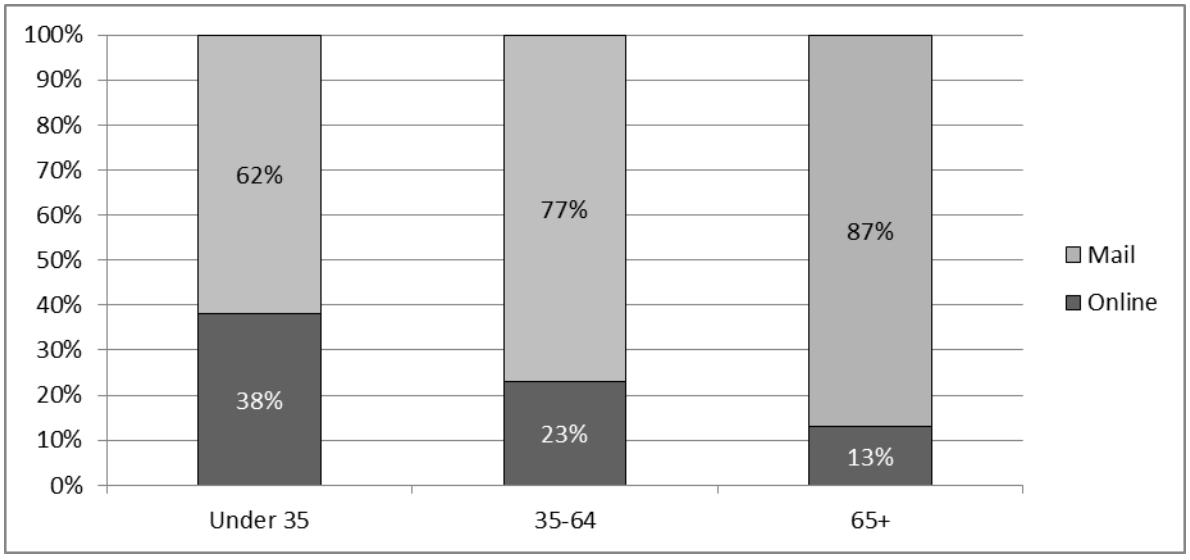
Table 4.12 compares the average number of bills received by mail per month to the average number received via the Internet. As the table illustrates, in 2017 there was a slight decrease in the number of monthly bills received by households, from 11.1 in 2015 to 10.7. Bills presented by mail fell from 9.3 bills per month in 2015 to 8.3 in 2017, reflecting the impact of electronic diversion as bills slowly migrate to online presentment. Bills received online, on the other hand, increased from 1.9 to 2.4 over the same period, partly offsetting the reduction in the number of bills received by mail.

Table 4.12:
Average Monthly Bills Received by Method

Method	2015	2016	2017
Mail	9.3	9.0	8.3
Internet	1.9	2.2	2.4
Total	11.1	11.2	10.7
Share Received by Internet	17%	19%	22%

Figure 4.6, shows the 2017 shares of bills received by each presentment method, by age cohort. As expected, younger heads of household converted to electronic presentments more quickly than their older counterparts. Households where the head is under 35 years old received 38 percent of their bills online; the other 62 percent of bills was received by mail. Households over 65 years old, on the other hand, received only 13 percent of their bills online and the vast majority (87 percent) was still received by mail.

Figure 4.6:
Shares of Bills Received by Methods and by Age



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017

Chapter 5: Advertising Mail

Introduction

This chapter examines advertising mail, which is any advertising, promotional, or sales material sent through the Postal Service. Advertising mail can be sent as First-Class or Marketing Mail.

The Advertising Market

According to Pivotal Research Group, American businesses spent about $210 billion in 2017 advertising their products and services, a 2.6% percent increase from 2016, following a 6.8 percent spending increase in 2016. Of this total advertising spending, 9.0 percent was spent on direct mail (note that Pivotal's spending estimates for direct mail include only postage costs).

As in prior years, direct mail was one of the leading media choices of advertisers in 2017 (third after Internet and TV). However, in spite of a robust increase in total advertising spending, a large increase in Internet advertising left fewer funds available for more traditional advertising methods such as direct mail. As shown in Table 5.1, direct mail spending incurred a significant decrease, falling 5.6 percent compared to 2016; Internet advertising, on the other hand, increased 20.7 percent, the only media category to show spending growth; spending in all other media fell compared to 2016. Other's fluctuations from one year to the next are seasonality's due to the elections and the Olympics.

Table 5.1:
U.S. Advertising Spending Growth by Medium, 2015-2017
(Percent Growth from Prior Year)

Medium	2015	2016	2017
Direct Mail	-1.1%	-1.7%	-5.6%
TV	0.7%	1.1%	-3.0%
Radio	-2.5%	-2.9%	-2.7%
Newspapers	-12.8%	-12.1%	-15.5%
Magazines	-12.8%	-8.7%	-12.8%
Internet	20.7%	22.0%	20.7%
Other	-22.5%	27.6%	-26.1%
Total	2.0%	6.8%	2.6%

Source: Pivotal Research Group—estimates.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

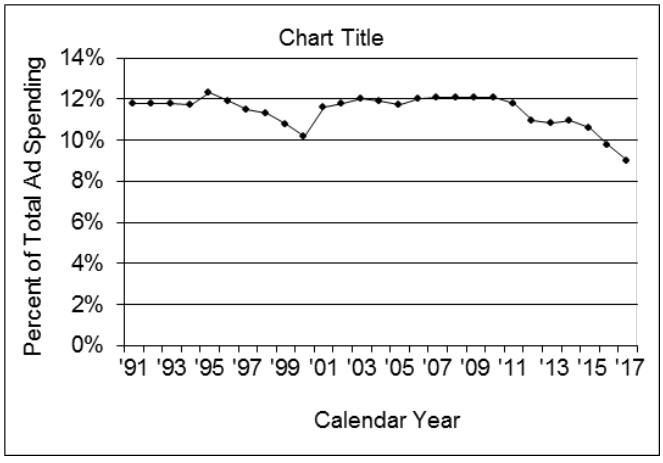
*Other fluctuations are due to political/Olympic advertising

Direct mail continues to be one of the most popular advertising choices. It is a highly efficient and versatile method for communicating with consumers. Direct mail can be targeted to the interests of individual customers, and used both to locate new customers and maintain relationships with existing customers. Direct mail allows for a variety of different types of advertising: letters, postcards, catalogs, and free samples. It can be sent as First-Class or Marketing Mail, allowing advertisers to trade off expeditious, personalized First-Class mailings against cost-savings from Marketing Mail.

Importantly, the effectiveness of direct mail is readily measurable, more so than for most other media. Businesses can track the response rate to a mailing far more precisely than for a television commercial or magazine advertisement. This feature alone gives advertising mail a key advantage over other media.

Figure 5.1 shows that, according to Pivotal's estimate of postage costs, after averaging 12% for over two decades, the share of direct mail spending started declining in 2012, reaching 9% by 2017.

Figure 5.1:
Direct Mail as a Share of Total Advertising, 1991-2017



Source: U.S. Postal Service calculations based on Pivotal Research Group data.

Advertising Mail Volumes

In 2017, advertising mail represented 62 percent of all household mail. Households received 76.8 billion pieces of advertising mail, down 3.9 percent from 2015, driven by a 6.8 percent decline in First-Class advertising and a 3.5 percent decline in Marketing Mail advertising.

As shown in Table 5.2, First-Class advertising mail accounted for 7.8 billion pieces (10 percent of all advertising mail received by households). Of this volume, 3.7 billion pieces were advertising-only, while the other 4.1 billion pieces were secondary advertising pieces. The latter, also referred to as advertising-enclosed mail, are not included in the total volume count for advertising because the primary piece (be it a bill, statement, or correspondence mailing) is already part of the total.

In 2017, First-Class advertising-only mail fell 6.8 percent compared to 2015, continuing a decline which began in 2007, just prior to the Great Recession. Weak economic conditions that followed the recession encouraged mailers to rely more heavily on Marketing Mail advertising - a cheaper alternative to First-Class Mail.

Advertising mail represented 62 percent of all mail received by households in 2017

About 90 percent (68.9 billion pieces) of all advertising mail received by households in 2017 was sent via Marketing Mail. Compared to 2015, Marketing Mail fell 3.5 percent, driven by slow economic growth and an increasing migration of advertising dollars from traditional media like direct mail to internet advertising.

Marketing Mail accounted for 90 percent of total household advertising mail.

Table 5.2:
Advertising Mail Received by Households by Mail Classification
(Volume in Billions of Pieces)

Mail Classification	Volume *(Billions of Pieces)*			Change 2015-2017
	2015	2016	2017	
First-Class Advertising	8.4	8.3	7.8	-6.8%
Advertising Only	3.6	3.8	3.7	3.3%
Secondary Advertising	4.8	4.5	4.1	-14.4%
Marketing Mail	71.4	71.5	68.9	-3.5%
Regular and ECR	58.7	60.0	57.2	-2.4%
Nonprofit	12.7	11.5	11.6	-8.4%
Unsolicited Packages	0.11	0.07	0.08	-29.7%
Total Advertising	79.8	79.9	76.8	-3.9%
Unaddressed Mail	0.7	1.1	1.0	33.9%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2015, 2016, and 2017.
Notes: Totals may not sum due to rounding. Unaddressed Mail is not included in totals.

Table 5.3:
Advertising Mail by Mail Classification
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Mail Classification	Pieces per HH per Week			Share of Total
	2015	2016	2017	
First-Class Advertising	1.3	1.3	1.2	10.2%
Advertising Only	0.6	0.6	0.6	4.8%
Secondary Advertising	0.7	0.7	0.6	5.3%
Marketing Mail	11.0	10.9	10.5	89.7%
Regular and ECR	9.1	9.2	8.7	74.6%
Nonprofit	2.0	1.8	1.8	15.2%
Unsolicited Periodicals/Packages	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.1%
Total Advertising	12.3	12.2	11.7	100.0%
Unaddressed Mail	0.1	0.2	0.2	1.3%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2015, 2016, and 2017.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding. Unaddressed Mail is not included in totals.

Advertising Mail and Household Characteristics

Income, Education, and Age

Given that advertising mail is used to sell goods and services, it is not surprising that the amount of ad mail received by a household is closely tied to income and education.

The relationship between advertising mail and household income is quite strong, as seen in Table 5.4. Households with incomes of $100,000 or more receive more than double the mail pieces received by households with income of less than $35,000 (16.2 vs. 7.5 pieces per week).

Table 5.4 also shows that education plays a key role in the amount of advertising mail households receive. For example, households headed by someone without a high school degree receive 9.1 pieces per week while households headed by a college graduate receive 13.2 pieces per week (higher income households without a high school diploma likely represent successful entrepreneurs who receive large volumes of business-related ad mail).

The role that education plays in advertising mail is two-fold. First, direct mail is a written type of communication, and education may play some role in its relative effectiveness compared to television or radio advertising. Second, education is not only tied to current household income, but also to future household income. A college graduate who currently has a relatively low income may, in a few years, earn a much higher income.

Table 5.4:
Advertising Mail Received by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income (Thousands)	Education of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School graduate	Some College or Technical School	College graduate	
Under $35	7.4	7.7	6.8	8.0	7.5
$35 to $65	11.2	10.5	10.8	11.0	10.8
$65 to $100	10.6	13.8	12.7	13.4	13.1
Over $100	15.1	14.6	16.5	16.5	16.2
Average	9.1	10.7	11.1	13.2	11.7

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

As Table 5.5 illustrates, households headed by an older person receive more advertising mail than those headed by someone younger. For every income group, advertising mail received increases as the age of the head of the household increases. In part, this is because age is correlated with other characteristics such as marriage, home ownership, and the presence of children in the household.

Moreover, the older a person is, the longer his or her buying history and the more businesses with which the person has a relationship that advertising mail can help maintain. Those households with incomes greater than $100,000 and with a head of household aged 55 and older received the greatest number of advertising mail pieces at 20 pieces per week.

The amount of advertising mail received increases as income, education, and age increase.

Table 5.5:
Advertising Mail Received by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 34	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	4.2	6.5	9.7	7.5
$35 to $65	6.9	9.2	14.0	10.8
$65 to $100	8.3	12.1	16.2	13.1
Over $100	10.8	15.1	20.0	16.2
Average	7.1	11.1	14.2	11.7

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Household Size

Tables 5.6 and 5.7 show advertising mail received increases as the household size and number of adults in the household increase. Table 5.6 shows that, while this is evident by looking at changes in household sizes from one to two household members (where mail pieces increase 41 percent), additional members over two do not increase the number of advertising pieces received.

Table 5.6:
Advertising Mail Received by Size of Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Size	
One person	9.2
Two	13.0
Three	12.0
Four	12.2
Five or more	11.5
Average	11.7

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

When looking at changes in the number of adults in the household, there is a more continuous increase in the number of advertising mail pieces received as the number of adults increases. Households with two adults receive 39% more advertising mail than those with only one adult. Households with three or more adults receive 5 percent more advertising mail than a household with two adults. These results stem from the likelihood that households with more than one adult are also two (or more) -income households.

Table 5.7:
Advertising Mail Received by Number of Adults
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Number of Adults	
One	9.0
Two	12.5
Three or more	13.1
Average	11.7

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Internet Access

Finally, Table 5.8 shows that there is a direct relationship between advertising mail received and Internet access. Despite all the attention paid to online and e-mail advertising, households with Internet access receive more advertising mail than those without access.

To a large degree, this reflects other household characteristics. As Table 5.9 shows, Internet access is closely tied to income and education. However, advertising mail is sent even when new advertising media are available. As Table 5.8 may demonstrate, the Internet is often used to target potential customers through direct mail advertising. Conversely, direct mail can also be used as a complement to the Internet by directing potential customers to specific company websites.

Table 5.8:
Advertising Mail Received by Internet Access
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Type of Internet Access	
Broadband	12.0
Dial-up	10.9
None	9.7
Average	11.7

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Table 5.9:
Income and Education by Type of Internet Access

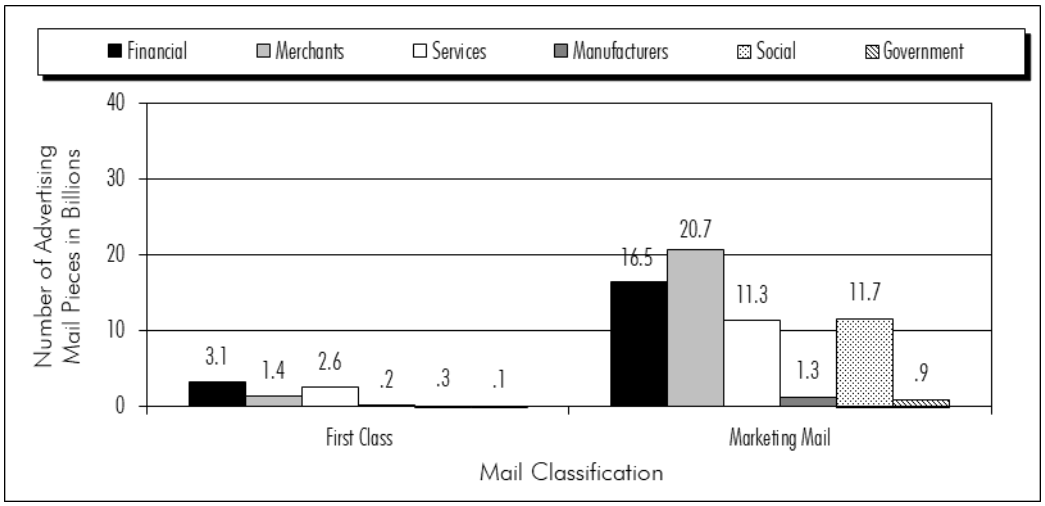
Type of Internet Access	Median Income	% w/ College Degree
Broadband	65,454	44%
Dial-up	28,824	31%
None	22,719	17%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Senders of Advertising Mail

Figure 5.2 provides data on the senders of advertising mail to households. Merchants continue to send the largest volumes; in 2017, they sent 33 percent of Marketing Mail advertising mail and 18 percent of First-Class advertising mail. Financial firms are the second largest sender of both Marketing Mail and First-Class Mail advertising (41 and 26 percent respectively).

Figure 5.2:
Advertising Volumes for First-Class and Marketing Mail Advertising by Sender Type



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017

Attitudes toward Advertising

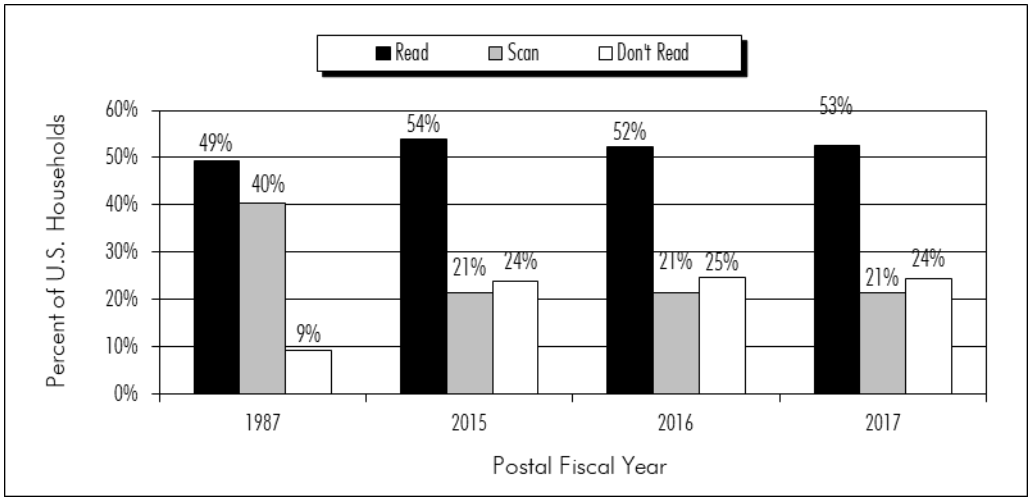
With $210 billion spent in the United States on advertising, few households would probably wish they received more.

Whether they wish to receive more or not, most households either read or at least scan their advertising mail. Figure 5.3 shows that, in 2017, 53 percent of households read their advertising mail, while an additional 21 percent scanned their mail. Twenty-four percent of households report they do not usually read their advertising mail, a substantial increase from the nine percent who did not usually read advertising mail in 1987.

However, given the large increase in advertising mail volumes since then, it is clear that U.S. households read more advertising mail now than in the past.

Seventy four percent of households either read or scan advertising mail received.

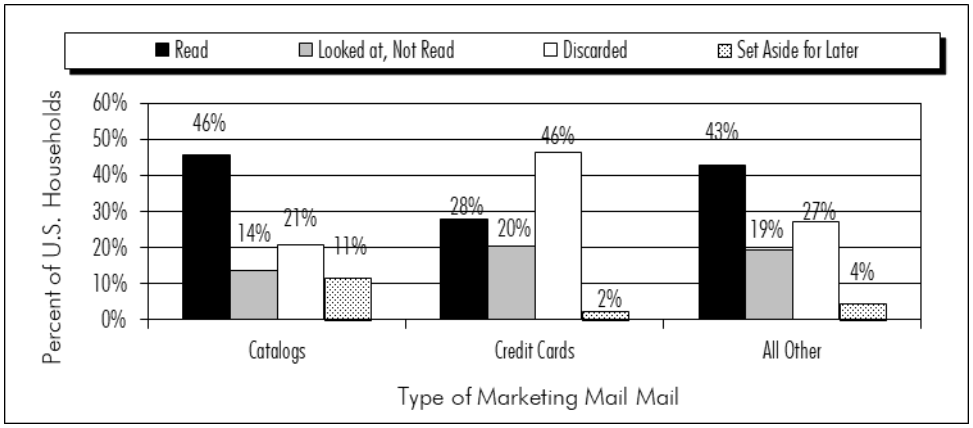
Figure 5.3:
Advertising Mail Behavioral Trends, FY 1987, 2015, 2016, and 2017



Source: HDS Recruitment Sample, FY 1987, 2015, 2016, and 2017.
Note: Percentages do not include those who did not provide a response.

Interestingly, the survey shows that not all advertising is treated equally. Figure 5.4 shows that catalogs attract more attention than credit card advertising, as they are usually more interesting to read. Forty-six percent of households read catalogs, and only 21 percent discard them without reading them. In contrast, 28 percent of households read credit card advertising and 46 percent discard them without reading them.

Figure 5.4:
Treatment of Marketing Mail Advertising by Type



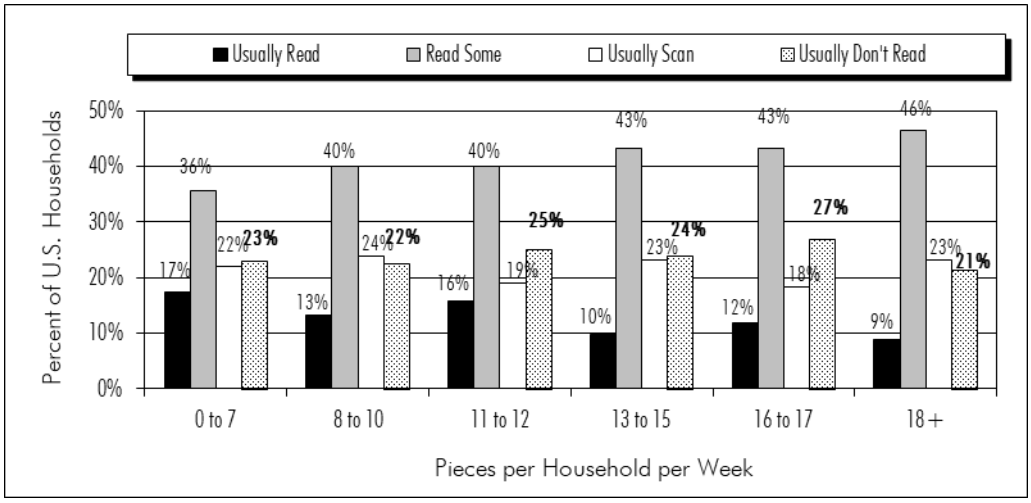
Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.
Note: Percentages do not include those who did not provide a response.

Another interesting result is found in Figure 5.5. Household behavior toward advertising mail is dependent on how much advertising mail the household receives. For example, among households that receive zero to seven pieces of advertising mail per week, 17 percent usually read all the mail and 36 percent only read some of it. Among households that receive eighteen or more pieces per week, only 9 percent usually read all the mail and 46% only read some of it.

Thus, households that receive more advertising mail than others appear to be "turned off" by the high volume. However, Figure 5.5 also shows that about 50

percent of households usually read all or some of their mail, a percentage that is unaffected by volume received. Additionally, the percent of households that usually don't read their advertising mail is about the same regardless of how much mail the household receives.

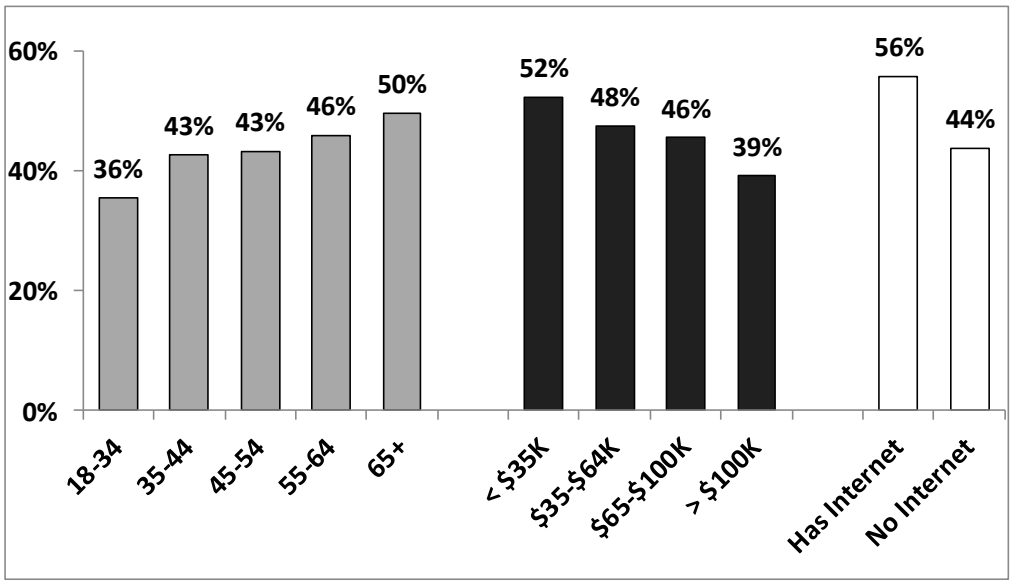
Figure 5.5:
Treatment of Advertising Mail by Number of Marketing Mail Pieces Received per Week



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

As Figure 5.6 shows, household demographics can have a substantial impact on advertising mail's reading rates. Lower income households tend to read more advertising mail, probably because they typically receive less mail than their wealthier counterparts, With respect to age, because older heads of households generally read more than younger ones, they also tend to read more advertising mail. Finally, Figure 5.6 shows that households with an Internet connection read more than households without one. This is probably because internet households tend to be wealthier and more educated, both of which are associated with higher reading rates.

Figure 5.6:
Advertising Mail Reading Rates by Household Demographics - FY 2017



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Effectiveness of Advertising Mail

Ultimately, advertisers send direct mail because it works—household members read and respond to it. Table 5.10 presents the intended response of households to advertising mail. Households report they intend to respond to about 12 percent of First-Class advertising mail and 11 percent of Marketing Mail. While these intended response rates are usually higher than actual response rates, the data demonstrate the impact that direct mail can have on household purchasing behavior. Table 5.10 also shows that households say they may respond to another 15 percent of Marketing Mail advertising and 12 percent of First-Class advertising. This is not to say that a similar mail piece would receive a higher response rate if mailed via Marketing Mail; it is more likely the result of a different mix of advertising material in Marketing Mail. For example, catalogs, which typically enjoy a high response rate (linked to the high read rate shown in Figure 5.4), are routinely mailed Marketing Mail but are infrequently mailed First-Class. Credit card advertising pieces, on the other hand, have the lowest response rate (linked to the lowest read rate shown in Figure 5.4) and are often mailed First-Class.

Figure 5.7 presents the total number of intended responses to advertising mail by income. As illustrated earlier in Tables 5.4 and 5.5, higher-income households received more advertising mail. Figure 5.6 combines the data on the amount of advertising mail received by household income with the household's intended response to the mail. The result is the average number of intended responses per week for each income level. For example, households with incomes greater than $150,000 report they intend to respond to 1.7 pieces of advertising mail per week, and they may respond to another 2.5 pieces per week. Other high-income households also indicated they will respond to more than one piece of advertising mail per week, as do some of the lower-income households.

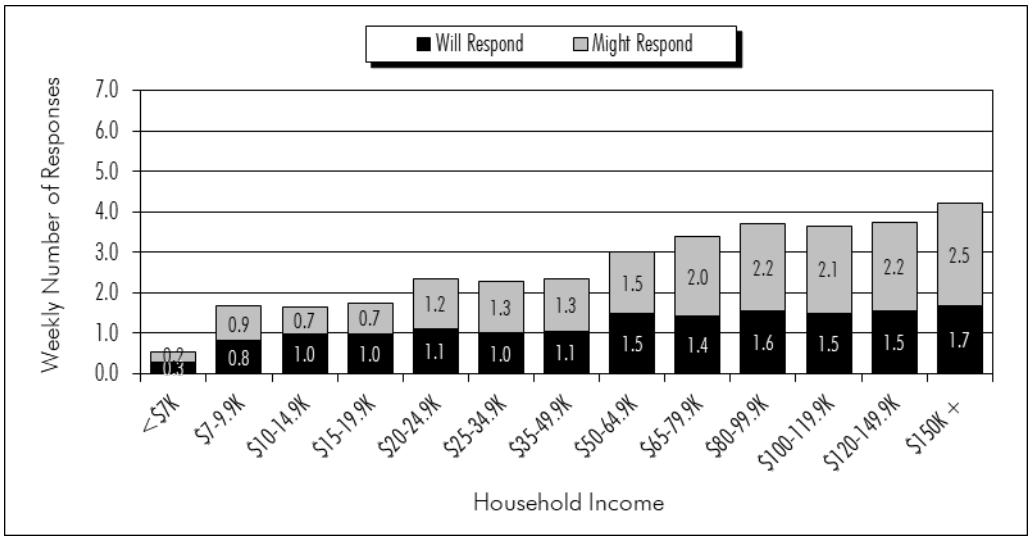
While intended responses do not always lead to actual responses, the data presented in Table 5.10 and Figure 5.7 help explain why direct mail is such a popular choice of advertisers in America. Although there is no completely equivalent measure for intended response to Internet ads, the click-through rate (the percentage of online visitors who viewed an ad and also clicked on it) is widely used as an indicator of consumers' interest in online ads. As such, it is somewhat comparable to mail ads' read rates. Based on published reports, the average click-through rate for Internet advertising is less than 3 percent. Overall read rates for mail ads, on the other hand, have averaged about 50 percent (as shown earlier in Figure 5.5).

Table 5.10:
Intended Response to Advertising Mail by Class
(Percentage of Pieces)

Response	First-Class	Marketing Mail
Yes	12%	11%
Maybe	12%	15%
No	65%	67%
No Answer	11%	7%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Figure 5.7:
Weekly Number of Intended Responses by Income



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Chapter 6: Periodicals

Introduction

This chapter examines periodicals sent to households. Periodical Mail consists of newspapers or magazines regularly sent to households, usually as part of a subscription. This chapter analyzes only periodicals delivered by the Postal Service to households. Newspapers or magazines delivered by a local carrier or purchased at a newsstand or store are not included in Household Diary Study data. The volumes examined here are only a portion of the total periodicals volume, since some of periodicals are received by non-households, such as doctors' offices or other businesses.

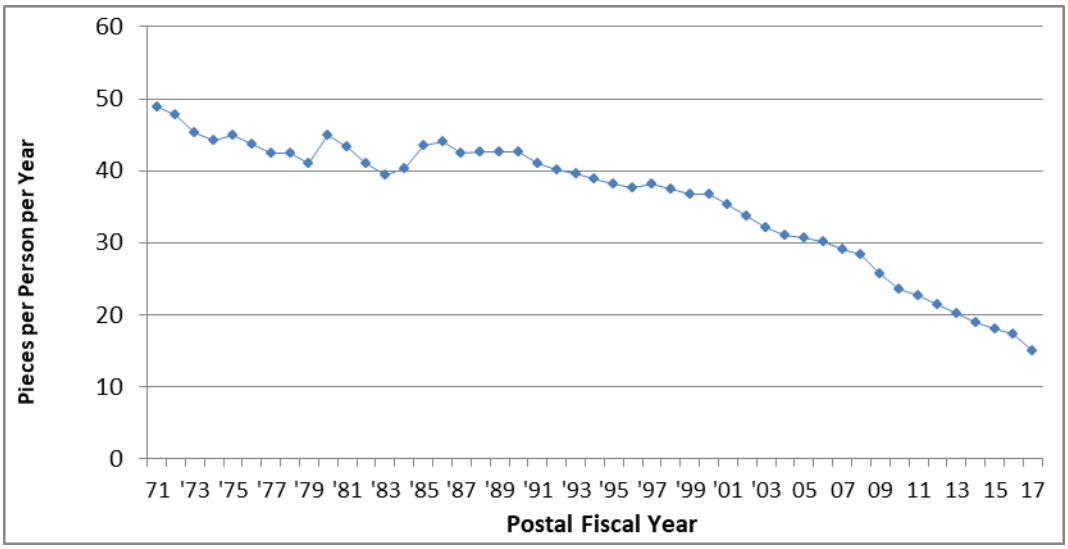
Since the early 2000's the Internet has become a major substitute for hard-copy publications.

The Periodicals Market

Historically, Periodical Mail volume has not kept pace with population growth, as seen in Figure 6.1. Since the 1990s, as demographics and technology changed, people began to read less printed materials. Periodical volumes reached a peak in 1990 at 10.7 billion pieces, but have declined each year since then, with the exception of FY 2000. In that year, the periodical industry was temporarily buoyed by an influx of advertising revenue during the dot-com boom.

After the recession that began in 2001, periodicals volume slipped not only because of reduced subscriptions, but also because of the number of publications that ceased operation as their sources of advertising revenue dried up. Since then, in addition to a general demographic shift away from reading, periodicals volume continued to decline as the Internet became an increasingly preferred substitute for hard-copy publications. Since 2008, the decline was further aggravated by the impact of the severe recession and the weak recovery that followed.

Figure 6.1:
Periodicals Mail Volume per Person, 1971-2017
(Annual Pieces per Person)



Source: U.S. Postal Service RPW Reports, U.S. Census Bureau.

Advertising's Impact on Periodicals

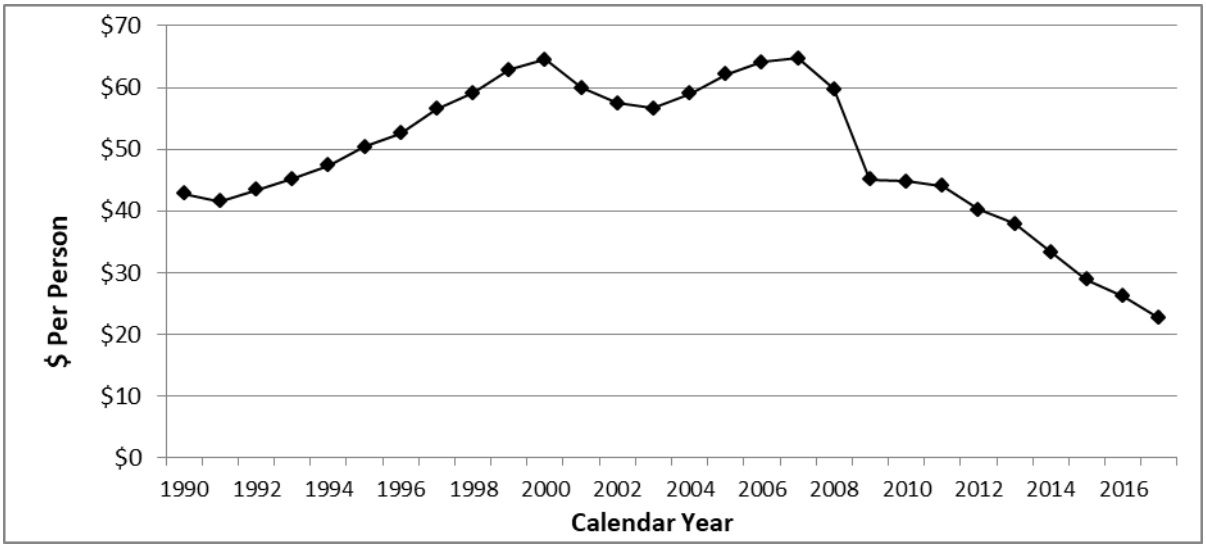
Advertising spending translates into advertising revenue, and the key determinant of periodicals profitability is advertising revenue.

Advertising is a form of business investment. As with other investments, when the economy takes a turn for the worse, advertising tends to slow. By 2000, total advertising as a percent of Gross Domestic Product (GDP) rose to a historically high level; when the high-tech bubble burst, advertising crashed. In 2002, albeit at a slower pace, total advertising spending resumed its growth, and, after six years of economic expansion, reached a new record high. After 2006, however, advertising spending suffered its largest decline in history and, by 2009, fell more than 20 percent. Since 2009, advertising spending increased 27 percent, aided by a slowly recovering economy. However, magazine advertising continued to decline albeit at a slower pace than during the recession.

Figure 6.2 shows the sharp decline in real per capita advertising spending for magazines that started in 2001 due to the recession. Annual spending growth resumed in 2004 but only lasted two years. The recession, which started in 2007, sent magazine advertising plummeting to the lowest level in decades, drastically shrinking the revenues and profitability of the magazine industry. Since 2009 spending decreased an additional 50 percent.

Pivotal Research Group projects that total advertising spending will continue to grow. As the economy moves into a stronger recovery, it typically would encourage advertising spending, which, in turn, should bode well for magazines and volume for the Postal Service, since, for most titles, the mail remains the primary distribution channel. The Internet, however, has absorbed a rapidly growing share of total advertising spending, leaving sharply smaller budgets for periodicals. With the Internet providing a much more convenient, faster, and cheaper alternative channel for news, information, and entertainment, periodical are expected to continue declining, regardless of the state of the economy.

Figure 6.2:
Real Per-Capita Magazine Advertising Spending, 1990-2017



Source: Pivotal Research Group, U.S. Census Bureau.

Household Periodicals Volume

As shown in Table E.2 of the Executive Summary, periodicals represent 3.9 percent of all household mail volumes. Table E.2 also shows that the volume of periodicals declined 4 percent compared to 2016. In FY 2017, households received 4.9 billion periodicals, compared to 5.1 billion in FY 2016.

Table 6.1 shows the breakdown of periodicals received by households. Sixty-seven percent of all periodicals received by households were magazines. In contrast, in 1987, the share of magazines was 59 percent.

In 2017, households received an average of 0.5 magazines per week. The most common type of magazine was monthly, accounting for 80 percent of total magazines. Newspapers made up 13 percent of total periodicals volume, down from a share of 35 percent in 1987. The number of newspapers received per household each week declined from 0.6 in 1987 to only 0.1 in 2017, while magazines declined from 1.0 to 0.5 pieces per week.

The decline in newspapers captured in the Household Diary Study mirrors the behavior seen in overall newspaper circulation.

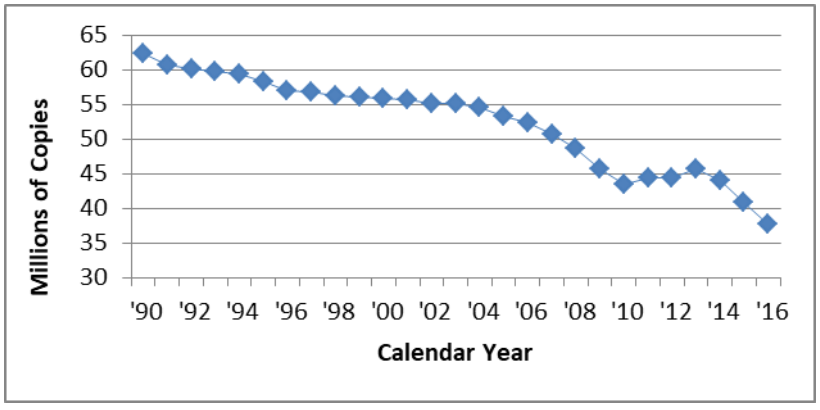
As shown in Figure 6.3, newspaper circulation in general has declined 40% since 1990. Of course, on a per capita basis, the decline is even more pronounced.

Table 6.1:
Periodical Type by Year
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Periodical Type	1987	2016	2017
Newspapers	**0.6**	**0.1**	**0.1**
Daily	0.2	0.0	0.0
Weekly	0.3	0.1	0.1
Other	0.1	0.0	0.0
Magazines	**1.0**	**0.6**	**0.5**
Weekly	0.3	0.1	0.1
Monthly	0.6	0.4	0.4
Other	0.1	0.1	0.1
Unclassified	**0.1**	**0.1**	**0.1**
Total Periodicals	**1.7**	**0.78**	**0.75**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 1987, 2016, and 2017.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Figure 6.3:
Newspaper Circulation, 1970-2016*



Source: Newspaper Association of America.
Data only available through 2016.

Declining newspaper circulation is not the only contributor to falling newspapers volumes received via mail. With current technology and alternate delivery systems, national newspapers, such as the *Wall Street Journal* and *The New York Times*, deliver their papers to prime urban and suburban household customers before breakfast. Local printing/ distribution and morning delivery mean these copies of these publications no longer move through the mail.

Periodicals Mail and Household Characteristics

Households with incomes above $100,000 receive twice as many periodicals as households earning less than $35,000.

Income, Education, and Age

Table 6.2 shows that as income and education increase, periodicals volume tends to increase. Households in which the head of the household has a college education receive the most periodicals, averaging 0.8 per week. Similarly, households with an income above $100,000 receive an average of 1.0 periodicals per week, twice what households earning less than $35,000 receive.

Table 6.3 shows periodicals volume by age and income. The higher the income and age of the household, the higher the volume of periodicals received. For households whose heads are under 34 years old and with incomes less than $35,000, the average is only 0.2 pieces per week. Households with income above $100,000 and whose heads are over 55 receive the most periodicals, with 1.4 pieces per week.

Table 6.2:
Periodicals by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	0.6	0.6	0.4	0.4	0.5
$35 to $65	1.3	0.7	0.6	0.7	0.7
$65 to $100	0.1	0.9	0.9	0.8	0.8
Over $100	1.4	0.6	0.9	1.0	1.0
Average	0.7	0.7	0.7	0.8	0.7

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Table 6.3:
Periodicals by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 34	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	0.2	0.4	0.8	0.6
$35 to $65	0.3	0.5	1.1	0.8
$65 to $100	0.3	0.6	1.1	0.8
Over $100	0.5	0.8	1.4	1.1
Average	0.3	0.6	1.1	0.7

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Household Size

Table 6.4 and Table 6.5 show that as households increase in size from one to two persons, periodicals volume increases. Households with more than two persons on average receive about the same number of periodicals as one-person households. In households with two adults, periodicals volume is higher than in one-person households. The presence of additional adults beyond two has a negligent effect on receiving periodicals.

Table 6.4:
Periodicals by Size of Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Size	
One person	0.7
Two	0.9
Three	0.6
Four	0.7
Five or more	0.6
Average	**0.7**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Table 6.5:
Periodicals by Number of Adults in Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Number of Adults	
One	0.6
Two	0.8
Three or more	0.7
Average	**0.7**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Internet Access

As shown in Table 6.6, wired households received less periodicals through the mail. Households' access to Broadband tend to receive most periodical content electronically, rather than by mail. The now widespread adoptions of e-readers likely contributed further to the reduction in the number of periodicals moving through the mail.

Table 6.6:
Periodicals by Type of Internet Access
(Pieces per Household per Week)

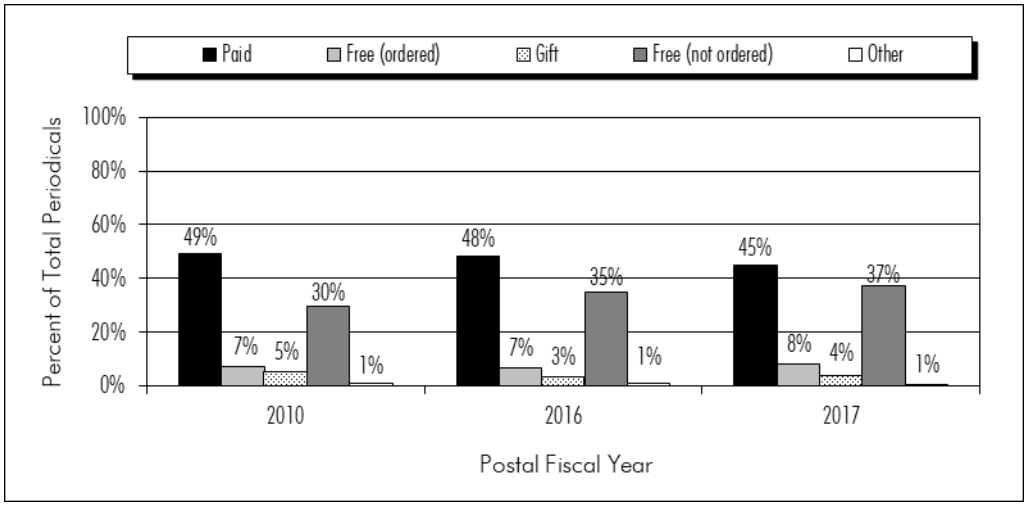
Type of Internet Access	
Broadband	0.7
Dial-up	1.0
None	0.8
Average	**0.7**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Subscription Type

Figure 6.5 provides an overview of subscription types for FY 2010, FY 2016, and FY 2017. As shown, the distribution of subscription types has remained relatively stable over the last two years and similar to the 2010 distribution. In 2017, a household member ordered and paid for 45 percent of total periodicals sent to households. An additional 45 percent were free—either ordered by a household member or delivered to the household without a freestanding order, for example, as a prerogative of membership in a professional, fraternal, or religious organization.

Figure 6.5:
Subscription Type by Year



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2010, 2016, and 2017.
Note: Percentages do not add to 100 due to the exclusion of periodicals not classified by subscription type.

Examining periodical volumes by sender type shows that commercial organizations sent by far more than any individual member organization (79%). Member organizations are professional affiliations; charitable, religious, and veterans' organizations, educational groups, and unions.

As shown in Table 6.7, member organizations, when combined, account for 20 percent of total periodicals received by households.

Table 6.7:
Periodicals by Sender Type

Sender Type	Pieces per Household per Week	Percent of Periodicals Received by HH
Commercial Organization	.59	79%
Professional Organization	.07	9%
Religious Organization	.03	4%
Educational Organization	.03	4%
Union	.01	2%
Charitable Organization	.01	1%
Veterans' Organization	.01	1%
Unclassified	.01	1%
Total	.75	100%

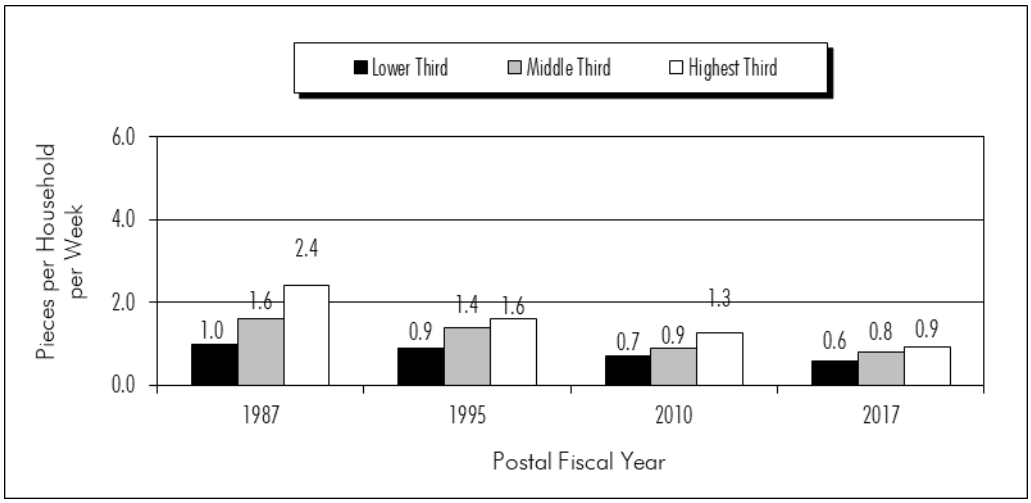
Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Volume Drivers

A number of factors influence a household's receipt of periodicals. Several of these variables are demographic, while others are more behavioral in nature. Income seems to influence volume strongly, since periodicals are usually received through a paid subscription.

Typically, higher-income households subscribe to more magazines and newspapers. In 2017, the number of periodicals per household continued its long-term decline for all income groups (Figure 6.6).

Figure 6.6:
Number of Periodicals Received per Week by Households by Income Group



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 1987, 1995, 2010, and 2017.

Chapter 7: Packages

Introduction

This chapter discusses packages sent and received by households. Packages can be mailed via the U.S. Postal Service at a variety of rates; for example, packages can be sent as Priority Mail, First-Class Mail, Media Mail, or Standard Post; documents are usually sent as First-Class Mail, Priority Mail, or Express Mail, while product samples are generally sent as Marketing Mail.

The Package Market

The package delivery market is an important segment of the economy. There are three major segments of the package market:

- Overnight air,
- Two- and three-day air, and
- Ground.

The U.S. Postal Service is a major player in the two- and three-day air segment but provides services in all: Priority Mail Express in the overnight segment, Priority and First-Class Mail in the two- and three-day segment, and Parcel Select, Standard Mail and Package Services in the ground segment.

Postal Service Package Volume

Compared to other mail, like letters and flats, the number of packages captured in the Household Diary Study is small, as most people do not receive packages on a regular basis. The interpretation of the results should be conducted with this in mind.

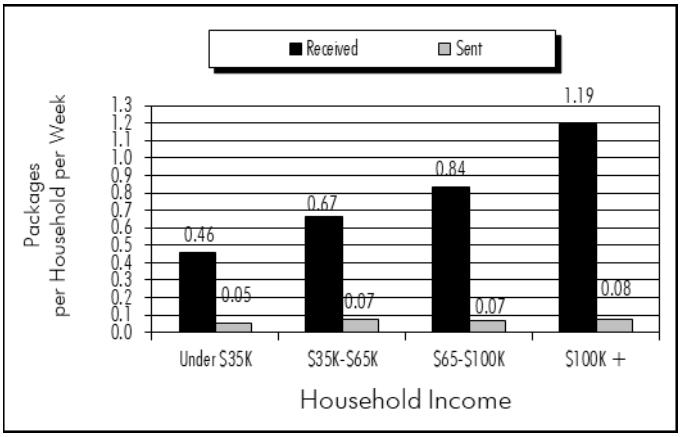
Packages and Household Characteristics

Income, Education, and Age

According to the HDS, high-income households received more packages than their less affluent counterparts in FY 2017, as shown in Figure 7.1.

In fact, households in the highest income bracket received more than twice the number of packages received by households with incomes below $35,000.. The age of the heads of household was another factor influencing the number of packages received. As shown in Table 7.1, heads of household in the mid age range (35 to 54 years old) received more packages than both the younger and older age groups. This may be the case because heads of household in the 35 to 54 age group typically have more disposable income. When it comes to sending packages, Table 7.2 shows that those in the mid age range also sent more packages than the other two age groups. In each income categories, however, the age of heads of households did not show a clear correlation with the number of packages sent or received.

Figure 7.1:
Postal Service Sent and Received Packages by Household Income
(Pieces per Household per Week)



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.
Base: Packages Sent and Received by Households and Delivered by U.S. Postal Service.

Table 7.1:
Postal Service Received Packages by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 35	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	0.33	0.47	0.52	0.46
$35 to $65	0.52	0.68	0.74	0.67
$65 to $100	0.87	0.84	0.81	0.84
Over $100	1.25	1.20	1.15	1.19
Average	0.70	0.83	0.75	0.77

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Table 7.2:
Postal Service Sent Packages by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of head of Household			Average
	Under 35	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	0.03	0.06	0.06	0.05
$35 to $65	0.09	0.09	0.05	0.07
$65 to $100	0.03	0.07	0.08	0.07
Over $100	0.03	0.11	0.07	0.08
Average	0.05	0.08	0.07	0.07

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

The Household Diary Study indicates that households whose heads have college degrees tend to receive and send more packages on average than households with lower educational attainment. These results are shown in Tables 7.3 and 7.4.

Table 7.3:
Postal Service Received Packages by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Education of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	0.57	0.37	0.38	0.62	0.45
$35 to $65	0.84	0.60	0.56	0.77	0.63
$65 to $100	0.45	0.81	0.87	0.89	0.80
Over $100	0.90	1.21	1.23	1.19	1.13
Average	0.59	0.65	0.69	0.92	0.77

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Table 7.4:
Postal Service Sent Packages by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Education of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	0.00	0.03	0.05	0.12	0.05
$35 to $65	0.12	0.08	0.03	0.09	0.07
$65 to $100	0.04	0.05	0.06	0.09	0.07
Over $100	0.00	0.06	0.09	0.08	0.08
Average	0.02	0.06	0.06	0.09	0.07

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Household Size

The Household Diary Study shows that larger households and those with more adults tend to receive and, in most cases, send more packages than smaller households, as shown in Table 7.5 and 7.6.

Table 7.5:
Postal Service Received and Sent Packages
by Size of Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Size	Received	Sent
One person	0.48	0.07
Two	0.81	0.07
Three	0.81	0.07
Four	1.01	0.10
Five or more	0.92	0.04
Average	0.77	0.07

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Table 7.6:
Postal Service Received and Sent Packages
by Number of Adults in Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Number of Adults	Received	Sent
One	0.49	0.06
Two	0.86	0.08
Three or more	0.92	0.05
Average	0.77	0.07

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Internet Access

Access to the Internet seems to play an important part in determining the number of packages received by households. Table 7.7 shows the packages sent and received by households with and without Internet access. In FY 2017, households with Broadband received and sent more than two times as many packages as households without Internet access. This relationship reflects the correlation between income, education, and Internet access.

In FY 2017, households with Internet access received and sent more than two times as many packages as households without Internet access.

Table 7.7:
Received and Sent Packages
by Household Internet Access
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Type of Internet Access	Received	Sent
Broadband	0.82	0.08
Dial-up	0.72	0.03
None	0.34	0.02
Average	0.77	0.07

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2017.

Table 7.8 shows the impact of online shopping activity on the number of packages households send and receive; in both cases, the difference is quite significant. Online-shopping households sent and received more than twice as many packages as those who did not shop online.

Table 7.8:
Received and Sent Packages
by Household Online Shopping Behavior
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Shopping Online?	Received	Sent
YES	0.83	0.08
NO	0.33	0.04

Household Package Contents

As shown in Table 7.9, packages received by households most often contain music/videos, pharmaceuticals, clothing, books, and household products—a sign that online purchases and mail-order retail are the primary drivers of household package volume.

Households also send more music, videos and clothes, than other types of content. This is primarily due to the high volume of household packages sent during the holiday season; however, this may also be evidence of the growing use of online sales and auction portals, such as eBay.

Table 7.9:
Contents of Postal Service Sent and Received Packages

Contents	Volume (Millions of Pieces)					
	2015		2016		2017	
	Sent	Received	Sent	Received	Sent	Received
Music/Video	248	492	179	362	200	341
Pharmaceuticals/Contacts	14	530	18	620	23	655
Clothing	135	877	115	1,101	100	1,199
Books	51	437	48	471	19	470
Household/Kitchen/Lawn and garden products	11	404	12	480	10	625
Electronic equipment	26	202	26	228	17	276
Computer hardware, software, or accessories	21	165	17	145	17	178
Food Products	1	201	0	187	0	195
Toys	16	154	14	229	9	182
Cosmetics/Beauty products/Toiletries	28	193	1	285	7	384
Checkbooks	0	80	0	50	0	66
Photos/Film	2	71	1	51	2	71
Travel products and information	0	87	14	64	2	65
Other Contents	44	888	77	1,045	50	1,016
Total Packages	834	4,230	691	4,652	610	5,042

Table 7.9:
Contents of Postal Service Sent and Received Packages (cont.)

Contents	Percent of Pieces					
	2015		2016		2017	
	Sent	Received	Sent	Received	Sent	Received
Music/Video	30%	12%	26%	8%	33%	7%
Pharmaceuticals/Contacts	2%	13%	3%	13%	4%	13%
Books	6%	10%	7%	10%	3%	9%
Clothing	16%	21%	17%	24%	16%	24%
Household/Kitchen/Lawn and garden products	1%	10%	2%	10%	2%	12%
Electronic equipment	3%	5%	4%	5%	3%	5%
Toys	2%	4%	2%	5%	2%	4%
Cosmetics/Beauty products/Toiletries	3%	5%	0%	6%	1%	8%
Checkbooks	0%	2%	0%	1%	0%	1%
Food Products	0%	5%	0%	4%	0%	4%
Computer hardware, software, or accessories	3%	4%	2%	3%	3%	4%
Photos/Film	0%	2%	0%	1%	0%	1%
Travel products and information	0%	2%	2%	1%	0%	1%
Other Contents	5%	21%	11%	22%	8%	20%
Total Packages	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2015, 2016, and 2017.
Notes:
Contents questions are multiple response; as such, total packages does not equal the sum for each column.
Does not include contents for which no answer was given (DK/RF).
Music/Video packages include 0.4 billion pieces of CD/DVDs sent and received, reported in First-Class Mail letters in Tables E.1, 1.5, and 1.6

Appendix A8: Annual Trends

Table A8-1
First Class Mail Received by Type
Pieces in Millions
Years 2000 - 2017 (Diary Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
Correspondence																		
Personal	7,211	7,456	7,154	6,457	6,561	5,870	6,079	5,610	5,646	5,225	4,855	4,301	4,266	3,895	3,603	3,249	3,157	3,141
Greeting Cards	4,052	4,472	4,456	3,816	4,014	3,586	3,935	3,571	3,652	3,368	3,278	3,083	3,069	2,767	2,562	2,251	2,243	2,269
Letter from Friend or Relative	1,769	1,839	1,629	1,467	1,385	1,227	1,138	1,116	1,046	956	837	701	693	652	592	588	493	516
Other Personal	1,391	1,145	1,070	1,174	1,161	1,057	1,006	923	948	901	740	517	505	477	449	410	421	356
Business/Government	9,678	10,501	11,081	10,530	10,552	10,965	10,142	10,631	10,061	9,504	9,234	10,596	10,691	10,251	10,644	10,650	10,889	10,881
Notice/ Announcement/ Business Invitation	4,336	5,052	5,546	6,608	6,901	6,640	5,969	6,340	5,693	4,493	4,297	4,403	4,748	4,518	4,905	5,116	5,051	5,055
Tax-Related (Docs, information, forms)	0	0	0	0	0	354	383	513	570	613	526	1,001	991	998	1,062	983	1,174	1,095
Insurance[3]	1,159	1,241	1,390	1,291	1,330	1,438	1,410	1,154	1,156	1,430	1,450	2,498	2,308	2,326	2,468	2,283	2,221	2,337
Other Bus/Gov	4,183	4,208	4,145	2,631	2,321	2,532	2,380	2,624	2,642	2,969	2,961	2,695	2,644	2,409	2,209	2,268	2,442	2,394
Social	2,581	2,570	2,664	2,692	2,336	2,387	2,274	2,579	2,380	2,066	1,905	1,384	1,355	1,350	1,161	1,105	1,098	1,013
Notice/ Announcement/ Business Invitation	1,674	1,753	2,084	2,446	2,049	1,866	1,793	2,232	1,674	1,382	1,351	752	773	723	645	608	535	487
Other Social	907	817	580	247	287	520	481	348	706	683	554	632	582	627	516	497	563	526
Total	19,470	20,527	20,899	19,680	19,449	19,222	18,495	18,820	18,087	16,795	15,995	16,281	16,311	15,497	15,408	15,004	15,144	15,036
Transactions																		
Bills	12,465	13,035	13,586	13,732	13,708	13,561	13,367	13,222	13,148	12,429	11,274	11,347	10,824	10,815	10,412	10,219	9,852	9,124
Financial Statements	5,780	7,205	6,492	6,109	6,152	6,272	6,643	6,809	6,294	6,387	5,418	4,655	4,744	4,285	4,514	4,204	3,994	4,056
Credit Card Statement/Bill	2,948	4,423	4,279	4,304	3,924	4,311	4,969	4,980	4,830	4,687	4,091	3,834	4,023	3,454	3,690	3,623	3,742	3,518
Request for donation	947	875	797	729	634	636	708	733	754	617	660	755	687	652	609	596	524	501
Payment/Check/Credit	1,481	1,679	1,635	1,618	1,552	1,437	1,439	1,418	1,324	1,378	1,194	1,009	993	1,055	998	1,039	895	896
Other	893	540	605	504	512	588	544	752	778	677	626	1,307	1,230	1,252	1,131	1,200	1,276	1,140
Total	24,514	27,758	27,393	26,997	26,483	26,805	27,669	27,914	27,128	26,175	23,263	22,906	22,501	21,512	21,355	20,881	20,283	19,236
Advertising (Ads Only)	9,471	11,153	11,045	10,221	9,259	10,782	10,344	9,034	8,257	6,648	6,115	5,448	5,021	4,240	3,925	3,593	3,826	3,713
CD/DVD/Video Games[1]	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	640	806	937	942	1,040	543	466	374	312	217	212
DK/RF[2]	3,350	1,073	1,192	1,972	2,080	1,974	2,915	2,449	2,971	2,569	3,748	2,598	2,828	2,426	1,768	1,610	1,811	1,637
Total First-Class Received	56,805	60,512	60,529	58,869	57,270	58,783	59,423	58,856	57,250	53,123	50,063	48,272	47,204	44,142	42,830	41,400	41,280	39,833

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to weighing by Home Ownership. Starting in 2015, fewer age and education categories are used in weighting, and the weights are trimmed so that no weight is greater than 5 and no weight is less than 0.2.

Note: Transaction and Correspondence definitions redefined to match calculation in HDS main report.

[1] CD/DVD/Video Games not collected as a separate category prior to 2007.

[2] Combination of Correspondence and Transactions (Purpose is unknown)

[3] Some mail reported as bills and statements in the 2000-2010 Household Diary Study were reclassified as insurance explanations of benefits

Table A8-2
Shares of First Class Mail Received by Type
Years 2000 - 2017 (Diary Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
Correspondence																		
Personal	13%	12%	12%	11%	11%	10%	10%	10%	10%	10%	10%	9%	9%	9%	8%	8%	8%	8%
Greeting Cards	7%	7%	7%	6%	7%	6%	7%	6%	6%	6%	7%	6%	7%	6%	6%	5%	5%	6%
Letter from Friend or Relative	3%	3%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Other Personal	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Business/Government	17%	17%	18%	18%	18%	19%	17%	18%	18%	18%	18%	22%	23%	23%	25%	26%	26%	27%
Notice/ Announcement/ Business Invitation	8%	8%	9%	11%	12%	11%	10%	11%	10%	8%	9%	9%	10%	10%	11%	12%	12%	13%
Tax-Related (Docs, information, forms)	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	3%
Insurance	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	3%	5%	5%	5%	6%	6%	5%	6%
Other Bus/Gov	7%	7%	7%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	5%	6%	6%	6%	6%	5%	5%	5%	6%	6%
Social	5%	4%	4%	5%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%
Notice/ Announcement/ Business Invitation	3%	3%	3%	4%	4%	3%	3%	4%	3%	3%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%
Other Social	2%	1%	1%	0%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Total	34%	34%	35%	33%	34%	33%	31%	32%	32%	32%	32%	34%	35%	35%	36%	36%	37%	38%
Transactions																		
Bills	22%	22%	22%	23%	24%	23%	22%	22%	23%	23%	23%	24%	23%	24%	24%	25%	24%	23%
Financial Statements	10%	12%	11%	10%	11%	11%	11%	12%	11%	12%	11%	10%	10%	10%	11%	10%	10%	10%
Credit Card Statement/Bill	5%	7%	7%	7%	7%	7%	8%	8%	8%	9%	8%	8%	9%	8%	9%	9%	9%	9%
Request for donation	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Payment/Check/Credit	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	2%	2%
Other	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%
Total	43%	46%	45%	46%	46%	46%	47%	47%	47%	49%	46%	47%	48%	49%	50%	50%	49%	48%
Advertising (Ads Only)	17%	18%	18%	17%	16%	18%	17%	15%	14%	13%	12%	11%	11%	10%	9%	9%	9%	9%
CD/DVD/Video Games [1]	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	1%	1%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
DK/RF [2]	6%	2%	2%	3%	4%	3%	5%	4%	5%	5%	7%	5%	6%	5%	4%	4%	4%	4%
Total First-Class Received	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Note: Transaction and Correspondence definitions redefined to match calculation in HDS main report.

[1] CD/DVD/Video Games not collected as a separate category prior to 2007.

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to weighing by Home Ownership. Starting in 2015, fewer age and education categories are used in weighting, and the weights are trimmed so that no weight is greater than 5 and no weight is less than 0.2.

Table A8-3
First Class Mail Sent by type
Pieces in Millions
Years 2000 - 2017 (Diary Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
Correspondence																		
Personal	6,680	7,135	7,154	6,457	6,561	5,870	6,232	5,811	5,646	5,225	4,234	3,547	3,631	3,647	3,160	3,274	2,810	2,475
Greeting Cards	3,818	4,561	4,223	3,958	4,332	4,010	4,294	3,887	3,648	3,496	2,834	2,572	2,705	2,652	2,261	2,263	2,138	1,819
Letter to Friend or Relative	1,915	1,740	1,974	1,561	1,513	1,071	1,240	1,250	1,021	1,120	798	636	667	675	561	678	461	410
Other Personal	947	833	957	938	715	789	699	675	978	609	602	340	259	320	338	332	211	246
Business/Government	2,317	2,081	2,218	1,700	1,747	1,744	1,652	1,679	1,600	1,550	1,094	1,209	1,195	1,106	1,067	1,185	1,080	965
Social	515	387	368	351	420	375	382	453	483	361	263	209	183	163	176	148	157	121
Total	9,512	9,603	9,740	8,508	8,728	7,989	8,266	7,944	7,729	7,136	5,591	4,965	5,009	4,916	4,403	4,607	4,047	3,561
Transactions																		
Bill Payment[2]	8,037	9,697	9,705	10,104	9,801	8,970	8,734	8,365	6,995	6,494	5,632	5,517	5,098	4,513	4,470	4,383	3,753	3,347
Orders/Rebate request	853	734	774	739	734	769	612	560	537	454	279	359	321	247	249	224	189	189
Donations	578	572	574	536	598	560	524	550	657	521	345	355	391	330	332	288	286	260
Total	9,468	11,002	11,054	11,379	11,133	10,300	9,869	9,475	8,189	7,469	6,257	6,231	5,810	5,089	5,051	4,894	4,228	3,796
CD/DVD/Video Games[1]	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	540	774	932	700	758	380	360	318	218	174	168
DK/RF[3]	361	1,701	1,982	1,176	1,185	1,013	824	966	1,353	667	772	881	788	498	634	368	729	559
Total First-Class Sent	19,341	22,306	22,776	21,062	21,046	19,302	18,958	18,924	18,046	16,204	13,319	12,834	11,987	10,863	10,406	10,087	9,178	8,084

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to weighing by Home Ownership. Starting in 2015, fewer age and education categories are used in weighting, and the weights are trimmed so that no weight is greater than 5 and no weight is less than 0.2.

[1] CD/DVD/Video Games not collected as a separate category prior to 2007.

[2] Payments were restated 2000-2009 (not adjusted)

[3] Combination of Correspondence and Transactions (Purpose is unknown)

Table A8-4
Shares of First Class Mail Sent by type
Years 2000 - 2017 (Diary Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
Correspondence																		
Personal	35%	32%	31%	31%	31%	30%	33%	31%	31%	32%	32%	28%	30%	34%	30%	32%	31%	31%
Greeting Cards	20%	20%	19%	19%	21%	21%	23%	21%	20%	22%	21%	20%	23%	24%	22%	22%	23%	23%
Letter to Friend or Relative	10%	8%	9%	7%	7%	6%	7%	7%	6%	7%	6%	5%	6%	6%	5%	7%	5%	5%
Other Personal	5%	4%	4%	4%	3%	4%	4%	4%	5%	4%	5%	3%	2%	3%	3%	3%	2%	3%
Business/Government	12%	9%	10%	8%	8%	9%	9%	9%	9%	10%	8%	9%	10%	10%	10%	12%	12%	12%
Social	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	2%	1%
Total	49%	43%	43%	40%	41%	41%	44%	42%	43%	44%	42%	39%	42%	45%	42%	46%	44%	44%
Transactions																		
Bill Payment[2]	42%	43%	43%	48%	47%	46%	46%	44%	39%	40%	42%	43%	43%	42%	43%	43%	41%	41%
Orders	4%	3%	3%	4%	3%	4%	3%	3%	3%	3%	2%	3%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%
Donations	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	4%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%
Total	49%	49%	49%	54%	53%	53%	52%	50%	45%	46%	47%	49%	48%	47%	49%	49%	46%	47%
CD/DVD/Video Games[1]	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	3%	4%	6%	5%	6%	3%	3%	3%	2%	2%	2%
DK/RF	2%	8%	9%	6%	6%	5%	4%	5%	8%	4%	6%	7%	7%	5%	6%	4%	8%	7%
Total First-Class Sent	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to weighing by Home Ownership. Starting in 2015, fewer age and education categories are used in weighting, and the weights are trimmed so that no weight is greater than 5 and no weight is less than 0.2.

[1] CD/DVD/Video Games not collected as a separate category prior to 2007.

[2] Payments were restated 2000-2009 (not adjusted)

Table A8-5a
Bills and Statements Received
Pieces in Millions by Sender Type
Years 2000 - 2017 (Diary Data)

Payee	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
Financial																		
Credit Card	2,916	3,803	3,664	3,791	3,601	4,007	3,838	3,601	3,619	4,687	4,091	3,834	4,023	3,454	3,690	3,623	3,742	3,536
Bank, S&L, Credit Union	4,182	4,931	4,973	4,724	4,829	4,941	5,406	5,463	4,933	4,951	4,216	3,703	3,517	3,474	3,531	3,264	3,015	2,963
Insurance Company[1]	1,181	1,202	1,469	1,359	1,299	1,353	1,464	1,703	1,701	1,602	1,368	1,668	1,661	1,725	1,719	1,740	1,667	1,706
Real Estate/Mortgage	281	396	383	430	416	498	437	494	433	428	376	317	313	390	374	318	397	357
Other Financial	2,010	2,354	1,955	1,592	1,746	1,686	1,852	1,968	1,842	1,774	1,578	1,543	1,654	1,331	1,401	1,426	1,353	1,282
Total Financial	10,570	12,686	12,444	11,897	11,890	12,486	12,996	13,228	12,529	13,442	11,628	11,064	11,168	10,376	10,716	10,370	10,175	9,844
Merchants																		
Department Store	736	783	766	709	707	659	756	792	980	161	129	32	63	59	54	49	38	62
Publisher	629	609	578	533	499	553	490	489	409	387	300	327	290	275	202	210	158	147
Mail Order Company	385	352	292	223	284	159	200	216	157	137	139	101	88	71	77	94	65	49
Other Merchants	458	484	468	517	544	525	555	591	620	370	221	163	171	164	148	136	164	142
Total Merchants	2,207	2,229	2,103	1,981	2,035	1,895	2,001	2,086	2,166	1,055	790	623	612	569	482	488	424	399
Services																		
Telephone /Cable Company	2,701	3,189	3,278	3,505	3,291	3,260	3,318	3,016	2,967	2,670	2,287	2,436	2,367	2,134	2,050	1,821	1,730	1,637
Utility Company	2,031	2,494	2,555	2,618	2,702	2,602	2,566	2,657	2,730	2,591	2,444	2,494	2,329	2,416	2,304	2,433	2,335	2,387
Medical and Other Professional	1,900	2,023	2,014	2,221	2,099	2,079	2,200	2,224	2,108	2,269	2,299	2,069	1,936	1,947	2,026	1,846	1,953	1,576
Other Service	672	656	647	620	525	594	554	479	512	456	393	404	402	387	352	369	376	310
Total Service	7,304	8,362	8,494	8,965	8,617	8,534	8,637	8,376	8,317	7,986	7,423	7,403	7,035	6,884	6,731	6,469	6,395	5,911
Manufacturers	89	99	103	102	87	81	128	156	183	64	59	51	26	21	47	46	27	26
Government	604	978	835	920	838	872	907	844	793	718	671	501	530	520	470	493	386	389
Social	248	225	271	195	190	190	228	202	193	184	173	159	191	159	127	136	149	100
Other/Don't Know/Refused	171	84	108	86	128	86	80	120	91	54	38	35	29	25	45	43	32	29
Total – All Industries	21,194	24,664	24,357	24,146	23,785	24,144	24,978	25,011	24,272	23,503	20,783	19,836	19,591	18,554	18,617	18,046	17,589	16,698

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to weighing by Home Ownership. Starting in 2015, fewer age and education categories are used in weighting, and the weights are trimmed so that no weight is greater than 5 and no weight is less than 0.2.

[1] Some mail reported as bills and statements in the 2000-2010 Household Diary Study were reclassified as insurance explanations of benefits

Table A8-6
Shares of Bills Paid by Method
Years 2000 - 2017 (Recruitment Data)

Method	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
Mail	81%	80%	75%	73%	69%	67%	62%	60%	54%	50%	47%	44%	40%	36%	33%	30%	27%	29%
Internet using a Computer	2%	4%	4%	7%	10%	12%	15%	18%	25%	28%	29%	32%	33%	34%	36%	36%	36%	33%
Internet using Mobile Phone	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	1%	2%	3%	4%	7%	8%
Internet using Other Device	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	1%	2%	3%	6%	4%	3%
Auto Deduction from Bank	8%	8%	9%	9%	10%	11%	11%	11%	11%	12%	13%	13%	14%	14%	14%	15%	16%	16%
In Person	8%	7%	8%	7%	6%	6%	6%	5%	6%	5%	5%	5%	5%	4%	4%	4%	3%	4%
Credit Card	N/A	N/A	2%	2%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	4%	4%	4%	4%	5%	5%
Telephone	1%	2%	1%	2%	2%	2%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%
Total	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%
Total Electronic [1]	11%	13%	17%	20%	25%	28%	32%	35%	41%	45%	48%	51%	56%	60%	63%	66%	70%	68%

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to weighing by Home Ownership. Starting in 2015, fewer age and education categories are used in weighting, and the weights are trimmed so that no weight is greater than 5 and no weight is less than 0.2.

[1] Includes bills paid by Internet, Auto Deduction from Bank Account, Credit Card, and Telephone

Table A8-7
Shares of Households using Method of Paying Bills
Years 2000 - 2017 (Recruitment Data)

Method	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
Mail	94%	93%	94%	94%	94%	93%	92%	92%	89%	86%	83%	79%	78%	71%	68%	66%	65%	59%
Internet using a Computer	4%	8%	12%	16%	23%	28%	33%	37%	43%	47%	50%	55%	56%	59%	61%	61%	63%	55%
Internet using Mobile Phone	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	6%	10%	10%	13%	20%	20%
Internet using Other Device	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	2%	5%	6%	12%	10%	7%
Auto Deduction from Bank Account	34%	35%	43%	44%	51%	54%	53%	56%	49%	48%	51%	50%	55%	56%	53%	54%	61%	51%
In Person	33%	29%	33%	34%	31%	31%	35%	31%	30%	26%	28%	26%	28%	26%	23%	23%	23%	20%
Credit Card	N/A	N/A	15%	17%	19%	22%	24%	23%	18%	16%	19%	18%	21%	22%	20%	22%	27%	23%
Telephone	4%	7%	8%	10%	11%	14%	15%	13%	12%	12%	13%	14%	15%	16%	14%	15%	16%	15%

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to weighing by Home Ownership. Starting in 2015, fewer age and education categories are used in weighting, and the weights are trimmed so that no weight is greater than 5 and no weight is less than 0.2.

Table A8-8
Type of Payments made by Mail
Pieces in Millions by Payee Type
Years 2000 - 2017 (Diary Data)

Payee	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
Financial																		
Credit Card	1,811	2,085	2,072	2,222	2,094	1,910	1,791	1,654	1,484	1,306	1,185	1,111	1,085	861	889	871	791	719
Bank, S&L, Credit Union	534	674	718	718	677	692	579	621	516	441	399	376	333	236	271	319	257	180
Insurance Company	608	650	735	713	762	668	687	645	552	549	486	478	407	389	410	383	343	304
Real Estate/Mortgage	261	286	285	293	334	330	313	302	219	225	228	219	168	182	157	175	129	153
Other Financial	119	112	81	94	50	65	79	78	72	42	37	26	27	36	31	35	43	26
Total Financial	3,334	3,807	3,892	4,041	3,916	3,666	3,449	3,301	2,843	2,564	2,336	2,210	2,020	1,704	1,758	1,783	1,562	1,382
Merchants																		
Department Store	341	330	395	344	312	359	289	269	276	120	105	66	67	57	59	59	55	51
Publisher	355	354	382	353	328	267	286	238	241	204	151	157	159	179	112	104	83	72
Mail Order Company	212	240	206	183	170	149	178	124	95	86	82	52	50	52	52	47	53	47
Other Merchants	169	184	151	167	154	136	184	176	156	130	91	95	115	75	90	56	62	60
Total Merchants	1,077	1,108	1,134	1,047	964	911	937	806	768	540	429	369	391	362	313	266	253	230
Services																		
Telephone /Cable Company	1,400	1,828	1,780	2,023	1,846	1,633	1,670	1,499	1,046	1,036	880	884	777	653	593	544	470	402
Utility Company	1,020	1,444	1,357	1,453	1,591	1,363	1,324	1,317	1,057	1,140	952	920	912	818	780	785	633	628
Medical and Other Professional	434	559	565	634	660	605	613	675	639	636	543	537	520	476	542	520	421	340
Other Service	382	385	375	378	343	329	335	316	255	227	203	247	212	192	189	190	171	156
Total Service	3,236	4,216	4,078	4,488	4,440	3,931	3,942	3,807	2,997	3,038	2,577	2,588	2,421	2,139	2,104	2,039	1,695	1,525
Manufacturers	17	41	25	51	36	28	21	25	30	12	7	9	10	6	8	9	12	10
Government	214	315	331	300	328	322	262	333	275	262	238	140	141	122	136	127	116	110
Social	98	59	116	61	4	29	24	0	0	0	0	106	71	97	63	65	54	60
Other/Don't Know/Refused	59	146	129	116	113	83	99	94	82	77	46	96	45	84	90	93	60	28
Total – All Industries	8,037	9,693	9,705	10,104	9,801	8,970	8,734	8,365	6,995	6,494	5,632	5,517	5,098	4,513	4,470	4,383	3,753	3,347

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to weighing by Home Ownership. Starting in 2015, fewer age and education categories are used in weighting, and the weights are trimmed so that no weight is greater than 5 and no weight is less than 0.2.

Note: Payments were restated 2000-2009 and not adjusted

Table A8-9
Type of Payments made by Mail
Percent of Bill Payments by Payee Type
Years 2000 - 2017 (Diary Data)

Payee	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
Financial																		
Credit Card	23%	22%	21%	22%	21%	21%	21%	20%	21%	20%	21%	20%	21%	19%	20%	20%	21%	21%
Bank, S&L, Credit Union	7%	7%	7%	7%	7%	8%	7%	7%	7%	7%	7%	7%	7%	5%	6%	7%	7%	5%
Insurance Company	8%	7%	8%	7%	8%	7%	8%	8%	8%	8%	9%	9%	8%	9%	9%	9%	9%	9%
Real Estate/Mortgage	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	4%	4%	4%	3%	3%	4%	4%	3%	4%	4%	4%	3%	5%
Other Financial	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	0%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Total Financial	41%	39%	40%	40%	40%	41%	39%	39%	41%	39%	41%	40%	40%	38%	39%	41%	42%	41%
Merchants																		
Department Store	4%	3%	4%	3%	3%	4%	3%	3%	4%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%
Publisher	4%	4%	4%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	4%	3%	2%	2%	2%
Mail Order Company	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Other Merchants	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	2%	2%
Total Merchants	13%	11%	12%	10%	10%	10%	11%	10%	11%	8%	8%	7%	8%	8%	7%	6%	7%	7%
Services																		
Telephone /Cable Company	17%	19%	18%	20%	19%	18%	19%	18%	15%	16%	16%	16%	15%	14%	13%	12%	13%	12%
Utility Company	13%	15%	14%	14%	16%	15%	15%	16%	15%	18%	17%	17%	18%	18%	17%	18%	17%	19%
Medical and Other Professional	5%	6%	6%	6%	7%	7%	7%	8%	9%	10%	10%	10%	10%	11%	12%	12%	11%	10%
Other Service	5%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	3%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	5%	5%
Total Service	40%	44%	42%	44%	45%	44%	45%	46%	43%	47%	46%	47%	47%	47%	47%	47%	45%	46%
Manufacturers	0%	0%	0%	1%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Government	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	4%	3%	4%	4%	4%	4%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%
Social	1%	1%	1%	1%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	2%	1%	2%	1%	1%	1%	2%
Other/Don't Know/Refused	1%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%
Total – All Industries	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to weighing by Home Ownership. Starting in 2015, fewer age and education categories are used in weighting, and the weights are trimmed so that no weight is greater than 5 and no weight is less than 0.2.

Table A8-10
Share of Households by Internet Access type
Years 2000 - 2017 (Recruitment Data)

Type of Access	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
None	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	29%	28%	28%	23%	22%	21%	22%	19%	17%	14%	13%	12%	11%	11%
Total Internet Access	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	71%	72%	72%	77%	78%	79%	78%	81%	83%	86%	87%	88%	89%	89%
Dial-up	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	38%	35%	28%	20%	13%	8%	6%	3%	3%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Cable Modem					14%	16%	20%	25%	27%	30%	34%	38%	41%	44%	85%	86%	88%	88%
Other Broadband					6%	5%	5%	4%	6%	6%	10%	14%	14%	17%				
DSL					10%	13%	18%	26%	30%	31%	25%	23%	23%	20%				
Other/DK/RF					3%	3%	2%	2%	2%	3%	4%	3%	2%	3%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Total	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to weighing by Home Ownership. Starting in 2015, fewer age and education categories are used in weighting, and the weights are trimmed so that no weight is greater than 5 and no weight is less than 0.2.

Note: All types of Broadband services are combined beginning in 2014

Table A8-11
Number of Purchases Made over the Internet over the past month
Percent of Households
Years 2000 - 2017 (Recruitment Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
All Households																		
None	86%	89%	78%	75%	71%	70%	60%	57%	56%	53%	53%	49%	48%	44%	42%	42%	39%	35%
1	6%	4%	8%	9%	10%	11%	9%	9%	8%	8%	8%	8%	8%	8%	8%	7%	7%	6%
2	3%	3%	5%	6%	8%	8%	10%	10%	10%	10%	10%	11%	9%	10%	10%	10%	10%	9%
3-5	3%	3%	6%	7%	8%	8%	14%	15%	16%	17%	17%	19%	19%	20%	23%	22%	22%	27%
6-10	1%	1%	2%	2%	2%	3%	5%	6%	6%	7%	8%	8%	10%	10%	11%	12%	13%	15%
More than 10	0%	0%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%	3%	3%	4%	5%	5%	6%	7%	7%	7%	9%	8%
Total	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%
Households that Made 1+ purchases																		
1	42%	36%	37%	38%	36%	35%	23%	20%	19%	18%	16%	15%	16%	15%	13%	12%	12%	9%
2	23%	26%	25%	23%	26%	25%	24%	23%	23%	22%	21%	22%	18%	18%	18%	17%	16%	14%
3-5	24%	28%	26%	26%	28%	27%	35%	35%	36%	37%	36%	37%	36%	37%	39%	38%	37%	42%
6-10	7%	7%	8%	9%	8%	8%	13%	15%	15%	15%	16%	16%	18%	18%	19%	21%	21%	23%
More than 10	3%	3%	3%	4%	3%	4%	5%	7%	8%	9%	10%	10%	12%	12%	11%	12%	14%	13%
Total	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to weighing by Home Ownership. Starting in 2015, fewer age and education categories are used in weighting, and the weights are trimmed so that no weight is greater than 5 and no weight is less than 0.2.

Table A8-12
Advertising Volume
Pieces in Millions
Years 2000 - 2017 (Diary Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
First-Class Advertising	16,875	19,556	18,797	18,012	16,748	18,631	17,998	16,888	16,445	14,482	12,793	12,710	11,437	9,709	8,987	8,370	8,292	7,802
Advertising Only	9,471	11,153	11,045	10,221	9,259	10,782	10,344	9,034	8,257	6,648	6,115	5,448	5,021	4,240	3,925	3,593	3,826	3,713
Secondary Advertising	7,404	8,402	7,752	7,791	7,489	7,849	7,653	7,854	8,187	7,834	6,678	7,262	6,416	5,469	5,062	4,776	4,466	4,089
Marketing Ads [1]	60,496	72,174	71,088	74,205	78,119	83,498	86,874	83,411	82,994	70,631	72,157	77,043	73,241	73,999	71,513	71,371	71,538	68,890
Total Ads	77,370	91,729	89,885	92,217	94,867	102,130	104,872	100,299	99,438	85,113	84,950	89,753	84,678	83,709	80,501	79,741	79,830	76,692
First-Class Ads Share of Total Ads	22%	21%	21%	20%	18%	18%	17%	17%	17%	17%	15%	14%	14%	12%	11%	10%	10%	10%

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to weighing by Home Ownership. Starting in 2015, fewer age and education categories are used in weighting, and the weights are trimmed so that no weight is greater than 5 and no weight is less than 0.2.

[1] Prior to 2007 Standard mail volumes were inflated by about 3 billion pieces due to a double count of Detached Address Labels in the Carrier Cost System (CCS). Also, volumes through 2007 were understated by about 2 to 3 billion pieces in the CCS. These CCS volumes are used as a control for survey results.

Table A8-13A
Advertising Mail By Sender Type
Pieces in Millions
Years 2000 - 2017 (Diary Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
First-Class Ads [1]																		
Financial	6,633	8,020	8,223	7,615	7,218	8,685	7,948	6,696	6,003	5,418	4,632	4,651	4,231	3,366	3,394	3,378	3,214	3,150
Merchants	4,753	5,219	4,369	4,225	3,923	4,096	3,956	3,681	3,621	2,438	2,422	2,172	2,186	1,832	1,817	1,594	1,517	1,387
Services	3,848	4,628	4,704	4,671	4,309	4,368	4,541	4,904	5,134	5,285	4,472	4,767	4,068	3,496	2,931	2,668	2,712	2,579
Manufacturers	328	418	395	418	408	409	373	469	476	329	262	212	165	190	148	153	202	174
Government	262	306	285	283	281	415	427	349	334	307	296	289	219	264	210	138	169	145
Social	891	900	723	694	564	599	675	704	695	659	611	587	549	538	458	421	438	343
Other	159	64	98	107	44	59	78	84	181	46	98	31	20	24	28	17	41	25
Total	16,875	19,556	18,797	18,012	16,748	18,631	17,998	16,888	16,445	14,482	12,793	12,710	11,437	9,709	8,987	8,370	8,292	7,802
Standard Ads [2]																		
Financial	8,156	12,641	13,397	13,961	16,306	19,367	19,909	17,921	17,502	12,786	14,767	18,401	15,355	15,715	15,363	15,643	17,121	16,525
Merchants	23,645	29,709	28,707	27,623	27,904	28,896	30,243	29,750	28,690	25,319	24,709	25,086	23,874	22,895	23,145	21,880	21,571	20,692
Services	6,194	9,099	8,213	8,932	9,082	9,953	9,622	10,944	11,626	10,359	10,705	11,184	10,673	11,605	11,319	11,857	11,886	11,346
Manufacturers	846	1,220	1,102	1,401	1,399	1,643	1,537	1,529	1,488	1,474	1,464	1,586	1,534	1,600	950	1,238	1,323	1,250
Government	1,053	1,089	1,192	973	1,166	1,283	1,626	1,408	1,575	1,043	1,042	951	1,064	991	888	920	946	907
Social	11,911	10,632	10,759	12,722	13,135	13,695	14,198	13,791	13,936	12,347	12,336	12,698	13,469	13,945	12,732	12,629	11,945	11,653
From Multiple Organizations	4,500	6,149	6,211	7,143	7,365	7,363	8,222	7,067	7,345	6,690	6,484	6,678	6,704	6,591	6,590	6,815	6,183	6,103
Other	4,190	1,634	1,508	1,450	1,763	1,299	1,516	1,002	832	613	649	459	568	656	526	389	563	415
Total	60,496	72,174	71,088	74,205	78,119	83,498	86,874	83,411	82,994	70,631	72,157	77,043	73,241	73,999	71,513	71,371	71,538	68,890
Total Ads																		
Financial	14,789	20,661	21,619	21,576	23,524	28,052	27,857	24,617	23,505	18,204	19,399	23,052	19,586	19,081	18,758	19,021	20,335	19,674
Merchants	28,398	34,928	33,075	31,848	31,828	32,992	34,199	33,431	32,311	27,757	27,130	27,258	26,060	24,727	24,962	23,474	23,088	22,079
Services	10,043	13,728	12,917	13,603	13,391	14,321	14,164	15,848	16,761	15,644	15,177	15,952	14,741	15,101	14,250	14,525	14,598	13,925
Manufacturers	1,174	1,638	1,497	1,819	1,807	2,051	1,909	1,998	1,963	1,803	1,726	1,798	1,699	1,790	1,098	1,391	1,525	1,424
Government	1,315	1,395	1,477	1,255	1,448	1,698	2,053	1,757	1,909	1,351	1,338	1,241	1,283	1,256	1,098	1,059	1,115	1,052
Social	12,802	11,532	11,483	13,416	13,698	14,294	14,873	14,495	14,631	13,006	12,947	13,285	14,018	14,482	13,190	13,050	12,383	11,995
From Multiple Organizations	4,500	6,149	6,211	7,143	7,365	7,363	8,222	7,067	7,345	6,690	6,484	6,678	6,704	6,591	6,590	6,815	6,183	6,103
Other	4,349	1,698	1,606	1,557	1,807	1,358	1,594	1,086	1,013	659	748	491	587	680	554	406	603	439
Total	77,370	91,729	89,885	92,217	94,867	102,130	104,872	100,299	99,438	85,113	84,950	89,753	84,678	83,709	80,501	79,741	79,830	76,692

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to weighing by Home Ownership. Starting in 2015, fewer age and education categories are used in weighting, and the weights are trimmed so that no weight is greater than 5 and no weight is less than 0.2.

[1] Includes Secondary Advertising

[2] Prior to 2007 Standard mail volumes were inflated by about 3 billion pieces due to a double count of Detached Address Labels in the Carrier Cost System (CCS). Also, volumes through 2007 were understated by about 2 to 3 billion pieces in the CCS. These CCS volumes are used as a control for survey results.

Table A8-13A2
Advertising ONLY (no secondary) Mail By Sender Type
Pieces in Millions
Years 2000 - 2017 (Diary Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
First-Class Ads [1]																		
Financial	3,450	4,205	4,712	4,188	3,798	4,899	4,468	3,410	2,857	1,902	1,655	1,517	1,411	1,160	1,121	1,163	1,195	1,312
Merchants	3,608	4,010	3,374	3,219	2,975	3,115	3,058	2,735	2,572	2,056	2,028	1,777	1,703	1,411	1,493	1,222	1,153	1,065
Services	1,742	2,279	2,336	2,168	1,910	1,998	2,047	2,222	2,090	2,217	1,966	1,601	1,503	1,204	988	951	1,078	1,066
Manufacturers	287	358	355	371	377	382	334	382	353	290	245	183	133	150	123	106	183	141
Government	113	132	138	123	144	299	323	205	190	156	172	138	64	150	56	26	51	36
Social	163	123	57	53	18	42	44	18	19	0	0	215	191	157	134	119	150	87
Other	107	46	73	100	35	46	69	63	176	28	48	17	15	8	9	7	17	7
Total	9,471	11,153	11,045	10,221	9,259	10,782	10,344	9,034	8,257	6,648	6,115	5,448	5,021	4,240	3,925	3,593	3,826	3,713
Standard Ads [2]																		
Financial	8,156	12,641	13,397	13,961	16,306	19,367	19,909	17,921	17,502	12,786	14,767	18,401	15,355	15,715	15,363	15,643	17,121	16,525
Merchants	23,645	29,709	28,707	27,623	27,904	28,896	30,243	29,750	28,690	25,319	24,709	25,086	23,874	22,895	23,145	21,880	21,571	20,692
Services	6,194	9,099	8,213	8,932	9,082	9,953	9,622	10,944	11,626	10,359	10,705	11,184	10,673	11,605	11,319	11,857	11,886	11,346
Manufacturers	846	1,220	1,102	1,401	1,399	1,643	1,537	1,529	1,488	1,474	1,464	1,586	1,534	1,600	950	1,238	1,323	1,250
Government	1,053	1,089	1,192	973	1,166	1,283	1,626	1,408	1,575	1,043	1,042	951	1,064	991	888	920	946	907
Social	11,911	10,632	10,759	12,722	13,135	13,695	14,198	13,791	13,936	12,347	12,336	12,698	13,469	13,945	12,732	12,629	11,945	11,653
From Multiple Organizations	4,500	6,149	6,211	7,143	7,365	7,363	8,222	7,067	7,345	6,690	6,484	6,678	6,704	6,591	6,590	6,815	6,183	6,103
Other	4,190	1,634	1,508	1,450	1,763	1,299	1,516	1,002	832	613	649	459	568	656	526	389	563	415
Total	60,496	72,174	71,088	74,205	78,119	83,498	86,874	83,411	82,994	70,631	72,157	77,043	73,241	73,999	71,513	71,371	71,538	68,890
Total Ads																		
Financial	11,606	16,846	18,108	18,149	20,104	24,266	24,377	21,331	20,359	14,688	16,423	19,918	16,766	16,875	16,485	16,805	18,316	17,836
Merchants	27,253	33,719	32,081	30,842	30,880	32,011	33,301	32,484	31,262	27,375	26,737	26,863	25,577	24,306	24,638	23,102	22,724	21,757
Services	7,937	11,378	10,549	11,100	10,992	11,951	11,669	13,166	13,716	12,576	12,671	12,785	12,176	12,810	12,307	12,808	12,964	12,412
Manufacturers	1,133	1,578	1,457	1,772	1,776	2,025	1,871	1,911	1,841	1,764	1,709	1,768	1,668	1,751	1,073	1,344	1,506	1,391
Government	1,166	1,221	1,331	1,095	1,311	1,582	1,949	1,613	1,765	1,199	1,215	1,089	1,128	1,142	944	947	997	943
Social	12,074	10,756	10,816	12,775	13,153	13,737	14,243	13,809	13,955	12,347	12,336	12,914	13,660	14,101	12,866	12,748	12,095	11,739
From Multiple Organizations	4,500	6,149	6,211	7,143	7,365	7,363	8,222	7,067	7,345	6,690	6,484	6,678	6,704	6,591	6,590	6,815	6,183	6,103
Other	4,297	1,680	1,581	1,550	1,798	1,345	1,585	1,064	1,008	641	698	476	583	664	535	396	579	421
Total	69,966	83,327	82,133	84,426	87,378	94,281	97,218	92,445	91,251	77,279	78,272	82,491	78,262	78,239	75,438	74,965	75,364	72,603

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to weighing by Home Ownership. Starting in 2015, fewer age and education categories are used in weighting, and the weights are trimmed so that no weight is greater than 5 and no weight is less than 0.2.

[1] Excludes Secondary Advertising

[2] Prior to 2007 Standard mail volumes were inflated by about 3 billion pieces due to a double count of Detached Address Labels in the Carrier Cost System (CCS). Also, volumes through 2007 were understated by about 2 to 3 billion pieces in the CCS. These CCS volumes are used as a control for survey results.

Table A8-14
Advertising Mail By Sender Type
Percent of Pieces
Years 2000 - 2017 (Diary Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
First-Class Ads [1]																		
Financial	39%	41%	44%	42%	43%	47%	44%	40%	37%	37%	36%	37%	37%	35%	38%	40%	39%	40%
Merchants	28%	27%	23%	23%	23%	22%	22%	22%	22%	17%	19%	17%	19%	19%	20%	19%	18%	18%
Services	23%	24%	25%	26%	26%	23%	25%	29%	31%	36%	35%	38%	36%	36%	33%	32%	33%	33%
Manufacturers	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	3%	2%	2%	2%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%
Government	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%
Social	5%	5%	4%	4%	3%	3%	4%	4%	4%	5%	5%	5%	5%	6%	5%	5%	5%	4%
Other	1%	0%	1%	1%	0%	0%	0%	0%	1%	0%	1%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Total	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%
Standard Ads [2]																		
Financial	13%	18%	19%	19%	21%	23%	23%	21%	21%	18%	20%	24%	21%	21%	21%	22%	24%	24%
Merchants	39%	41%	40%	37%	36%	35%	35%	36%	35%	36%	34%	33%	33%	31%	32%	31%	30%	30%
Services	10%	13%	12%	12%	12%	12%	11%	13%	14%	15%	15%	15%	15%	16%	16%	17%	17%	16%
Manufacturers	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	2%	2%	2%
Government	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Social	20%	15%	15%	17%	17%	16%	16%	17%	17%	17%	17%	16%	18%	19%	18%	18%	17%	17%
From Multiple Organizations	7%	9%	9%	10%	9%	9%	9%	8%	9%	9%	9%	9%	9%	9%	9%	10%	9%	9%
Other	7%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Total	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%
Total Ads																		
Financial	19%	23%	24%	23%	25%	27%	27%	25%	24%	21%	23%	26%	23%	23%	23%	24%	25%	26%
Merchants	37%	38%	37%	35%	34%	32%	33%	33%	32%	33%	32%	30%	31%	30%	31%	29%	29%	29%
Services	13%	15%	14%	15%	14%	14%	14%	16%	17%	18%	18%	18%	17%	18%	18%	18%	18%	18%
Manufacturers	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	2%	2%	2%
Government	2%	2%	2%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Social	17%	13%	13%	15%	14%	14%	14%	14%	15%	15%	15%	15%	17%	17%	16%	16%	16%	16%
From Multiple Organizations	6%	7%	7%	8%	8%	7%	8%	7%	7%	8%	8%	7%	8%	8%	8%	9%	8%	8%
Other	6%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Total	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to weighing by Home Ownership. Starting in 2015, fewer age and education categories are used in weighting, and the weights are trimmed so that no weight is greater than 5 and no weight is less than 0.2.

[1] Includes Secondary Advertising

[2] Prior to 2007 Standard mail volumes were inflated by about 3 billion pieces due to a double count of Detached Address Labels in the Carrier Cost System (CCS). Also, volumes through 2007 were understated by about 2 to 3 billion pieces in the CCS. These CCS volumes are used as a control for survey results.

Table A8-15
Treatment Of Advertising Material By Household Income
Percent of Households
Years 2000 - 2017 (Recruitment Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
Usually Read - Total	15%	13%	13%	13%	15%	15%	15%	17%	17%	17%	20%	22%	22%	20%	20%	19%	18%	16%
Under $25K	51%	41%	36%	41%	34%	33%	33%	34%	31%	39%	44%	44%	42%	40%	42%	41%	41%	37%
$25 - $ 49.9	28%	28%	26%	27%	30%	29%	29%	29%	27%	25%	26%	22%	23%	24%	26%	26%	25%	31%
$50 - $64.9	10%	13%	13%	12%	14%	14%	13%	13%	16%	12%	11%	10%	12%	13%	10%	12%	10%	10%
$65 +	10%	19%	25%	21%	22%	24%	25%	24%	26%	24%	19%	24%	24%	23%	22%	21%	24%	22%
Usually Scan - Total	40%	38%	37%	38%	38%	38%	36%	33%	30%	29%	27%	26%	25%	21%	21%	22%	22%	22%
Under 25K	36%	27%	22%	25%	23%	21%	21%	19%	18%	20%	26%	24%	22%	23%	22%	25%	23%	21%
$25 - $ 49.9	33%	30%	26%	27%	28%	26%	26%	26%	25%	25%	26%	21%	21%	24%	28%	23%	23%	22%
$50 - $64.9	14%	14%	17%	17%	16%	17%	15%	16%	14%	14%	14%	12%	13%	13%	14%	12%	13%	13%
$65 +	17%	30%	35%	31%	33%	35%	37%	40%	43%	41%	35%	43%	44%	40%	37%	40%	41%	44%
Read Some - Total	27%	29%	30%	31%	32%	32%	32%	31%	32%	34%	35%	32%	34%	36%	37%	36%	35%	36%
Under 25K	32%	24%	18%	19%	18%	18%	17%	17%	16%	19%	24%	22%	22%	21%	17%	19%	18%	18%
$25 - $ 49.9	35%	28%	26%	26%	24%	23%	26%	23%	23%	22%	23%	21%	22%	23%	25%	23%	23%	22%
$50 - $64.9	14%	12%	16%	17%	17%	17%	16%	15%	15%	14%	14%	12%	14%	13%	14%	13%	13%	12%
$65 +	18%	36%	40%	38%	41%	42%	41%	45%	45%	45%	40%	46%	42%	43%	45%	45%	46%	48%
Usually Don't Read - Total	17%	20%	19%	18%	16%	15%	17%	19%	20%	20%	18%	21%	20%	23%	21%	23%	25%	25%
Under 25K	39%	30%	25%	25%	22%	22%	18%	20%	19%	20%	28%	25%	29%	25%	19%	21%	18%	19%
$25 - $ 49.9	31%	25%	23%	25%	22%	22%	25%	22%	21%	21%	20%	22%	19%	19%	20%	23%	20%	21%
$50 - $64.9	13%	12%	15%	15%	14%	16%	16%	14%	14%	14%	13%	13%	12%	10%	12%	12%	14%	10%
$65 +	17%	33%	37%	35%	42%	40%	41%	44%	45%	45%	39%	41%	41%	46%	48%	44%	49%	51%

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to weighing by Home Ownership. Starting in 2015, fewer age and education categories are used in weighting, and the weights are trimmed so that no weight is greater than 5 and no weight is less than 0.2.

Appendix B: Methodology

Study Design and Methodology

The U.S. Postal Service Household Diary Study (HDS), conducted by NuStats on behalf of the Volume and Revenue Forecasting division of the Postal Service's Finance Department, is a continuously fielded study that measures household mail volumes, mail usage, and attitudes about the mail and advertising.

The HDS uses a two-stage survey design: Stage 1 is an online and interviewer-mediated household recruitment interview. Stage 2 is a self-completion mail diary [Appendix C contains the survey instruments]. The HDS uses a multi-mode approach to minimize response bias, to improve data accuracy through efficient data checking and household re-contacts, and to provide immediate telephone assistance to participants during their diary week.

Household Recruitment Interview

The **household recruitment interview** collects information on household and individual demographics, recall of mail sent and received, adoption and use of communications technologies, bill payment behavior, and attitudes towards advertising.

Mail Diary

The **mail diary** covers a seven-day period (Monday to Sunday) and collects information on the number of mail pieces received and sent, industry source, mail characteristics, and attitudes regarding mail received.

Sample Design

This section describes the household selection process for participation in the HDS. A sample is the representative subset of the survey population used to gain information about the entire population. The population of inference for the HDS is all U.S. households. The probability design ensures each household has an equal chance of selection.

The sample design allows projections of results to all U.S. households. The Postal Service provided an address sample that NuStats matched for known telephone listings. Generally, the study was conducted using telephone and online sampling for household selection and screening, followed by diaries mailed to eligible households and completed by each household unit. Households without telephones were contacted via U.S. Mail. The sample design involves a systematic sample stratified by strata (or urban/rural location) and Census regions, ensuring even coverage across the United States.

A master national sample was specified and drawn by in-house sampling statisticians. The Postal Service drew the household probability sample from the national address database following NuStats specifications. The master list, sorted by ZIP code, was used to draw a systematic stratified sample, which was then tagged with variables indicating each housing unit's geographic location in terms of Census region and stratum.

Sample was drawn for each of the four quarters based on known proportions of households within a Census region and urban or rural location. Census regions are defined by state. Urban and rural location is defined by county and metropolitan status as defined by the U.S. Census Bureau. The strata are defined by county as follows:

- **Stratum 1:** Counties that are part of the 30 largest metropolitan areas in the United States, as defined by population, according to 100 percent counts of the Census 2010.
- **Stratum 2:** Counties that are part of metropolitan areas but are not in Stratum 1.
- **Stratum 3:** Counties that are not part of a metropolitan area.

Quarterly sample frames were then derived based on the amount of sample needed for each quarter, and sample was allocated to region and strata cells based on known proportions as indicated by Census 2010 counts of households.

The sample was continuously "fielded" throughout all 52 weeks of the year. Sample was released in a manner designed to recruit equal sample sizes for each diary week, resulting in a sample file of at least 5,200 households. Table B.1 shows the distribution of recruited and completed households.

Table B.1:
Sample by Postal Quarter

Quarter	Required Sample	Recruited Households	Completed Households
Quarter 1	1,300	2,139	1,261
Quarter 2	1,300	2,101	1,362
Quarter 3	1,300	2,089	1,339
Quarter 4	1,300	2,125	1,295
Total	**5,200**	8,454	5,257

Data Collection Method

The study uses a two-stage design in which households are recruited to participate in the diary study by choosing to use a household interview or an online survey (Stage 1) and recruited households complete a seven-day diary of mail received and sent (Stage 2).

Stage 1: Household Recruitment Interview

The main function of the household recruitment interview is to recruit households to participate in the diary study. In addition, the interview collects information on household and person demographics, recall of mail sent and received, adoption and use of communication technologies, bill payment behavior, and attitudes towards advertising.

Households completed the recruitment interview via computer-assisted telephone interviewing (CATI) technology or by using an online survey. The FY 2017 household interview consisted of 6,110 online surveys and 2,344 phone interviews completed with an adult member (age 18 or older) in the household. Table B.2 below shows the distribution of recruited households by recruitment type.

Table B.2:
Sample by Recruitment Type

Recruitment Interview	Completed	Sample Percent
Phone	2,344	27.7%
Web	6,110	72.3%
Total	8,454	100%

These respondents represented a cross-section of U.S. households by geography. The household interview contained 130 data items and took an average of 25 minutes to administer. The flow of the interview included the following elements:

- **Introduction.** Each interview began with an introduction and purpose of the interview. The interviewer also verified the respondent's address.
- **Technology adoption and use.** Questions were asked about ownership and use of personal computers, Internet, and other electronic communication.
- **Mail volume recall.** The respondent was asked to summarize how many bills, statements, and packages all members of the household have sent in a particular time period.
- **Use of postal services.** The use of post offices, post office boxes, and private mailing services was explored.
- **Bill payments.** Bill payment volumes, methods, and timing were explored in depth.
- **Periodicals.** A summary of magazine and newspaper volumes received by the household were collected.
- **Advertising.** Descriptions of advertising received by the household as well as attitudes about the advertising, and orders placed because of it, were elicited.
- **Online shopping.** Respondents were asked about their online shopping habits, including questions about shipping methods.
- **Financial accounts and credit cards.** Respondents were asked to summarize the total accounts and credit cards held by the household.
- **Household and person demographics.** Demographic items included gender, age, marital status, employment status, educational attainment, race/ethnicity, household income, household wage earners, home ownership, residence tenure, and dwelling type.

The completion rate for the FY 2017 study (defined as the proportion of respondents who completed the diary portion relative to all recruited respondents) was 62.2 percent compared to 62.6 percent in FY 2016. Most recruitment refusals took place prior to hearing who NuStats was and why the firm was calling. Refusal households that were later re-contacted cited time

constraints and privacy concerns as reasons for not participating.

Stage 2: Mail Diary Package

Recruited households were sent mail diaries, instructions, and a toll-free "help" telephone number. The night before the beginning of an assigned diary week, NuStats made reminder calls to households to confirm receipt of the diary package and to answer any questions. If the diary package was not received by this time, NuStats re-confirmed the address, assigned a new diary week, and re-sent the diary package.

The diary package contains a Certificate of Appreciation, Instruction Booklet, and a photo-based "Quick Start" sheet. The Instruction Booklet provided information about the study, answers to frequently asked questions, instructions for filling out the diary, guidelines for sorting mail, and examples of mail markings.The diary instrument was composed of two parts:

- **The Question sheets.** The Question sheets are color-coded by mail classification (First-Class Mail received, First-Class Mail sent, Marketing Mail, Nonprofit, etc.). Information collected about each mail classification included: type of mail piece (i.e., envelope, postcard, catalog, etc.), mail classification, mail type, sender type, information about advertising enclosed, and receiver reaction or responses to the mail piece.
- **Seven answer booklets, each specific to a day of the week.** Each booklet was arranged by mail classification and color-coded to correspond to the question sheets.

Households were instructed to enclose pertinent information from each mail piece received to enable NuStats editors to verify or clarify quantity and classes of mail recorded in the diaries. NuStats used a three-stage editing process to check the accuracy of the diary information recorded by each household. First, returned diary packages were culled for those that represented a reasonable attempt to complete the diary. Second, the diary information recorded for each day were checked to ensure sufficient and logical answers, as well as to verify recorded information against the mail markings returned in the package. The diaries were then scanned using Optical Character Recognition (OCR) software. In stage three, a verifier re-checked the diary information recorded in the OCR software for each day. This second edit functions as a quality control check to ensure data accuracy.

During the editing process, a small number of correction callbacks were made to households to clarify information or to fill-in missing information. Overall, about three percent of returned diaries did not pass the edit checking process.

Of the 8,454 households recruited to receive a diary package 5,194 actually returned acceptable completed diaries (defined as containing data suitable for analysis) to NuStats, for a completion rate of 62.2 percent.

Data Processing

Data Management

Data management entails processing the information resulting from the Household Interview and Mail Diaries, making it available for analysis, storing it, and documenting it. Household interviews were conducted using CATI technology, where the questionnaire and relevant data checks were programmed into a master questionnaire that was used by all interviewers to administer the survey. Recorded data was extracted from the CATI software into a database management file.

Returned diary information was recorded (entered) through optical scanning technology. The diary data, once scanned using Teleform software, was captured in a database management file.

After completion of data collection, editing and entry tasks, the survey data were contained in 9 data files. One data file contained the Household Interview data. The Mail Diary data were in 8 files—one for each mail classification (First-Class Mail received, First-Class Mail sent, etc.). These files were all developed in SAS-PC.

The file variables were identified by variable name. For each file variable, the File Information contains:

- Label, which is a brief description of the variable;
- Measurement level, which specifies the level of measurement as scale (numeric data on an interval or ratio scale), ordinal, or nominal. Nominal and ordinal data can be either string (alphanumeric) or numeric;
- Value formats, which identify the response codes; and
- Column width and alignment.

Several SAS programming operations were necessary to put the Mail Diary data in the desired form for analysis. The structure for these programs was

contained in a separate File Information document that accompanied the data delivery.

Various edit routines were used to check the consistency of the reported data and to identify reporting or entry errors. Routine edit checks were conducted to examine questionnaire responses for reasonableness and consistency across items. Routine checks included such items as:

- Response code range checks;
- Checks for proper data skips and patterns of answering questions consistent with prior answers;
- Checks for realistic responses (e.g., number of online purchases possible in one month); and
- Checks for high frequency of item non-response (missing data from question refusals).

When conducting these checks, data were compared against the actual survey forms. NuStats identified extreme values that were impossible or unlikely, and corrected inconsistent data when possible. For example, extremely high numbers of computers owned by a household were examined to determine whether or not they were legitimate. Some extreme/inconsistent data values unable to be corrected or verified were edited to missing values.

In addition, NuStats performed in-depth customized data checks to ensure data within each record of the Household Interview were logically consistent. For example, a respondent should have reported paying bills online only if he/she also reported having Internet access. Customized checks were also used to ensure consistency between the Household Interview and Mail Diary data. For example, an addressee was identified as a child (under 18) in the diary only if the household also reported having a child in the Household Interview.

Raw variables, derived variables, and analytical programs were documented in a data documentation binder that accompanied the data delivery. Any information that could be directly or indirectly used to identify individual respondents, such as respondent names, addresses, or telephone numbers, were removed to protect respondent confidentiality and privacy. Such information is stored in a locked archival file.

Sample Demographic Profile (All Counts Unweighted), Government Fiscal Year 2017

Table B.3:
Annual Household Income by Recruitment/Retrieval Status

Annual Household Income	Recruited Households		Total	Sample Percent	Population Percent
	Retrieved	Not Retrieved			
Under $10,000	134	154	288	2.5%	6.4%
$10,000 - $14,999	126	151	277	2.4%	4.9%
$15,000 - $19,999	129	137	266	2.5%	4.6%
$20,000 - $24,999	189	158	347	3.6%	4.9%
$25,000 - $34,999	325	252	577	6.2%	9.4%
$35,000 - $49,999	535	335	870	10.2%	12.9%
$50,000 - $64,999	513	274	787	9.8%	10.9%
$65,000 - $79,999	541	265	806	10.3%	8.9%
$80,000 - $99,999	541	233	774	10.3%	9.3%
$100,000 or more	1,252	614	1,866	23.8%	27.7%
Don't Know	155	150	305	2.9%	N/A
Refused	817	474	1,291	15.5%	N/A
Total	**5,257**	**3,197**	**8,454**	**100.0%**	**100.0%**

Notes:
Sample Percent based only on retrieved households that provided a response to the Household Income question.
Population percent based on U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey Annual Demographic File (March 2017).

Table B.4:
Number of Adults in Household by Recruitment/Retrieval Status

Number of Adults in Household	Recruited Households		Total	Sample Percent	Population Percent
	Retrieved	Not Retrieved			
One	1,265	916	2,181	24.1%	27.9%
Two	2,295	1,180	3,475	43.7%	34.5%
Three	760	475	1,235	14.5%	15.5%
Four	593	345	938	11.3%	12.8%
Five or More	344	281	625	6.5%	9.3%
Total	**5,257**	**3,197**	**8,454**	**100.0%**	**100.0%**

Notes:
Sample Percent based only on retrieved households.
Population percent based on U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey Annual Demographic File (March 2017).

Table B.5:
Geographic Region by Recruitment/Retrieval Status

Geographic Region	Recruited Households		Total	Sample Percent	Population Percent
	Retrieved	Not Retrieved			
Northeast	868	499	1,367	16.5%	16.0%
Midwest	1,304	683	1,987	24.8%	23.2%
South	1,906	1,295	3,201	36.3%	38.1%
West	1,179	720	1,899	22.4%	22.6%
Total	**5,257**	**3,197**	**8,454**	**100.0%**	**100.0%**

Notes:
Sample Percent based only on retrieved households.
Population percent based on U.S. Census Bureau, Census 2010, Summary File 3, Table H6 (Occupied Housing Units).

Table B.6:
Urban/Rural Location by Recruitment/Retrieval Status

Urban/Rural Location	Recruited Households		Total	Sample Percent	Population Percent
	Retrieved	Not Retrieved			
30 Largest Metro Areas	2,485	1,590	4,075	47.3%	46.5%
Other Metro Areas	2,251	1,320	3,571	42.8%	42.4%
Non-Metropolitan Areas	521	287	808	9.9%	11.0%
Total	**5,257**	**3,197**	**8,454**	**100.0%**	**100.0%**

Notes:
Sample Percent based only on retrieved households.
Population percent based on U.S. Census Bureau, Census 2010; Strata based on Metro Area Classification by County.

Table B.7:
Age of Head of Household by Recruitment/Retrieval Status

Age of Head of Household	Recruited Households		Total	Sample Percent	Population Percent
	Retrieved	Not Retrieved			
18 - 24	75	102	177	1.4%	4.8%
25 - 44	1,287	956	2,243	24.5%	33.0%
45 - 64	2,061	1,085	3,146	39.2%	37.0%
65+	1,739	989	2,728	33.1%	25.2%
Refused	95	65	160	1.8%	N/A
Total	**5,257**	**3,197**	**8,454**	100.0%	100.0%

Notes:
Sample Percent based only on retrieved households that provided a valid response.
Population percent based on U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey Annual Demographic File (March 2017).

Table B.8:
Educational Attainment of Head of Household by Recruitment/Retrieval Status

Educational Attainment of Head of Household	Recruited Households		Total	Sample Percent	Population Percent
	Retrieved	Not Retrieved			
8th grade or less	36	45	81	0.7%	3.4%
Some high school	92	131	223	1.8%	6.2%
High school graduate	889	713	1,602	16.9%	27.2%
Some college	1,030	723	1,753	19.6%	18.3%
Technical school graduate	331	231	562	6.3%	4.4%
College graduate	1,589	815	2,404	30.2%	27.2%
Postgraduate work	1,223	466	1,689	23.3%	13.2%
Refused	67	73	140	1.3%	N/A
Total	**5,257**	**3,197**	**8,454**	100.0%	100.0%

Notes:
Sample Percent based only on retrieved households that provided a valid response.
Population percent based on U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey Annual Demographic File (March 2017).

Data Weighting and Expansion

This section explains the methodology used for creating sampling and expansion weights for the FY 2017 Household Diary Study.

The FY 2017 HDS uses both weighting and expansion factors to 1) adjust the sample data to match population parameters and 2) expand mail volumes exhibited in the diary sample to all U.S. households.

Weighting Procedures, FY 2017 Recruitment Data

Sampling weights were produced separately for the households that participated in the recruitment phase of the FY 2017 HDS, and those that completed and returned a diary. There were four main weighting variables: Geography, Education, Age, and Homeownership. FY 2017 recruitment geographic weights were derived from sample households' strata and region:

Strata: As mentioned previously, there are three strata. A household was classified within strata as residing in the top 30 metropolitan areas nationwide, any other metropolitan area, or a non-metropolitan area.[1] Table B.9 provides unweighted sample counts from FY 2017 recruitment data for strata:

Table B.9:
HDS 2017 Recruitment Data: Urban/Rural Location

Urban/ Rural Location	Household	Percent	Cumulative Percent
30 Largest Metro Areas	4,075	48.2%	48.2%
Other Metro Areas	3,571	42.2%	90.4%
Non-Metro Counties	808	9.6%	100.0%
Total	**8,454**	100.0%	

[1] Metropolitan area is defined within the sample according to the official definition used by the U.S. Census Bureau, commonly referred to as Metropolitan Statistical Areas (MSAs). Metropolitan areas are defined as single- or multi-county areas. Non-metropolitan areas are counties that do not belong to a metropolitan area. Each sample county was assigned to a stratum according to its metropolitan status.

Regions: Table B.10 provides unweighted sample counts from FY 2017 recruitment data for region. Households were classified by state. There are four mutually exclusive regions as defined by the U.S. Census Bureau (along with respective states):

Four Census Regions:

Northeast: Connecticut, Maine, Massachusetts, New Hampshire, New Jersey, New York, Pennsylvania, Rhode Island, and Vermont.

Midwest: Illinois, Indiana, Iowa, Kansas, Michigan, Minnesota, Missouri, Nebraska, North Dakota, Ohio, South Dakota, and Wisconsin.

South: Alabama, Arkansas, Delaware, District of Columbia, Florida, Georgia, Kentucky, Louisiana, Maryland, Mississippi, North Carolina, Oklahoma, South Carolina, Tennessee, Texas, Virginia, and West Virginia.

West: Arizona, Alaska, California, Colorado, Hawaii, Idaho, Montana, Nevada, New Mexico, Oregon, Utah, Washington, and Wyoming.

Table B.10:
HDS 2017 Recruitment Data: Geographic Region

Geographic Region	Households	Percent	Cumulative Percent
Northeast	1,367	16.2%	16.2%
Midwest	1,987	23.5%	39.7%
South	3,201	37.9%	77.5%
West	1,899	22.5%	100.0%
Total	**8,454**	100.0%	

Strata/Regions: Table B.11 indicates the distribution of households from the FY 2017 recruitment sample within strata and regions.

Population parameters for the intersection of the three strata and four regions were based on 2010 Census counts of households by county. As Table B.12 shows, each county was grouped according to its location within these 12 mutually exclusive and collectively exhaustive geographic categories.

To calculate the weight for each strata/region interval, the population percentage was divided by the sample percentage. Geography weights appear in the last column to the right in Table B.12.

Table B.11:
Distribution of Households within Strata and Region

Geographic Region	Stratum *(Urban/Rural Location)*			Total
	30 Largest Metro Areas	Other Metro Areas	Non-Metro Areas	
Northeast	691	594	82	**1,367**
Midwest	953	802	232	**1,987**
South	1,325	1,506	370	**3,201**
West	1,106	669	124	**1,899**
Total	**4,075**	**3,571**	**808**	**8,454**

Table B.12:
HDS 2017 Recruitment Data: Construction of Geographic Weight

Stratum	Geographic Region	Households *(Population)*	Percent	Households *(Sample)*	Percent	Weight
30 Largest Metro Areas	Northeast	8,679,534	7.96%	691	8.2%	.97
	Midwest	11,759,871	10.79%	953	11.3%	.96
	South	16,492,511	15.13%	1,325	15.7%	.97
	West	13,800,893	12.66%	1,106	13.1%	.97
Other Metro Areas	Northeast	7,316,645	6.71%	594	7.0%	.96
	Midwest	9,982,770	9.16%	802	9.5%	.97
	South	19,849,344	18.21%	1,506	17.8%	1.02
	West	9,074,069	8.33%	669	7.9%	1.05
Non-Metro Areas	Northeast	1,485,685	1.36%	82	1.0%	1.41
	Midwest	3,551,875	3.26%	232	2.7%	1.19
	South	5,200,840	4.77%	370	4.4%	1.09
	West	1,796,099	1.65%	124	1.5%	1.12
Totals		**108,990,136**	**100.0%**	**8,454**	**100.0%**	**1.00**

Source: Household Population Estimates based on U.S. Census Bureau, 2010 Census.

Education: In addition to weighting for differences in geography between the sample and the population, an additional weight was created based on differences in the educational attainment of the head of household. For those households in which either more than one person was identified as the head of household or no individual was identified as the head of household, one was chosen based on the following sequence of criteria: 1) oldest male or 2) oldest female (if no male exists). For cases in which two candidates for the head of the household were of the same age, the respondent on the phone was chosen.

Known population parameters were based on weighted proportions derived from the U.S. Census Bureau's Current Population Survey annual demographic file for March 2017. For cases in which the head of household refused to provide his/her education level, an educational level was imputed based on the average educational level of like cases. There were 140 such cases in 2017; mean levels of educational attainment were based on geography (strata and regions), as well as age and income level, if provided.

Table B.13:
HDS 2017 Recruitment Data: Construction of Educational Attainment Weight

Educational Attainment	Households *(Population)*	Percent	Households *(Sample)*	Percent	Weight
Less than high school diploma	12,188,808	9.7%	304	3.6%	2.69
High school graduate	34,384,610	27.2%	1,603	19.0%	1.44
Some college	23,114,096	18.3%	1,761	20.8%	0.88
Technical school graduate	5,509,477	4.4%	685	8.1%	0.54
College graduate	34,379,558	27.2%	2,412	28.5%	0.95
Postgraduate work	16,647,136	13.2%	1,689	20.0%	0.66
Totals	126,223,685	100.0%	8,454	100.0%	1.00

Note: Education responses include imputed Don't Know/Refused answers.

Age: Additional weight was also created based on differences in the age of the head of household. Known population parameters were based on weighted proportions derived from the U.S. Census Bureau's Current Population Survey annual demographic file for March 2017. For cases in which the head of household refused to provide his/her age, an age level was imputed based on the average age level of like cases. There were 160 such cases in 2017; mean levels of age were based on geography (strata and regions), as well as education level, if provided.

Table B.14:
HDS 2017 Recruitment Data: Construction of Age Weight

Educational Attainment	Households *(Population)*	Percent	Households *(Sample)*	Percent	Weight
18-24	6,056,306	4.8%	177	2.1%	2.29
25-34	20,135,433	16.0%	1,050	12.4%	1.28
35-44	21,530,213	17.1%	1,215	14.4%	1.19
45-54	22,842,207	18.1%	1,371	16.2%	1.12
55-64	23,804,090	18.9%	1,894	22.4%	0.84
65-74	18,277,560	14.5%	1,583	18.7%	0.77
75+	13,577,876	10.8%	1,164	13.8%	0.78
Total	126,223,685	100.0%	8,454	100.0%	1.00

Note: Age responses include imputed Don't Know/Refused answers.

Homeownership: In addition to weighing for differences in education and geography between the sample and the population, data was weighed to account for homeownership rates for U.S. Households. For those households in which homeownership was unknown, one was imputed based on the average income level and geography of like cases. There were 216 such cases in 2017; mean levels of income attainment were based on geography (strata and regions). Known population parameters were based on weighted proportions derived from the U.S. Census Bureau's Current Population Survey quarterly Housing Vacancies and Homeownership file for October 2017. The average Homeownership rate in 2017 is 63.7 percent.

Weighting Procedures, FY 2017 Diary Data

As mentioned above, 8,454 households participated in the recruitment phase of the FY 2017 HDS, and 5,257 households completed usable diaries. Balancing weights for the FY 2017 HDS diary data were developed in the same way as for the recruitment data. An additional age weight was derived based on the age of the head of household using the following categories: 18–24, 25–34, 35–44, 45–54, 55–64, 65–74, and over 75 years old.

Other adjustments to weights used in the diary data included a quarterly adjustment, which accounted for variances in sampling across postal quarters.

All component weights were multiplied together and normalized to ensure that the total number of weighted cases equals the number of unweighted cases.

A final adjustment in the form of expansion factors was made to expand the sample to the level of total households in the United States at the time of data collection, which was 126.2 million. The number of households in the United States was divided into the number of households that participated in the diary portion of the survey. The resultant factor was applied to each household in the survey. The expansion factor was multiplied by the sampling weight and then multiplied by 52 (the number of calendar weeks in one year) to derive nationwide annual volume estimates from the sample data.

Expansion Factor

126,223,685/ 5,257 = 24,010.6

Component Weight:

$$\omega = \frac{Ps / Pt}{Ss / St},$$

Where Ps = population count in cohort and
Pt = total population count
Ss = sample count in cohort
St = total sample count

Appendix C: Survey Instruments

Appendix C1: Recruitment Questionnaire

Recruitment Web Questionnaire – FY2017

Acronym Dictionary
DK = Don't Know
RF = Refusal
NA = Not applicable

1. **[LETTR]** The U.S. Postal Service is conducting a study to better understand the type and amount of mail households like yours receive and send. The information will be used to make better decisions about postage rates and staffing needs to ensure an efficient national mail system and keep costs at a minimum. We recently sent a letter explaining the study and to let you know we would contact you. Did you receive our letter?

   1 .....Yes CONTINUE WITH VADDW

   2……No VERIFY ADDRESS [Continue TO VADDW]

2. **[VADDW]** First, we'd like to verify your name and mailing address. The research study is based on mailing addresses. To qualify for the study, your address has to match the address we have in our records. However, apartment numbers can change so if your street address is correct but the apartment number is not, please edit the apartment number in the field below. Is your address...

ADDRESS: <MADDR>
APT: <MSUIT>
CITY: <MCITY> STATE: <MSTAT> ZIP: <MZIP1> <MZIP2>

   1 YES => Lang
   2 No, entire address is wrong => INT10 CODE AS QN
   3 No, Apt/Suit # is wrong [CAN BE ADJUSTED] => SKIP TO MSUI2 => Lang
   9 Not applicable/Rather not say

3. **[INT07]** IF VADDW=9 Refused,
   I understand not wanting to give out your address, but to participate in the survey and be eligible to receive 100 First-Class or $40, I'll need to verify your mailing address. If you have any questions, please call 1-888-441-8777. Thank you, have a nice evening/day. CODE AS RA (REFUSED ADDRESS), AND TERMINATE.

4. **[MSUI2]** What is the new apartment or suite number? NOTE: Leave blank if you no longer have an apartment number or suite number. =>LANG

5. **[LANG]** Please select the language you prefer to complete the survey in: Por favor elija el idioma que prefiere usar para completar la encuesta:

English (Inglés) 1
Spanish (Español) 2

6. **[INT] [WHEN STRATA/REGION QUOTAS CLOSE:]** Thank you for your time, I'm sorry if we've inconvenienced you, but we have filled the quota for the region in which you live. For this survey, the USPS has randomly selected households based on their mailing address. If you have any questions, please call 1-888-441-8777. Have a nice evening/day."

"Exit Survey" -> Code as OQ

[ACTIVATE AND DEACTIVATED AT EACH END OF QTR.]

7. **[INT05] [END OF YEAR/QTR WHEN ONLY 1 ASSN WEEK REMAINING]**: Your household was selected to participate in the diary study the week of <Last ASSN>. If your household cannot participate during the specified time, please exit the survey and thank you for your participation. If you can participate during this time, press Continue.

Continue - > To RFNAM

Exit Survey -> Code as QA

[ASSNW] We'd like for you to answer detailed questions about the mail your household sends and receives for 7 days. Once you complete the diaries, you will receive your choice of either 100 Forever Stamps or a $40 check. You can expect your gift to arrive roughly 12 weeks after we receive your completed diaries.

We want to confirm that you understand we'll be mailing you a set of household diaries that you'll complete during one of the weeks you select from the list below.

How much time does it take?
How long it takes depends on how much mail you receive. The first day of your diary-recording week will take the longest as you become more familiar with the survey. After that, on average, it should only take about 3-5 minutes for each piece of mail. To help you, we have a USPS hotline available to provide you with step-by-step instructions if needed, and to answer any questions you may have. That toll free number is 1-888-441-8777. You may also want to check out the study web site at www.nustats.com/uspsstudy.htm

8. **[Q1]** So that we can group your responses with those of other respondents, could you please tell us your gender?
1..... Male
2..... Female
9..... Rather not say

9. **[RECV]** Do you receive mail at your home address, including cluster boxes near your home?

1..... Yes **CONTINUE**
2..... No => **CONTINUE**
8..... Unsure => **CONTINUE**
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say **CONTINUE**

10. **[HMBOX]** Where is your mailbox located?

1..... Door slot
2..... Mailbox installed on a porch or near your front door
3..... Curbside single/double mailbox (not part of a cluster or group of mailboxes)
4..... Central mailbox cluster inside an apartment, condominium or other building
5……Central mailbox cluster outside in your neighborhood
[IF HMBOX=1-5, CONTINUE TO POBOX]
6..... Picked up mail from a post office box or box at a mailing center **-> [IF 6, THANK AND TERMINATE, AND MARK IT QM (INT04)]**
8..... Unsure**-> [IF 8, THANK AND TERMINATE, AND MARK IT QM (INT04)]**
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say **-> [IF 9, THANK AND TERMINATE, AND MARK IT QM (INT04)]**

11. **[INT04]** Thank you very much for your time. I'm sorry if we inconvenienced you, but we need households that receive their mail at their home address. Have a nice evening/day. Goodbye.

QM……. DOES NOT RECEIVE MAIL AT HOME ADDRESS => GO TO END

12. **[POBOX]** Thank you. Does your household rent a PO Box at either the Post Office or a private mailing service, like Post Office Plus, or Parcel Place?

1 .....PO Box at USPS
2 .....Box at private mailing service
3 .....Neither- My household does not have a PO Box or a box at a private company.
4 .....Both
7 .....Other, Specify
8 .....Unsure
9 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

13. **[Q9R]** Which of the following methods have household members used in the last six months to mail personal packages, not letter mail? Do not include work-related packages. Note: If you used Click N Ship, or shipped a Household package from a work location, please indicate the method used to ship your package from the list below. Mark all that apply

[PROGRAMMER NOTE: mark all that apply except for choice 5, 8, and 9]

0 .....Put the package in a blue USPS Mailbox
1 .....Took Package inside a US Post Office to the service counter
4 .....I left the package for my mail carrier for pick up
6 .....Used an Automated Postal Center.
3 .....Used a private package shipping company, like UPS, FedEx, etc.
2 .....Took it to a private mailing service, like Post Office Plus, Parcel Place, etc.
7 .....Other, Specify [O_Q9R]
5 .....None. I have not mailed packages in the last six months
8 .....Unsure
9 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

14. **[Q14B]** How many times in an average month do household members go inside a U.S. Post Office to the service counter? [RANGE: 0-60]

00 .....None
98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

15. **[Q12]** How many times in an average month do household members go to a U.S. Post Office but not to the service counter? We mean an outside drop off box, going to your PO Box, or using an automated machine. [RANGE: 0-60]

98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

16. **[Q13]** How many times in an average month do household members go to a private mailing service? For example, Post Office Plus, Parcel Place, etc. [RANGE: 0-30]

00 .....None => GO TO Q50
98 .....Unsure => GO TO Q50
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say => GO TO Q50

17. **[Q14]** Why does your household use a mailing service rather than the post office? MULTIPLE RESPONSE, ALLOW UP TO 7 ANSWERS

01 .....Hours-longer/later
02 .....Location
03 .....Offers pick up service
04 .....Cheaper
05 .....Faster/overnight delivery
06 .....Offers drop off service
07 .....Packages it up
08 .....Service-better/more efficient/friendly
09 .....More reliable/seems safer
11 .....Uses only in special circumstances

12..... For extra services (copying, faxes, mail boxes, etc.)
13..... Shorter wait time/lines, less crowded
14..... 'Ship to' requested it
16..... Accepts odd-shaped/oversized packages
18..... On-line tracking service
20..... Uses only for job/work-related packages
21..... To use UPS or FedEx, etc.
22 …… Sending back using the service that company used to ship it
97..... Other, specify
98..... Unsure
99..... Rather not say

18. **[Q50]** Currently, the law does not allow anyone other than a U.S. Postal employee to place mail in your mailbox. How would you feel about changing the law to allow anyone to place mail or other items in your mailbox? Do you… .

1..... Prefer it
2..... Oppose it
3..... Not care one way or the other
8 ..... Unsure
9 ..... Rather not say

19. **[Q15].** Approximately how many Forever stamps do you currently have in your household? RANGE 0-200, 998, 999

20. **[Q16].** How many Forever stamps has your household purchased within the past 30 days? RANGE 0-200, 998, 999

21. **[Q17].** How many Forever stamps has your household USED within the past 30 days? RANGE 0-200, 998, 999

22. **[Q18].** Within the past 30 days, how many Forever stamps within your household have been lost or damaged? RANGE 0-200, 998, 999

23. **[Q19].** [**IF Q15=0 THEN SKIP Q19**] Of the Forever stamps you currently have in your household, how many of them do you intend to keep (e.g., for stamp collecting) and not ever use for mailing letters, postcards or packages? [numeric input] RANGE 0-200, 998, 999

24. **[Q22]** Many people are now using the Internet to communicate, pay bills and conduct other household activities that were traditionally done by mail. In this next set of questions, we'll be asking about your household's access to and use of the Internet, including accessing the web through a mobile device. How many adults age 18 or older in your household connect to the Internet from home? RANGE: 0-9

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

IF Q22 = 0, 98 or 99, SKIP TO Q24

25. **[Q23]** What is the primary type of Internet connection used by the adults in your home?

4..... DSL, Cable Modem, Other Broadband (fiber optic, satellite), Wireless
2..... Mobile Broadband (such as a Smartphone)
1..... Dial-up modem
7..... Other, Specify [O_Q23]
8..... Unsure
9..... Rather not say

26. **[Q24]** Do any of the adults in your household regularly access the Internet from any other location, such as work or a library?

1 .....Yes
2 .....No
8 .....Unsure
9 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

NOTE: SKIP TO Q177F IF ((Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24= 2,8,9, or Missing))

27. **[Q55B]** With which of the following devices do adults in your household connect to the Internet for non-work-related purposes?

27a. **[Q55B1]** A desktop or laptop computer?
1 .....Yes
2 .....No
8 .....Unsure
9 .....Rather not say

27b. **[Q55B2]** A mobile phone or smartphone?
1 .....Yes
2 .....No
8 .....Unsure
9 .....Rather not say

27c. **[Q55B3]** Another Internet device?
1 .....Yes
2 .....No
8 .....Unsure
9 .....Rather not say

NOTE: SKIP TO Q177F IF ((Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24= 2,8,9, or Missing))

28. **[Q57A1]** How long have adults in your household been using the Internet at any location?

1 .....Less than 1 year
2 .....1 to 2 years
3 .....2 to 5 years
4 .....More than 5 years
8 .....Unsure
9 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

29. **[Q57B1]** During the last month, how often did adults in your household use the Internet for non-work-related purposes at any location? Would you say…

1 .....Several times a day
2 .....Almost every day
3 .....Several times a week
4 .....Once a week or less
8 .....Unsure
9 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

PROGRAMMER NOTE: SKIP TO Q177F IF ((Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24= 2,8,9, or Missing))

30. **[Q57C2]** How many adults in your household are a member of an online social network, such as Twitter, Facebook, or Instagram?

RANGE: 0-9
00..... NONE SKIP TO Q7
98..... Unsure SKIP TO Q7
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say SKIP TO Q7

31. **[Q57C3] [IF Q57C2=1-9]** During the last month, how often did adults in your household access online social network sites?
1..... Several times a day
2..... Several times a week
3..... Once per week or less
4..... Not in the last month
5..... Other
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

PROGRAMMER NOTE: SKIP TO Q177F IF ((Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24= 2,8,9, or Missing))

32. **[Q7]** About how many electronic greeting cards (not e-mail messages) did your household send through the Internet last month? [RANGE: 0-80]
98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

NOTE: SKIP Q55J and Q55K IF (Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24 = 2,8,9, or Missing))

33. **[Q55J]** In the last **twelve months**, did anyone in your household make any purchases over the Internet?
1..... Yes CONTINUE
2..... No => GO TO Q177F
8..... Unsure => GO TO Q177F
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say => GO TO Q177F

34. **[Q55K]** In the last **month**, did anyone in your household make any purchases over the Internet?
1..... Yes CONTINUE
2..... No => GO TO Q177F
8..... Unsure => GO TO Q177F
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say => GO TO Q177F

NOTE: SKIP Q55R IF (Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24 = 2,8,9, or Missing))

35. **[Q55R]** [**IFQ55K=1**] In the last month, about how many purchases did your household make over the Internet? [RANGE: 0-200]

000..... None SKIP TO Q177F
998..... Unsure SKIP TO Q177F
999..... Not applicable/Rather not say SKIP TO Q177F

36. **[Q177A]** [**IF Q55R>0&<998**] How many of these Internet purchases were shipped and delivered, as opposed to being delivered electronically (such as e-tickets, software, or a gift certificate for an online retailer)? [RANGE: 0-200]

000 .....None
998 .....Unsure
999 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

PROGRAMMER NOTE: SKIP Q177B IF (Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24 = 2,8,9, or Missing))

37. **[Q177B]** Thinking about your most recent Internet purchase, was it shipped and/or delivered to
0 .....No one in my HH has ever purchased anything on the internet
1 .....Your home address
2 .....Your work address
3 .....Your school address
4 .....Another person's address
5 .....Pick up at store / shipped to store
6 .....Delivered electronically
7 .....Other. Please specify in the box.
8 .....Unsure
9 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

38. **[Q177F]** [**ASK ALL**] Do you feel more secure providing and/or receiving personal information through the Internet or through the U.S. Mail, or is it about the same?

1 .....Feel more secure providing personal information through the Internet
2 .....Feel more secure providing personal information through the US Mail
3 .....It's about the same
8 .....Unsure
9 .....Rather Not Say

39. **[SCRP3]** In the next several questions, we will ask you about the bills and statements your household receives in the mail and online. For these questions, please count credit card statements as bills rather than statements. Press 'Next' to continue

40. **[Q27]** [**ASK ALL**] **How many bills does your household receive through the mail each month?** For example utilities, cable, & credit card bills? **[***RANGE: 0-80*]

00 .....None → go to Q27C
98 .....Unsure → go to Q27_AA
99 .....Rather not say → go to Q27_AA

41. **[Q27_AA]** What are the reasons you receive bills through the mail instead of receiving them by Internet? [MULTIPLE RESPONSE, UP TO 5 RESPONSES]

27 .....No internet access to receive bills online
25 .....Have not set things up to receive bills online
26 .....Biller only sends bills by mail (or Biller does not send bills online)
08 .....Security/Privacy
14 .....Record Keeping
19 .....Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20 .....I have always done it this way
30 .....I do not receive any bills in the mail
97 .....Other, Specify
98 .....Unsure
99 .....Rather not say

42. **[NEW] [Q27_AAA]** Of those you selected, what is the **main** reason you receive bills through the mail instead of receiving them by Internet? [PROGRAMMER: ALLOW ONE RESPONSE; ONLY DISPLAY OPTIONS SELECTED IN Q27_AA]

27..... No internet access to receive bills online
25..... Have not set things up to receive bills online
26..... Biller only sends bills by mail (or Biller does not send bills online)
08..... Security/Privacy
14..... Record Keeping
19..... Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20..... I have always done it this way
30..... I do not receive any bills in the mail
97..... Other, Specify
98..... Unsure
99..... Rather not say

43. **[Q27C]** [**ASK ALL**] **How many statements does your household receive through the mail each month?** Please remember not to include credit card statements in this total. **[***RANGE: 0-80*]

00..... None → go to Q28
98..... Unsure → go to Q27DD
99..... Rather not say → go to Q27DD

44. **[Q27DD]** What are the reasons you receive statements through the mail instead of receiving them by Internet? [MULTIPLE RESPONSE, UP TO 5 RESPONSES]

27..... No internet access to receive statements online
25..... Have not set things up to receive statements online
26..... Biller only sends statements by mail (or Biller does not send statements online)
08..... Security/Privacy
14..... Record Keeping
19..... Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20..... I have always done it this way
30..... I do not receive any statements in the mail
97..... Other, Specify
98..... Unsure
99..... Rather not say

45. **[NEW] [Q27DDD]** Of those you selected, what is the **main** reason you receive statements through the mail instead of receiving them by Internet? PROGRAMMER ONLY ONE RESPONSE, ONLY DISPLAY OPTIONS SELECTED FROM Q27DD]

27..... No internet access to receive statements online
25..... Have not set things up to receive statements online
26..... Biller only sends statements by mail (or Biller does not send statements online)
08..... Security/Privacy
14..... Record Keeping
19..... Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20..... I have always done it this way
30..... I do not receive any statements in the mail
97..... Other, Specify
98..... Unsure
99..... Rather not say

NOTE: SKIP TO Q28C IF ((Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24= 2,8,9, or Missing))

46. **[Q28]** How many bills does your household receive on-line at a website or through e-mail each month? For example utilities, cable, & credit card bills? **[**RANGE: 0-80]

00 .....None **GO TO Q28C**
98 .....Unsure
99 .....Rather not say

47. **[Q28B]** How many of these <Q28> bills that you receive online at a website or through email do you also receive a bill in the mail? [RANGE: 0-80]

00 .....None
98 .....Unsure
99 .....Rather not say

48. **[Q28D]** [**If Q28 >0**] What are the reasons you receive bills online? [MULTIPLE RESPONSE, UP TO 5 RESPONSES]

27 .....Biller only provides online bills
02 .....Received a financial incentive
06 .....Avoided a financial penalty
07 .....Environmental
08 .....Security/Privacy
14 .....Record Keeping
21 .....Reduce Clutter
19 .....Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20 .....I have always done it this way
30 .....I do not receive any bills online
97 .....Other, Specify
98 .....Unsure
99 .....Rather not say

49. **[Q28DD]** Of those you selected, what is the **main** reason you receive bills online? [PROGRAMMER: ALLOW ONE RESPONSE, ONLY DISPLAY RESPONSES SELECTED IN Q28D]

27 .....Biller only provides online bills
02 .....Received a financial incentive
06 .....Avoided a financial penalty
07 .....Environmental
08 .....Security/Privacy
14 .....Record Keeping
21 .....Reduce Clutter
19 .....Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20 .....I have always done it this way
30 .....I do not receive any bills online
97 .....Other, Specify
98 .....Unsure
99 .....Rather not say

50. **[Q28C]** [**ASK ALL**] Did you receive any bills online a year ago?

01 .....Yes
02 .....No
08 .....Unsure
09 .....Rather not say

NOTE: SKIP TO Q28F IF ((Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24= 2,8,9, or Missing))

51. **[Q28A]** How many statements does your household receive on-line at a website or through e-mail each month? Please remember not to include credit card statements in this total. [RANGE: 0-80]

00..... None GO TO Q28F
98..... Unsure
99..... Rather not say

52. **[Q28E]** For how many of these <Q28A> statements that you receive online at a website or through email do you also receive a statement in the mail? [RANGE: 0-80]

00..... None
98..... Unsure
99..... Rather not say

53. **[Q28G]** [**If Q28A >0**] What are the reasons you receive Statements online? [MULTIPLE RESPONSE,- UP TO 5 RESPONSES]

27..... Biller only provides online statements
02..... Received a financial incentive
06..... Avoided a financial penalty
07..... Environmental
08..... Security/Privacy
14..... Record Keeping
21..... Reduce Clutter
19..... Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20..... .. I have always done it this way
30..... I do not receive any statements online
97..... Other, Specify
98..... Unsure
99..... Rather not say

54. **[NEW] [Q28GG]** Of those you selected, what is the **main** reason you receive Statements online? [PROGRAMMER: ALLOW ONE RESPONSE,- ONLY DISPLAY OPTIONS SELECTED IN Q28G]

27..... Biller only provides online statements
02..... Received a financial incentive
06..... Avoided a financial penalty
07..... Environmental
08..... Security/Privacy
14..... Record Keeping
21..... Reduce Clutter
19..... Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20..... .. I have always done it this way
30..... I do not receive any statements online
97..... Other, Specify
98..... Unsure
99..... Rather not say

55. **[Q28F]** [**ASK ALL**] Did you receive any Statements online a year ago?

1..... Yes
2..... No
8..... Unsure
9..... Rather not say

56. **[Q29]** About how many total bills does your household pay, by any method, in an average month? [RANGE: 0-80]

98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

57. **[Q31]** Of these <Q29> household bills, about how many are paid…

NOTE: SKIP ALL THE INTERNET QUESTIONS (Q31D, Q31H, Q31I) IF (Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24 = 2,8,9, or Missing)

[Q31A] By mail RANGE: 0-80

98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

[Q31D] By Internet using a desktop computer or laptop? RANGE: 0-40

98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

[Q31H] By Internet using a mobile phone or smartphone? RANGE: 0-40

98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

[Q31I] By Internet using another device, such as a tablet? RANGE: 0-40

98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

[Q31B] In Person RANGE: 0-80

98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

[Q31C] By telephone call RANGE: 0-20

98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

[Q31F] By automatic deduction from bank account, or charge to debit card (Do not include online bill pay from a bank) RANGE: 0-21

98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

[Q31G] By automatic charge to credit card RANGE: 0-20

98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

NOTE: SKIP ALL THE INTERNET QUESTIONS (Q31D1, Q31H1, Q31I1) IF (Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24 = 2,8,9, or Missing)

58. **[Q31A1]** Did you pay bills by mail a year ago?

1 ..... Yes
2 ..... No
8 ..... Unsure
9 ..... Rather not say

59. **[Q31D1]** Did you pay bills by internet using a pc or laptop a year ago?

1 ..... Yes
2 ..... No
8 ..... Unsure
9 ..... Rather not say

60. **[Q31H1]** Did you pay bills by Internet using a mobile phone or smartphone a year ago?

1 ..... Yes
2 ..... No
8 ..... Unsure
9 ..... Rather not say

61. **[Q31I1]** Did you pay bills by Internet using another device, such as a tablet a year ago?

1 ..... Yes
2 ..... No
8 ..... Unsure
9 ..... Rather not say

62. **[Q31B1]** Did you pay bills in-person a year ago?

1 ..... Yes
2 ..... No
8 ..... Unsure
9 ..... Rather not say

63. **[Q31C1]** Did you pay bills by telephone call a year ago?

1 ..... Yes
2 ..... No
8 ..... Unsure
9 ..... Rather not say

64. **[Q31F1]** Did you pay bills by automatic deduction from bank account, or charge to debit card a year ago?

1 ..... Yes
2 ..... No
8 ..... Unsure
9 ..... Rather not say

65. **[Q31G1]** Did you pay bills by automatic charge to credit card a year ago?

1 ..... Yes
2 ..... No
8 ..... Unsure
9 ..... Rather not say

ONLY ASK Q33A IF RESPONDENT SAID THEY PAY THAT WAY In NEWQ31A

66. **[Q33A]** What are the reasons you pay bills by mail? Select up to 5. [MULTIPLE RESPONSE – ALLOW UP TO 5]

27 ..... No internet access to pay electronically
25 .....Have not set things up to pay electronically
26 .....Biller prefers/requires payment by mail
08 .....Security/Privacy
14 .....Record Keeping
19 .....Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20……..I have always done it this way
97 .....Other, Specify
98 .....Unsure
99 .....Rather not say

67. **[NEW] [Q33AA]** Of those you selected, what is the main reason you pay bills by mail? [PROGRAMMING NOTE: DISPLAY ONLY THE ANSWERS SELECTED IN Q33A AS THE ANSWER CHOICES & ONLY ALLOW ONE RESPONSE]

27 ..... No internet access to pay electronically
25 .....Have not set things up to pay electronically
26 .....Biller prefers/requires payment by mail
08 .....Security/Privacy
14 .....Record Keeping
19 .....Convenience (Ease of use/Saves time)
20……..I have always done it this way
97 .....Other, Specify
98 .....Unsure
99 .....Rather not say

ONLY ASK Q34A, Q34A1 IF RESPONDENT SAID THEY PAY THAT WAY In NEWQ31C-NEWQ31I [>0 AND NOT 98,99] Exclude NEWQ31B>0 "in person"

68. **[Q34A]** What are the reasons you pay bills by electronic methods, such as Online, Automatic deduction from your bank, by phone, or Auto Charge to a Credit Card? [PROGRAMMER NOTE: MULTIPLE RESPONSE,- UP TO 5 RESPONSES]

00 .....Biller prefers/requires payment electronically
01 .....To save postage costs
02 .....Convenience (ease of use/saves time)
03 .....Received financial incentive
04 .....Avoided a financial penalty
05 .....Environmental
06 .....Reduce paper clutter
08 .....Security/Privacy
14 .....Record Keeping
20 .....I have always done it this way
97 .....Other, Specify [O_Q34A]
98 .....Unsure
99 .....Rather not say

[PROGRAMMER: DISPLAY ONLY THE ANSWERS SELECTED IN Q34A AS THE ANSWER CHOICES IN Q34A1, AND ONLY ALLOW THEM SELECT ONE ANSWER.]

69. **[Q34A1]** Of those you selected, what is the main reason you pay bills by electronic methods, such as Online, Automatic deduction from your bank, by phone, or Auto Charge to a Credit Card? [PROGRAMMING NOTE: ONLY ALLOW ONE RESPONSE]

00..... Biller prefers/requires payment electronically
01..... To save postage costs
02..... Convenience (ease of use/saves time)
03..... Received financial incentive
04..... Avoided a financial penalty
05..... Environmental
06..... Reduce paper clutter
08..... Security/Privacy
14..... Record Keeping
20..... I have always done it this way
97..... Other, Specify [O_Q34A1]
98..... Unsure
99..... Rather not say

70. **[Q36]** How many different magazine subscriptions do members of your household receive through the mail? [RANGE: 0-50]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

PROGRAMMER NOTE: SKIP Q37 IF (Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24 = 2,8,9, or Missing))

71. **[Q37]** How many different magazine subscriptions do members of your household receive online? [RANGE: 0-50]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

72. **[Q38]** How many different magazine subscriptions do members of your household receive through another method? [RANGE: 0-15]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

73. **[Q40]** How many different newspaper subscriptions do members of your household receive through the U.S. Mail? [RANGE: 0-15]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

PROGRAMMER NOTE: SKIP Q41 IF (Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24 = 2,8,9, or Missing))

74. **[Q41]** How many different newspaper subscriptions do members of your household receive online? [RANGE: 0-32]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

75. **[Q42]** How many different newspaper subscriptions do members of your household receive through another method? [RANGE: 0-32]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

76. **[Q47]** When members of your household receive advertising material through the mail, do they...

1 .....Usually read it
2 .....Usually scan it
3 .....Read some, don't read others
4 .....Usually don't read it
8 .....Unsure
9 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

77. **[Q53]** In the **last month**, did anyone in your household buy anything as a result of receiving advertising, a catalog or other promotional material in the mail, including credit card solicitations?

1 .....Yes CONTINUE
2 .....No => GO TO Q178
8 .....Unsure => GO TO Q178
9 .....Not applicable/Rather not say => GO TO Q178

78. **[Q54]** How many of those purchases were placed … **[SKIP Q54D Q54H Q54I IF (Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing)** AND (**Q24 = 2,8,9, or Missing**)]

[Q54A] By mail [RANGE: 0-80]

[Q54D] By Internet using a computer? [RANGE: 0-40]

[Q54H] By Internet using a mobile phone or smart phone? [RANGE: 0-40]

[Q54I] By Internet using another device such as a tablet? [RANGE: 0-40]

[Q54B] In Person [RANGE: 0-80]

[Q54C] By telephone call [RANGE: 0-40]

[Q54F] Some Other Method [RANGE: 0-40]

98 .....Unsure
99……..Not applicable/Rather not say

79. **[Q178].** Do you typically use coupons when you shop?

1 .....Yes
2 .....No
8 .....Unsure
9 .....Rather not say

80. **[Q179]** During the past month, how many coupons did you and/or members of your household use that were received through the mail?

[ENTER NUMBER, RANGE 0-50]

98 .....Unsure
99 .....Rather not say

81. **[Q180]** [SKIP IF (Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24 = 2,8,9, or Missing))] During the past month, how many coupons did you and/or members of your household use that were received online on your computer, cell phone, or other internet device?

[ENTER NUMBER RANGE 0-50]
98 .....Unsure
99 .....Rather not say

82. **[Q181]** During the past month, how many coupons did you and/or members of your household use that were received by another method – such as newspaper, magazine, door-hanger, or in-store promotion?

[ENTER NUMBER RANGE 0-50]
98 ..... Unsure
99 ..... Rather not say

83. **[SCRP5]** The Postal Service is interested in learning more about what makes up its mail volume. Financial accounts produce bills and statements which represent a large portion of the mail. As with everything in this survey, your answers are completely confidential.

We simply want to get a sense of the volume and types of mail you receive from financial companies such as banks, credit cards, investment firms and similar organizations. We do not ask any details about your personal financial information.

1..... Continue

84. **[Q57]** How many total financial accounts do household members have such as Bank or Credit Union, Loans, Stocks, mutual funds, or retirement accounts, etc.? (RANGE: 0-80)

NOTE: Please be assured we are not collecting any specific financial information and your answers will remain completely confidential.

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

85. **[Q58]** How many total insurance policies do household members have such as Property, Life, Health, Automobile, etc? Please exclude any policies held through their jobs. [Range: 100]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

86. **[Q59]** How many total credit cards do household members have such as Bank, Gasoline, and Retail store cards, etc.? [Range: 100].

NOTE: Please be assured we are not collecting any specific financial information and your answers will remain completely confidential.

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

87. **[Q60]** The next set of questions are for classification purposes only. The answers allow us to compare your household to other households with similar characteristics. Including yourself, how many people live in your household? [RANGE 1-16]

01..... ONE => GO TO AGE
98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

88. **[Q65]** How many are 18 years of age or older? [RANGE 1-10]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

IF Q65 = Q60 BUT NOT 01 or 99, SKIP TO SCRP6

89. **[Q61]** How many of are under age 6? [RANGE 0-9]

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

90. **[Q62]** How many are between the ages of 6 and 12? [RANGE 0-6]

98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

91. **[Q63]** How many are between the ages of 13 and 17? [RANGE 0-5]

98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

92. **[SCRP6] ONLY SHOW SCRP6 IF Q65>1** The next questions concern the <Q65> [people/person] in your household, 18 years of age and older. Let's begin with you.

1 .....CONTINUE

93. **[AGE]** What is <your/their> age?

01 18-21
02 22-24
03 25-34
04 35-44
05 45-54
06 55-64
07 65-69
08 70-74
09 .....75+
98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

[ONLY SHOW RESTG IF Q65>1]

94. **[RESTG]** What is their gender?

1 .....Male
2 .....Female
8 .....Unsure
9 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

95. **[Q68]** What is <your/their> marital status?

1 .....Married
2 .....Living as married
3 .....Single, never been married
4 .....Divorced
5 .....Separated
6 .....Widowed
8 .....Unsure
9 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

96. **[Q69]** Are <you/they> currently…

1 .....Employed full-time => GO TO Q79
2 .....Employed part-time => GO TO Q79
3 .....Retired, or
4 .....Not employed
5 .....Self-employed => GO TO Q79
8 .....Unsure
9 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

97. **[Q70]** Have <you/they> been employed within the last 12-months?

1..... Yes => GO TO Q79
2..... No IF Q69=3 AND Q70=2 SKIP TO Q79
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

98. **[Q71]** Are <you/they> currently…

1..... A student => GO TO Q79
2..... A homemaker => GO TO Q79
3..... Disabled => GO TO Q79
4..... Temporarily laid off => GO TO Q79
5..... Retired => GO TO Q79
6..... Other, specify => GO TO Q79
8..... Unsure => GO TO Q79
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say => GO TO Q79

99. **[Q79]** What is the highest level of education <YOU/THEY> have obtained?

1..... 8th grade or less
2..... Some high school
3..... High school graduate
4..... Some college
5..... Technical school graduate
6..... College graduate
7..... Post graduate work
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

100. **[Q81A]** Are <you/they> of Spanish/Hispanic/Latino Origin?

1..... YES
2..... NO
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

101. **[Q81B]** Which of the following do <you/they> consider <yourself/themselves> household member to be?

1..... White/Caucasian
2..... Black/African American
3..... Asian
4..... American Indian and Alaska Native
5..... Native Hawaiian and Other Pacific Islander
7..... Other, Specify
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

102. **[Q82]** Would <you/they> say <you/they> are one of the heads of the household?

1..... Yes
2..... No
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

[**END OF ROSTER – if more than 1 Adult, go back to RESTG]**

103. **[Q84]** For statistical purposes, was your total household income last year, before taxes and including all household members, above or below $50,000?

We understand if you feel uncomfortable answering this question. However, we only ask about income to ensure all households are equally represented in our survey. Your answer is completely confidential and only used as part of this research study in combination with other households across the country.

1 .....Under $50,000 a year > Q85
2 .....Over $50,000 a year > Q86
8 .....Unsure
9 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

104. **[Q85]** [IF UNDER $50K] And which income category best matches your household income...

01 .....Under $7,000 a year
02 .....$7,000 - $9,999 a year
03 .....$10,000 - $14,999 a year
04 .....$15,000 - $19,999 a year
05 .....$20,000 - $24,999 a year
06 .....$25,000 - $34,999 a year
07 .....$35,000 - $49,999 a year
98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

This more specific detail is used to analyze the data and will not be used for any purpose outside this study.

105. **[Q86]** [IF OVER $50K] And which income category best matches your household income…

08 .....$50,000 - $64,999 a year
09 .....$65,000 - $79,999 a year
10 .....$80,000 - $99,999 a year
11 .....$100,000 - $119,999 a year
12 .....$120,000 - $149,999 a year
13 .....$150,000 and over
98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

This more specific detail is used to analyze the data and will not be used for any purpose outside this study.

[INCOME] : COMPUTED HH INCOME

106. **[Q87]** Do you own or rent your home?

1 .....Own
2 .....Rent
8 .....Unsure
9 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

107. **[Q88]** How long have you lived in your present home?
If you have lived there less than one year, please enter "0". [RANGE 0-80]

8 .....Unsure
9 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

108. **[Q89]** Which of the following best describes your home?

1 .....Single family detached home
2 .....Apartment or condominium
3 .....Mobile home
6 .....Duplex or townhouse

8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

109. **[CLPHL]** How many mobile or cell phones does your household have? RANGE 0-20

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

110. **[PHNLNS]** Do you have a landline in your household? Please do not include cell phones in this total.

1..... Yes
2..... No
8..... Unsure
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say

111. **[Q92]** Do you or any member of your household have a business that is operated from home?

1..... Yes
2..... No => GO TO Q97
8..... Unsure => GO TO Q97
9..... Not applicable/Rather not say => GO TO Q97

112. **[Q93]** About how many pieces of mail does the business receive each week? RANGE 0-75

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

113. **[Q94]** About how many pieces of mail does the business send each week? RANGE 0-75

98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

114. **[SCRP7]** Remember, when you do your household diary, we are interested only in household mail, so please do not include this business mail in your diary. Click on the NEXT button to continue.

CONTINUE 1 DI

115. **[Q97]** There are just a few more questions.

What is the diary study all about? The second part of this study involves filling out daily diaries. In them, you answer detailed questions about the mail your household sends and receives for 7 days. Once you complete the diaries, you will receive your choice of either 100 Forever Stamps or a $40 check. You can expect your gift to arrive roughly 10 to 12 weeks after we receive your completed diaries.

How much time does it take? How long it takes depends on how much mail you receive. The first day of your diary-recording week will take the longest as you become more familiar with the survey. After that, on average, it should only take about 3-5 minutes for each piece of mail. To help you, we have a USPS hotline available to provide you with step-by-step instructions if needed, and to answer any questions you may have. That toll free number is 1-888-441-8777. You may also want to check out the study web site at www.nustats.com/uspsstudy.htm.

I will participate in the diary portion of the study 1
I do not wish to do the diary portion ..... 9 => OLIST

116. **[GIFT]** Which gift would you like to receive for completing the diaries?

2..... 100 Forever Stamps

3 .....Forty dollars

117. **[ASSNW]** We would like for you to answer questions about your household's mail for one of the weeks listed below:

[Displays list of available Assns. If one is selected, continue to DIARY]

[END OF YEAR ONLY DISPLAY THIS Assn 15999] Can't participate on <Last ASSN> -> GO TO INT06

118. **[**INT06**]:** Your household was selected to participate in the diary study the week of <Last ASSN>. If your household cannot participate during the specified time, please exit the survey and thank you for your participation. If you can participate during this time, press Continue."

Continue > Go to DIARY
Exit Survey > Disposition code: QA

119. **[**DIARY**]** Next, we want to confirm that you understand we'll be mailing you a set of household diaries that you'll complete during your assignment week, which is <ASSN>. In appreciation for completing those diaries, we will send you the gift you requested which takes about 10-12 weeks once we receive your completed diaries.

Continue

120. **[RESPF/RESPL]** So that we may mail the survey materials to you, please tell us your full name? We ask for your name to ensure proper delivery of your survey packet. **Please enter only the first and last name. Please do not enter middle initial, Mr. or Mrs.**

[RFNAM] First Name
[RLNAM] Last Name

NOTE: For processing purposes, it is important that we have only one first and one last name per household. Any additional information will delay processing.

[PROGRAMMING NOTE: RESPF AND RESPL ARE MOVED INTO RFNAM AND RLNAM]

121. **[MATRL]** Would you prefer your diary materials in English or Spanish?

1 .....English
2 .....Spanish

122. **[DIFPH]** A few days after we mail your diaries, we want to call to make sure you've received them and also to remind you of the dates we need you to track your mail.

123. **[OTHPH]** What is your home phone number? If you do not wish to give us your home phone number, you may enter another number where we might reach you or leave it blank

FORMAT 999-999-9999
[PROGRAMMER: ALLOW OTHPH TO BE LEFT BLANK ->EMAIL)
IF OTHPH PROVIDED, THEN SKIP TO INT99]

124. **[EMAIL] [IF OTHPH is left blank]** Since no phone was entered, maybe it would be easier for us to contact you via email to remind you about your diary dates. Please enter the email address you prefer we use (Example john@email.com): [PROGRAMMER NOTE: ALLOW EMAIL TO BE LEFT BLANK->PHONE1, IF EMAIL NOT BLANK -> INT99]

125. **[PHONE1] [IF EMAIL and OTHPH is left blank]** We understand not wanting to share personal information, like phone numbers and email addresses. It's important that we have a way to reach you to remind you about your diary tracking, and also to answer any questions you have about the study. All information collected in the Household Diary Study is confidential and we do not sell, rent, loan or in any way share personal information with anyone. Please provide the phone number or email address you prefer we use.

1..... Provide Phone -> OTHPH
2..... Provide email -> EMAIL
9..... Will not provide -> INT99

126. **[INT99]** Thank you very much for your participation. The diaries will be sent to the mailing address you verified at the beginning of the survey. Our toll free phone number is 1-888-441-8777. Please call us if you have any questions. We greatly appreciate your participation.

127. **[INT03]** Although you do not wish to continue with our survey, we appreciate the time you have given us today. Thank you and goodbye.

RF..... Refused to do diaries => GO TO END

128. **[INT10]** Thank you very much for your time. I'm sorry if we inconvenienced you, but we need to attempt to contact the household currently using the other mailing address. For this survey, the USPS has randomly selected households based on their mailing address. If you have any questions, please call 1-888-441-8777. Have a nice evening/day.

QN……Not qualified due to address change => GO TO END

129. **[OLIST]** IF REFUSES TO PARTICIPATE In DIARY STUDY: If you participate in the survey, you will be eligible to receive 100 Forever Stamps or $40. Are you certain you do not wish to continue with the diary portion of the survey? Would you please tell us why you do not want to participate in our survey? OPEN END => INT03 code as RF

130. **[INTRO]** Welcome back to the U.S. Postal Service Survey. You began an interview concerning your household's mail and we would like you to complete the survey now.

2=CONTINUE WHERE I LEFT OFF

1=RESTART AT THE BEGINNING

131. **[INT]** ENTER FINAL DISPOSITION. "Thank you for your time, I'm sorry if we've inconvenienced you, but we have filled the quota for the region in which you live. For this survey, the USPS has randomly selected households based on their mailing address. If you have any questions, please call 1-888-441-8777. Have a nice evening/day." OQ

132. **[INT99]** SURVEY COMPLETE

CW…….WEB COMPLETE

Appendix C2: Diary Package - Advance Letter

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE

August 28, 2017

Postal Resident
«ADDRESS»
«CITY», «STATE» «ZIP» «SAMPN»-«REPLICATE»

The U.S. Postal Service is guided by one principle: we exist to serve our customers. This vision is our commitment to ensuring a vital Postal Service for future generations.

To assist us in meeting that commitment, we are conducting our 30th annual Household Diary Study for 2017! That's why your household, along with others in your area, were selected to answer questions about your household's mail and to record information about the mail your household sends and receives for a one-week period.

We will provide your household with postal diaries in which to record this information, along with easy-to-read instructions on how to complete them. This information will help us better understand current trends in the volume and types of mail households handle on a daily basis. Ultimately, your response will help us make important decisions about performance improvements and investments in new equipment, facilities, programs, and technologies to better serve you.

As thanks for your time and participation in this study, you will have a choice of ONE of the following:

- **Forty dollars**
- **100 First-Class stamps**

We will make your participation as convenient as possible. You have three options for being part of the Household Diary Study:

Online: This is the simplest and most convenient; you can complete the initial questionnaire about your household and the mail you send and receive any time you want by going to: **http://surveys.nustats.com/USPSWEB.htm** and enter **PIN#: «SAMPN»**.

Phone: Just call us at **1-888-441-8777** and we will answer any questions you might have and conduct the initial interview by phone at a convenient time for you. Please see the telephone hotline hours below.

Mail: Fill out and send the green postcard and we will call you at the time of your request to answer any questions and conduct the initial interview.

All information collected is strictly confidential in order to protect your privacy.

For any questions about the project or to give us the best phone number and time for reaching you, please visit **www.nustats.com/uspsstudy.htm** anytime, or call our hotline at **1-888-441-8777** between 11am and 9pm Central time Monday to Wednesday or 12pm to 5pm Thursday to Sunday.

Thank you for joining us in the Household Diary Study!

Sincerely,

John F. Mazzone
Manager, USPS Household Diary Study

Voltee para Español ➔

475 L'Enfant Plaza SW
Washington DC 20260-0010

28 de Agosto de 2017

Residente Postal
«ADDRESS»
«CITY», «STATE» «ZIP» «SAMPN»-«REPLICATE»

El Servicio Postal de los Estados Unidos se conduce bajo un principio: existimos para servir a nuestros clientes. Esta visión es nuestro compromiso para asegurar un Servicio Postal vital para las futuras generaciones.

Para ayudarnos a alcanzar este compromiso, estamos realizando nuestro 30vo Estudio Domiciliario en Diarios anual para El 2017. Esta es la razón por la cual su hogar, junto con otros en su área, fue seleccionado para responder preguntas acerca del correo de su hogar y registrar la información acerca de la correspondencia enviada y recibida por su hogar en un período de una semana.

Le proporcionaremos a su hogar unos diarios postales en los cuales podrá registrar esta información, junto con instrucciones de fácil lectura acerca de cómo completarlos. Esta información nos ayudará a entender mejor tendencias actuales en el volumen y tipos de correo que los hogares manejan de forma diaria. Por último, su respuesta nos ayudará a tomar decisiones importantes acerca de mejoras en nuestro desempeño e inversiones en nuevos equipos, instalaciones, programas y tecnologías para servirle mejor.

Como muestra de agradecimiento por su tiempo y participación en este estudio, usted tendrá la opción de recibir uno de los siguientes:

- **Cuarenta dólares**
- **100 Estampillas de primera clase (First-Class)**

Haremos todo lo posible para que su participación se realice de la manera más conveniente para usted. Tiene usted tres opciones para ser parte del Estudio Domiciliario en Diarios:

Internet: Participar por Internet es la opción más fácil y conveniente. En cualquier momento, usted puede completar la primera parte del estudio en la que se le hacen preguntas sobre su hogar y el correo que envía y recibe. Sólo visite **http://surveys.nustats.com/USPSWEBSP.htm** e ingrese el **número de PIN: «SAMPN»**.

Teléfono: Sólo llámenos al **1-888-441-8777** y le llamaremos para contestar cualquier pregunta que tenga e iniciar la primera parte del estudio o programar una hora que sea conveniente para usted. Por favor consulte el horario de la línea de asistencia del proyecto que aparece abajo.

Correo: Llene y envíe la tarjeta postal verde y nos comunicaremos con usted a la hora indicada en la tarjeta para contestar cualquier pregunta que tenga e iniciar la primera parte del estudio.

Toda la información recopilada es estrictamente confidencial para proteger su privacidad.

Si tiene cualquier pregunta sobre el estudio o desea proporcionarnos un número telefónico y la hora más conveniente para comunicarnos con usted, por favor visite **www.nustats.com/uspsstudy.htm** en cualquier momento, o llame gratis a nuestra línea de asistencia del proyecto al **1-888-441-8777** de lunes a miércoles de 11am a 9pm hora central o jueves a domingo de 12pm a 5pm.

¡Agradecemos su participación en el Estudio Domiciliario en Diarios!

Atentamente,



John F. Mazzone
Director, Estudio Domiciliario en Diarios de USPS

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Diary Package Cover Letter

USPS Household Diary Study

What is the Household Diary Study?

The Household Diary Study is a national research effort sponsored by the U.S. Postal Service. The information collected from households like yours will be used to help us design systems to use our resources most effectively, develop strategies for making wise decisions, and monitor the effects of electronic technology on regular mail service. Ultimately, the data will be used to find ways of keeping the cost of service at a minimum.

The study is conducted on our behalf by NuStats, a professional research firm in Austin, Texas. NuStats ensures all information collected is strictly confidential and is used for our research purposes only. The information from your household will be used only in combination with data from other participating households.

What are we asking of you?

Answer questions about all the mail and packages your household receives and sends for seven days. We are only interested in the mail you send and receive for the dates that are on your Answer Booklets.

Here's how:

- **Read Steps 1-7 in the Instruction Booklet first** – this is important because it explains how to correctly fill out the Answer Booklets and provides visual examples.
- **Review the Photo Quick Start**.
- **Answer questions from the Question Booklet by recording the codes in the Answer Booklets**. Do this for all the mail and packages your household receives and sends each day.
- **Select your choice of gift on the Gift Selection Form** *(please allow 10-12 weeks for processing)*.
- **Return all completed Answer Booklets, Mail Pieces, and the Gift Selection Form in the postage-paid Priority Mail envelope** – drop in any public U.S. Postal Service mailbox or post office.

Your package includes: *(each item is numbered in the top right-hand corner)*

1.	Instruction Booklet	**4a.-4g.**	Answer Booklets – 1 for each day	**7.**	"I'm done . . ." postcard
2.	Photo Quick Start	**5a.-5g.**	Daily Envelopes – 1 for each day	**8.**	Priority Mail envelope
3.	Question Booklet	**6.**	Gift Selection Form		

If you have any questions about how to complete the survey, call the USPS Hotline at **1-888-441-USPS (8777)** available 11am-9pm CST (Mon-Wed), 11am-5pm CST (Thu & Fri), or 12pm-5pm CST (Sat & Sun).

I would like to thank you again for your participation and willingness to do the research that will help us improve our performance at your local post office.

Sincerely,



John F. Mazzone
Manager, USPS Household Diary Study

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Instruction Booklet

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Instruction Booklet

PLEASE READ THIS FIRST!

Includes instructions for completing the Answer Booklets and examples of postage and mail markings for each type of mail, behind the color-coded tabs

Common Terms & Questions

Here are definitions of some of the terms that we use throughout the Household Diary materials and the most frequently asked question.

Common Terms

- **Mail Pieces** are the different pieces of mail that you receive and send – letters, bills, postcards, magazines, advertisements, packages, etc.
- **Mail Type** is the category of mail that we ask you to sort your mail into. *(See the list of 6 mail types on page 1 of this booklet.)*
- **Postage** is how the piece of mail was paid for when it was sent. There are three different types of postage: Stamps, Meter, or Permit. *(See the visual examples under the color-coded tabs for each mail type*.)
- **Mail Markings** are markings that are printed on a mail piece either by the U.S. Postal Service or the mailing house. These markings indicate the postage paid and the type of mail. The Postage and Mail Markings are typically located in:
  a) the top right-hand corner of the mail piece,
  b) above or below the address, or
  c) inside the window of an envelope.

What is the difference between First-Class Mail and Presorted Standard Mail?

These are the two most common mail types. Here are some ways to help distinguish between them:

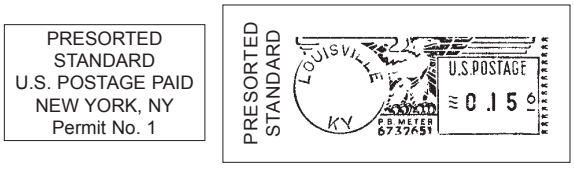
- **First-Class Mail** from businesses are often marked “First-Class” or “Presorted First-Class,” especially when they don’t have stamps. If the mail piece just has a stamp or metered strip without any of these markings, it is likely First-Class Mail.
  Hint: Most letter size envelopes will have postage of 49¢ or more, either in First-Class stamps, a metered strip, or a “Forever Stamp.”
  If it is **Presorted First-Class**, it may have less postage but it will say “Presorted First-Class.” *(See pages 5-8 in this booklet for descriptions & more visual examples.)*

Examples of Presorted First-Class Mail Markings



- **Presorted Standard** Mail pieces are always marked “Presorted Standard,” or “PRSRT STD,” or “Standard,” or “STD” usually in the upper-right corner of the mail pieces close to the stamp or meter strip. *(See pages 9-13 in this booklet for descriptions & more visual examples.)*

Examples of Presorted Standard Mail Markings



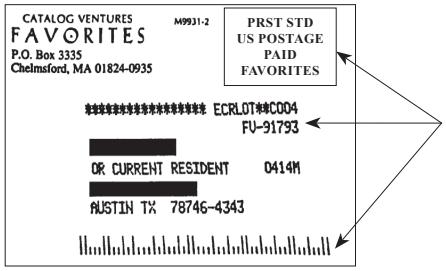
How to fill out the Answer Booklets.

1 Sort your daily mail into groups by mail type.

The first step is to sort your mail each day into groups of mail types by looking at the postage and other markings on your mail (we call these "mail markings"). All the mail you receive can be classified as one of the following 6 types*:

1. **First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail** (Purple pages)
2. **Presorted Standard Mail (PRSRT STD)** (Blue pages)
3. **Nonprofit Organization Mail** (Gray pages)
4. **Packages & Expedited Materials** (Green pages)
5. **Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals** (Yellow pages)
6. **Unaddressed Mail** – Delivered by US Postal Service only (Pink pages)

To Sort: Look at the Postage & Mail Markings



Postage & Mail Markings can be located:

- in the top right-hand corner,
- above or below the address, or
- inside the window of an envelope.

***To help you sort your mail, see the examples of postage and mail markings under the colored tab associated with each mail type.**

We are only interested in your household mail and packages:

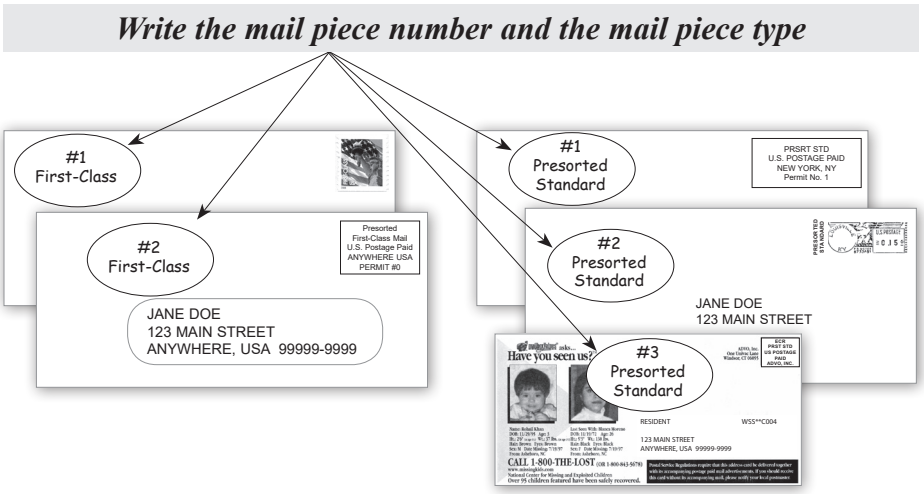
- Please DO NOT include any mail received or sent for a business, club, or association operated from your home.
- DO NOT include any mail sent to your PO Box.
- Please DO include household mail or packages that you send or receive at another location, for instance at work.

Special Circumstances

- If you did not receive or send any mail or packages, or if there was no mail service one day during your assigned week, put an "X" in the box labeled "Did Not Receive or Send any Mail/Packages Today" on page 1 of the Answer Booklet for that day.
- If household members will be away from home on any day(s) during the diary week, record all mail received in the daily answer booklet for the day on which you return.
- If you forget to pick up your mail for a day, record all mail received on the next day.
- You may not receive mail on Sunday, but you may receive packages and/or send mail out.

2 Number and label the mail pieces within each mail type.

Once your mail is sorted for that day, write the mail type on each piece of mail and then number the mail pieces within each mail type. For example, the top First-Class mail piece is #1, the next is #2, and so on until you have numbered all First-Class Mail for that day. Next, number all the other types of mail (Presorted Standard, Nonprofit, Packages, etc.) beginning again with #1, and then #2, and so on for each different mail type.



3 Complete the Summary Page (page 1) in the Answer Booklet for each day.

On this page, record the total number of mail pieces of each type that all members of your household received and sent that day. *(See Summary Page example below.)*

Summary Page

Please print clearly as in the example below: 1 OR 20

Use a pen in black or blue ink **DO NOT USE PENCIL**

Did not Receive or Send any Mail/Packages Today: → ☐

(If no mail received or sent, mark the box above with an "X." You are done for today.)

Mail RECEIVED Monday: 11 **Total # Received**

Record the total number of mail received above and then record for each mail type below.

1. **First-Class:** 4 **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 3 (PURPLE)*
   - First-Class errors: 0 # Wrong address, right person → *GO TO PAGE 3 (PURPLE)*
   - 0 # Right address, wrong person
   - 0 # Wrong address, wrong person

   } *DO NOT ANSWER QUESTIONS ABOUT THESE MAIL PIECES*
2. **Presorted Standard:** 6 **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 7 (BLUE)*
3. **Nonprofit Organization:** 0 **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 9 (GRAY)*
4. **Packages & Expedited:** 1 **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 11 (GREEN)*
5. **Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals:** 0 **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 15 (YELLOW)*
6. **Unaddressed Mail:** 0 **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 17 (PINK)*

Mail SENT Monday: 3 **Total # Sent**

- Envelopes (First-Class): 3 **Total # Sent**
- Postcards (First-Class): 0 **Total # Sent**

} *GO TO PAGE 5 (PURPLE)*

- Packages & Expedited: 0 **Total # Sent** → *GO TO PAGE 13 (GREEN)*

Monday 999642 **Page 1**

If you did not receive or send any mail or packages, or if there was no mail service one day during your assigned week:

Put an "X" in the box labeled "Did not Receive or Send any Mail/Packages Today" on the summary page for that day.

4 Open both the Question Booklet and the Answer Booklet for that day to the colored pages for the type of mail piece you have.

You will use a different Answer Booklet for each day of the week, but you use the same Question Booklet each day. Read the questions from the Question sheet (in the Question Booklet) and find the correct answers (number codes), then write them on the Answer sheet in the Answer Booklet. There are colored pages for each mail type: First-Class Mail is purple, Presorted Standard Mail is blue, etc. You can record up to 12 mail pieces for each mail type. **Remember, the postage on the mail piece determines which colored Question and Answer sheets to use.**

1. In the Answer Booklet for that day, write in the answer on the Answer Sheet using the correct number code found in the Question Booklet.
2. Starting with mail piece #1, Question A, write the codes under column #1. Using the Question Booklet, continue down the page to Question B.
3. After you are finished answering questions for mail piece #1, continue on to the questions for mail piece #2 in column #2. Continue in this way for each mail piece within each type.

Question Sheet (in Question Booklet)

Question Sheet — 3 Purple

First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received

STOP **For Presorted Standard Mail: Go to Blue page 7**

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. FORM: Was the mail piece... ***(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)***

IF THIS IS A PACKAGE: GO TO GREEN PAGE 11

1. In a letter size envelope
2. Postcard
3. Flyer or Catalog
4. In an envelope larger than letter size (not catalog)

B. ADDRESSEE: Mail piece was addressed to...

1. Male head of household
2. Female head of household
3. Male & Female head of household (Mr. & Mrs.)
4. Other adult living in household (18 and over)
5. Child (under 18)
6. Whole family
7. Current Resident, Occupant, Postal Patron, etc. (with or without street address)
8. Other addressee *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

C. RETURN ENVELOPE: Was a return envelope or card included?

1. Yes – pre-stamped or postage paid
2. Yes – needs a stamp
3. No return envelope or card included

D. SENDER TYPE: What type of industry did the mail piece come from?

Financial (including all types of credit cards):

1. Credit Card (from any bank, store, or company)
2. Bank / Savings & loan / Credit union / Loan company
3. Insurance company (medical, dental, life, auto, etc.)
4. Real estate / Mortgage
5. Investments (stock, mutual fund, retirement plan, etc.)
6. Other financial *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

Merchants:

7. Supermarket / Grocery store
8. Department / Discount store
9. Other store (electronics, shoes, clothes, hardware, etc.)
10. Mail order company
11. Restaurant (incl. fast food, pizza delivery, etc.)
12. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
13. Auto dealership (not manufacturer or service department)
14. Individual seller (on eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site)
15. Other merchants *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

Services:

16. Telephone / Cell / Cable / Satellite / Internet
17. Electric / Gas / Water / Utility company

Services continued:

18. Medical (doctor, dentist, hospital, not insurance company)
19. Other professional (lawyer, accountant, etc.)
20. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental company (Netflix, etc.)
21. Craftsman (plumber, carpenter, electrician, etc.)
22. Travel / Entertainment service (theater, hotel, airline, etc.)
23. Auto maintenance (oil change, mechanic, etc.)
24. Roadside assistance (AAA, etc.)
25. Other services *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

Manufacturers:

26. All manufacturers (makers of automobiles, computers, etc.)

Government:

27. Federal (Social Security, VA, IRS, Medicare, etc.)
28. State and Local (not a utility company)

Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political:

29. Educational (public & private schools, universities, etc.)
30. Political (campaign, political action committee, political party, etc.)
31. All other nonprofit organizations

Friend or Relative:

32. Friend or Relative (not to a business)

E. PURPOSE: What was the MAIN purpose of the mail piece? ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Holiday / Seasons greeting card
2. Other greeting cards (birthday, sympathy, thank you)
3. Invitation or announcement from friend or relative → **SKIP TO J**
4. Letter from friend or relative → **SKIP TO J**
5. Bill / Invoice / Premium (not for a credit card)
6. Financial statement (not for a credit card)
7. Credit card bill / Credit card statement
8. Notice / Announcement / Business invitation (no bills)
9. Advertising / Promotional / Sales only (no bills) → **SKIP TO G**
10. Insurance explanation of benefits
11. Tax related (information, forms, etc.)
12. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental
13. Request for donation (money, time, blood drive, goods, etc.)
14. Confirmation or thank you for donation
15. Rebate received in response to coupon submitted
16. Direct deposit receipts or check stub (not a payment)
17. New or replacement credit or debit card
18. Payment or other check / Money order / Credit (no rebate)
19. Survey / Questionnaire
20. Sweepstakes / Contest promotion
21. Newsletter
22. Prospectus
23. Social Security related (information, statement, etc.)
24. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

More questions on back of page →

Answer Sheet (in Answer Booklet)

Mail Piece #1

Mail Piece #2

Question

Code

Answer Sheet — Purple

First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns. There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. FORM	2	1	2	1	1							
B. ADDRESSEE	1	2	1	3	3							
C. RETURN ENVELOPE	3	3	3	2	3							
D. SENDER TYPE	10	32	16	1	27							
E. PURPOSE	9	4	9	7	6							
F. ADVERTISING				1	2							
G. READING	2		1	3								
H. REACTION	3		1	1								
I. RESPONSE	2		1	3								
J. CLASS **OK to choose up to 4 codes.** *(See example on pg. 2)*	1 3 4		2 5	1 4	1 9 4							

Monday 877714 **Page 3**

For questions where it is "OK to choose more than one," you can record up to four codes.

Mail Markings are important.

Tell us which mail markings are on the mail piece by answering the "Class" question at the end of each Question sheet (e.g., Question J for First-Class Mail).

To accurately answer this question, you need to record all the mail markings that are on each mail piece – these markings are placed on the mail piece either by the U.S. Postal Service or by a mailing house.

Question J - Class (First-Class Question sheet)

J. CLASS: Tell us what type of markings are on the mail piece. ***(OK to choose more than one)***

For example of First-Class Mail, see pages 5-8 of the Instruction Booklet.
Look at markings in top right-hand corner, above or below the address, & inside the window.
Remember – packages and items marked Presorted Standard, Nonprofit or Periodicals do not belong in the First Class mail type.

1. Presorted First-Class, **or** PRSRT, **or** FP
2. First-Class Postage
3. Forever Stamp
4. AUTO
5. AB, **or** AF, **or** MB, **or** AV
6. Single Piece, **or** SNGLP, **or** SP
7. Mail from outside the U.S.
8. Federal Government Mail with Official Signature (FRANKED)
9. Other Federal Government Mail
10. Other classification *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

5 Please send us your mail pieces.

We only need the envelope your mail came in, not the contents (unless it's something you don't need).
Please DO NOT CUT OUT the individual mail markings.

- **Remember to label each mail piece with the number and mail type you assigned it in the Answer Booklet** so we are able to match it to your responses.
- **If the mail piece is a catalog, magazine, flyer, or newspaper, just send the page with the mailing label and the postage.** We don't need the entire catalog or newspaper, etc.

Why do we need your mail pieces?

If we have your mail markings for each piece, we can double check that everything is correct. Each packet goes through an editing process that verifies that the mail pieces were recorded under the correct mail type (First-Class, Presorted Standard, etc.) and that all the questions were answered. The entire mail piece (i.e., the envelope) provides us with additional survey information, such as sender type.

All information collected is strictly confidential and is used for research purposes only.

6 Place your completed Answer Booklets and mail pieces in the envelopes marked Monday through Sunday.

Your completed Answer Booklets and mail pieces labeled with the mail type and mail piece number should be placed in the corresponding daily envelope.

7 Place the daily envelopes in the postage-paid Priority Mail envelope.

The daily envelopes with your completed Answer Booklets and mail pieces should be sent to NuStats in the postage-paid Priority Mail envelope.

First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received and Sent (Purple)

All First-Class Mail may not say "First-Class" on the envelope or postcard. It is important to look at the postage and mail markings on each mail piece to determine if it is First-Class or not. Use the following to help you determine if your mail piece should be recorded under this type:

- Include letter size envelopes marked "**First-Class**" or "**Presorted First-Class**."
- Include large envelopes marked "**First-Class**." Check the mail markings carefully; some large envelopes may be marked Presorted Standard or Expedited.
- Most First-Class Mail from businesses are marked "**First-Class**" or "**Presorted First-Class,**" especially when they have a metered strip and NOT a stamp.
- If the mail piece just has a stamp without being marked "**First-Class**" or "**Presorted First-Class**," (or Presorted Standard or Nonprofit, etc.) it is probably First-Class Mail.
- Most letter size envelopes will have postage of 49¢ or more, either in stamps or on a metered strip (the postage may also be in the form of a "Forever Stamp"). If it is "**Presorted First-Class,**" it may have less postage but it will be marked as "Presorted First-Class."
- Postcards *usually* have 34¢ postage for First-Class. Some postcards are larger in size than a typical picture postcard. However, if it is larger than the postcard dimensions (see page 2 of the Question Booklet), then it is considered a flyer.
- The most common First-Class Mail pieces are letters, bills, postcards, greeting cards, checks, and money orders.
- Include mail ***(that is not a package)*** sent with special services, such as Certified, Registered, or Insured.
- Include magazines, catalogs, newsletters, or other periodicals that are marked "**First-Class**."

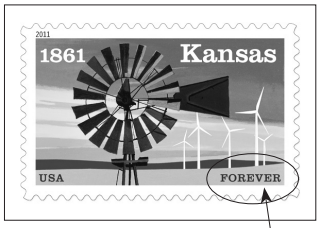
Examples of First-Class Mail postage and markings begin on the next page.

First-Class Mail Examples

First-Class or Forever Stamp

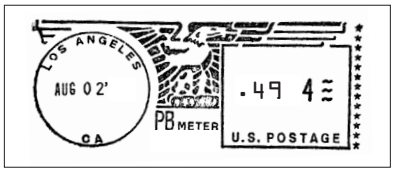


First-Class Stamp



Forever Stamp

Look for "Forever" somewhere on the stamp.



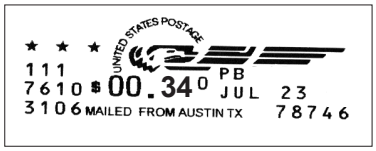
First-Class Metered Strip

FIRST-CLASS MAIL
U.S. POSTAGE PAID
COMPANY NAME
PERMIT #000

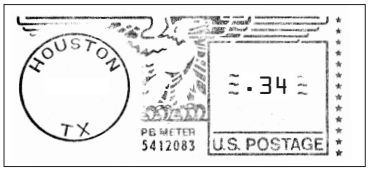
First-Class Permit



First-Class Postcard Stamp

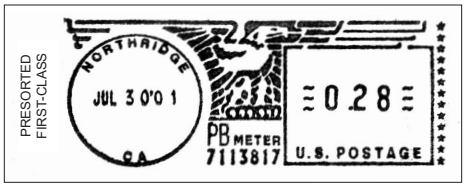


Metered Postcard



Metered Postcard

Presorted First-Class, PRSRT, or FP



"Presorted First-Class" Metered Strip

Presorted
First-Class Mail
U.S. Postage Paid
Mailed from Zip Code 27101
PERMIT #000

"Presorted First-Class" Permit



"Presorted First-Class" Stamp

PRSRT
First-Class Mail
U.S. Postage Paid
PERMIT #000

5698 1 AUTO 0.305

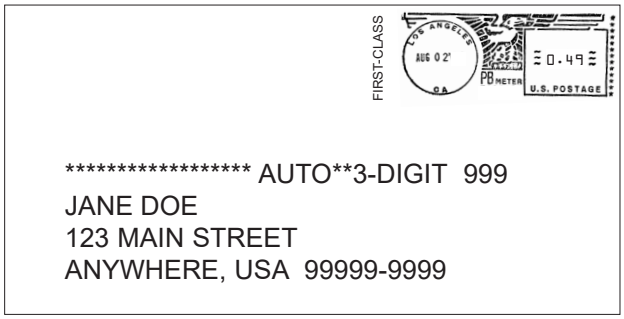
JANE DOE
123 MAIN STREET
ANYWHERE, USA 99999-9999

Look for "Presorted First-Class" on a Permit, a Stamp, or a Metered Strip

Hint: Find closest match

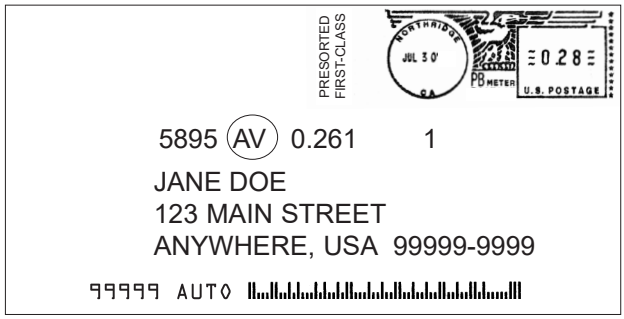
First-Class Mail Examples

AUTO



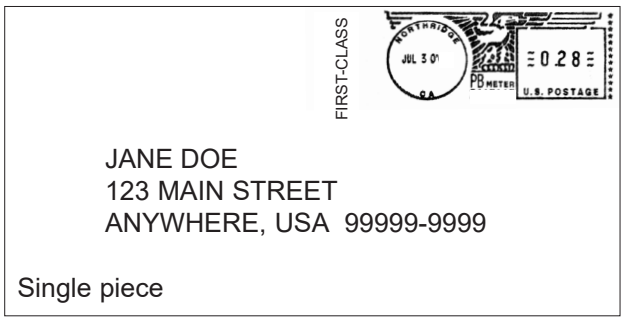
"AUTO" above or below the address

AB, or AF, or MB, or AV

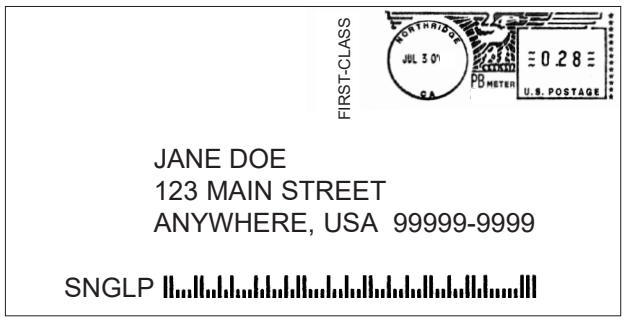


"AB, or AF, or MB, or AV"
above address

Single Piece, or SNGLP, or SP



"First-Class" left of Metered Strip
"Single piece" in lower left corner



"First-Class" left of Metered Strip
"SNGLP" left of Barcode

Note: Many additional mail markings may appear above or below the address, inside the window of an envelope, or near the postage on a mail piece.

Hint: Find closest match

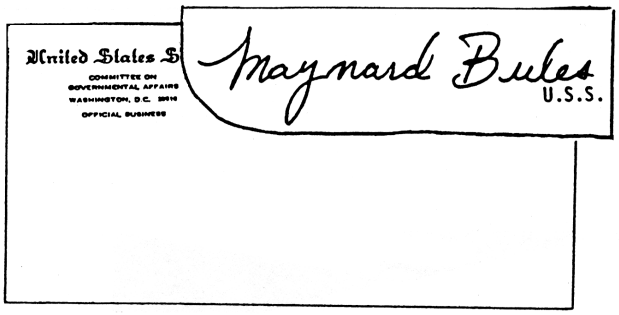
First-Class Mail Examples

Mail from outside the U.S.

AIR MAIL

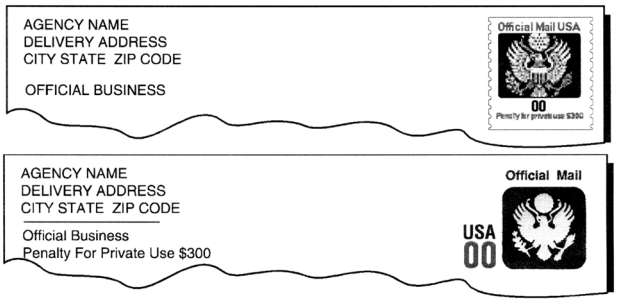
JANE DOE
123 MAIN STREET
ANYWHERE, USA 99999-9999

Federal Government Mail (Franked)



"Official Government Signature" (Franked)

Other Federal Government Mail



FIRST-CLASS MAIL
POSTAGE AND FEES PAID
AGENCY NAME
PERMIT NO.G-999

PRESORTED
FIRST-CLASS MAIL
POSTAGE AND FEES PAID
AGENCY NAME
PERMIT NO.G-99

Marked "Official Mail" or Government Permit Number

Hint: Find closest match

Presorted Standard Mail (Blue)

Use the following to help you determine if your mail piece should be recorded under this type:

- Include mail ***(that is not a package)*** that is marked "**Presorted Standard**," or "**PRSRT STD**," or "**Standard**," or "**STD**" whether it is a letter, postcard, large envelope, magazine, catalog, circular, or flyer, etc.

- Most **catalogs** are sent Presorted Standard. However, check to make sure it is marked "Presorted Standard," or "PRSRT STD," or "Standard," or "STD."
  Catalogs that are in envelopes marked "Bound Printed Matter" or items marked "Media Mail" or "Library Mail" should be recorded under "Packages & Expedited Materials" (Green pages).

Advertising often comes as a group of flyers, circulars, coupons, or other pieces that are not in an envelope.* These types of advertisements can be delivered in two different ways:

1. Your address may be printed on a **detached label card** that is delivered with separate advertising pieces that are grouped or folded together.

   If you get a detached label card, please record it under "**Presorted Standard Mail**," and then record the group of advertising pieces as **ONE** mail piece (regardless of how many flyers or circulars, etc.) under "**Unaddressed Mail**" on the Pink pages.



2. Your address may be printed directly on the group of advertising pieces.

   Please record the whole group as **ONE** mail piece under "**Presorted Standard Mail**." Record code #7 for Question B and code #2 for Question C.

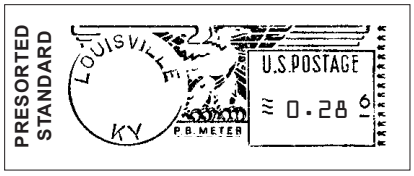


**Usually from more than one company or advertiser*

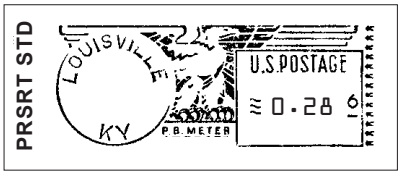
Examples of Presorted Standard postage & mail markings begin on the next page.

Presorted Standard Mail Examples

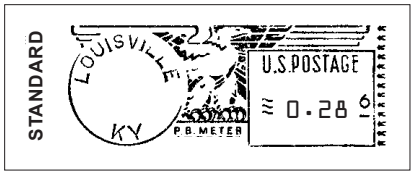
Presorted Standard, or PRSRT STD, or Standard, or STD



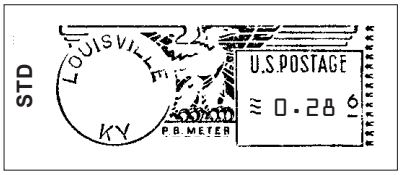
"Presorted Standard"
on Metered Strip



"PRSRT STD"
on Metered Strip



"Standard"
on Metered Strip



"STD"
on Metered Strip



"Presorted Std"
on Stamp

PRESORTED STANDARD
U.S. POSTAGE PAID
NEW YORK, NY
Permit No. 1

"Presorted Standard"
on Permit

PRSRT STD
U.S. POSTAGE
PAID
NEW YORK, NY
Permit No. 1

"PRSRT STD"
on Permit

STANDARD
U.S. POSTAGE PAID
NEW YORK, NY
Permit No. 1

"Standard"
on Permit

STD
U.S. POSTAGE
PAID
NEW YORK, NY
Permit No. 1

"STD"
on Permit

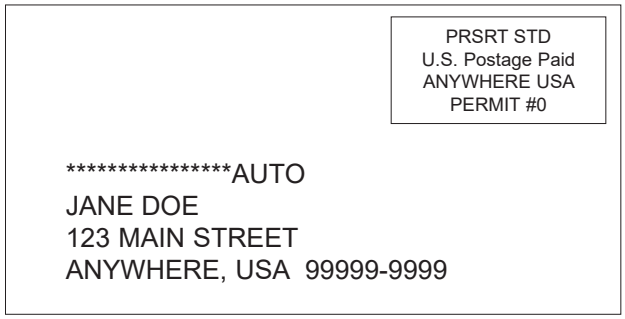
Hint: Find closest match

Presorted Standard Mail Examples

Note: Many of the markings may appear with any of the permit types (i.e., AUTO may appear with a Presorted Standard, or PRSRT STD, or Standard, or STD permit or meter strip).

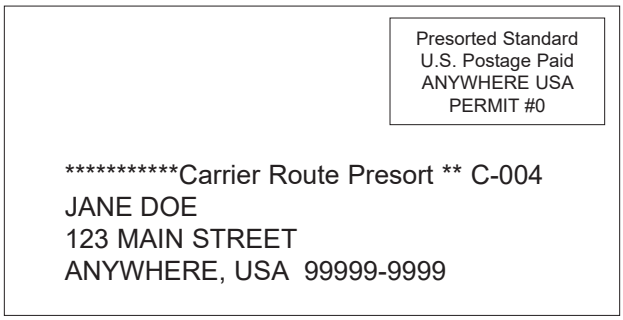
Also, AUTO, Carrier Route Presort, or CAR-RT SORT may appear in the permit area in the top right-hand corner of the mail piece.

AUTO



"AUTO" above address

Carrier Route Presort, or CAR-RT SORT



"Carrier Route Presort"



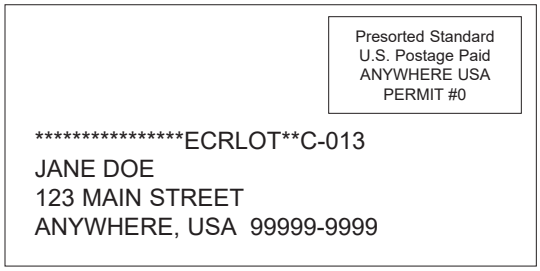
"CAR-RT SORT"

Hint: Find closest match

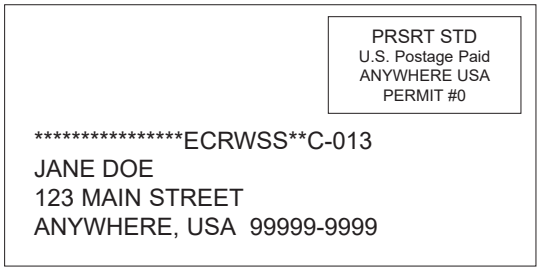
Presorted Standard Mail Examples

Note: Many of the markings may appear with any of the permit types (i.e., ECR may appear with a Presorted Standard, or PRSRT STD, or Standard, or STD permit or meter strip).

ECR with LOT, WSS, or WSH



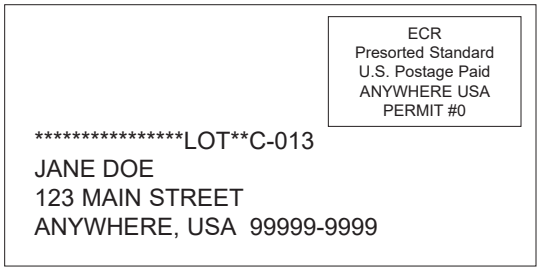
"ECRLOT" above address



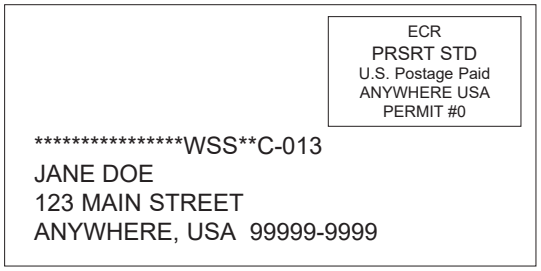
"ECRWSS" above address



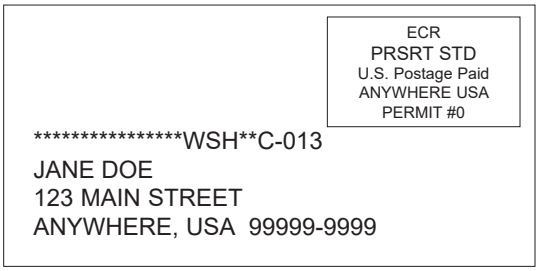
"ECRWSH" above address



"ECR" on Permit *and* "LOT" above address



"ECR" on Permit *and* "WSS" above address



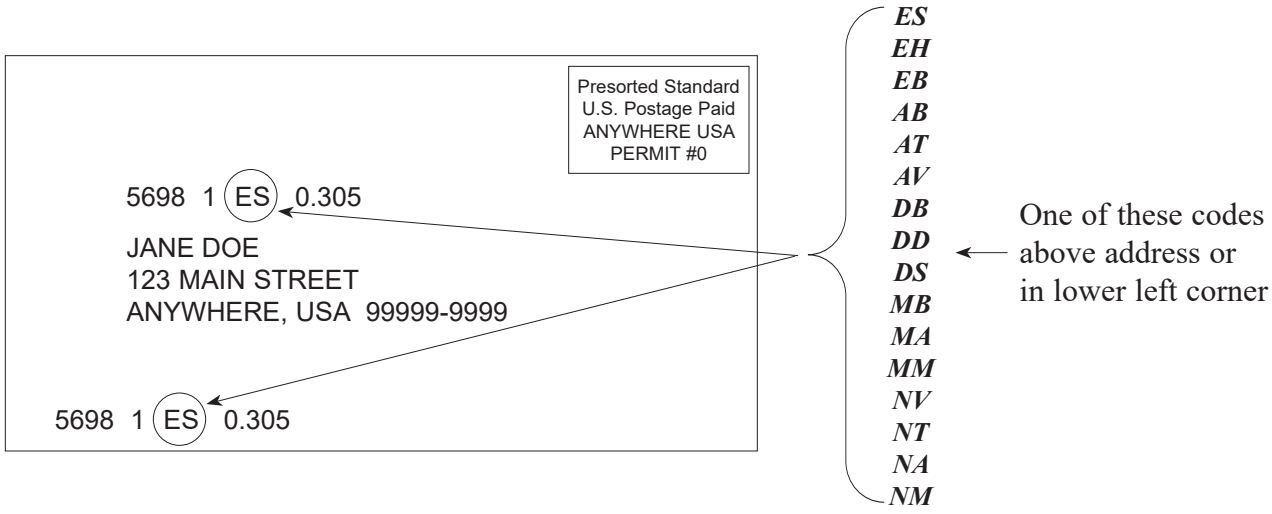
"ECR" on Permit *and* "WSH" above address

Hint: Find closest match

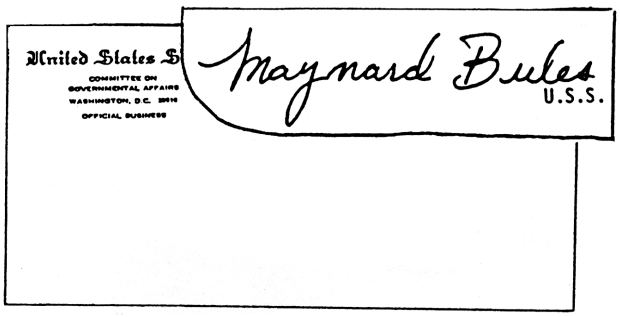
Presorted Standard Mail Examples

Note: Many of the markings may appear with any of the permit types (i.e., ES may appear with a Presorted Standard, or PRSRT STD, or Standard, or STD permit or meter strip).

ES, EH, EB, AB, AT, AV, DB, DD, DS, MB, MA, MM, NV, NT, NA, NM

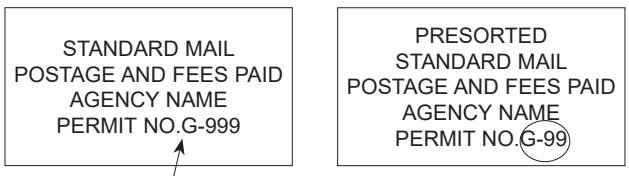


Federal Government Mail (Franked)



"Official Government Signature" (Franked)

Other Federal Government Mail



Government Permit Number

Hint: Find closest match

Nonprofit Organization Mail (Gray)

Use the following to help you determine if your mail piece should be recorded under this type:

- All Nonprofit Mail (that is not a package) must be marked "**Nonprofit Organization**," "**Nonprofit Org.**," **or** "**Nonprofit**."
- A few examples of Nonprofit Organizations are charities, schools, hospitals, churches, etc.
- Nonprofit Organization Mail may include requests for donations of money, your time, or other items, or they may be asking you to purchase an item or service.
- **Do not include** packages that are marked Nonprofit Organization. These should be recorded under "**Packages & Expedited Materials**" (Green pages).

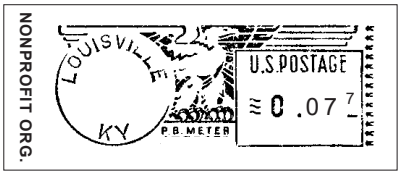
Examples of Nonprofit postage & mail markings begin on the next page.

Nonprofit Organization Mail Examples

Nonprofit Organization, Nonprofit Org., or Nonprofit

Nonprofit Organization
U.S. Postage
PAID
Boston, Massachusetts
Permit No. 9

"Nonprofit Organization" on Permit



"Nonprofit Org." on Metered Strip



"Nonprofit Org." on Stamp

NONPROFIT ORG.
U.S. POSTAGE
PAID
HAPPY HEART SOCIETY

"Nonprofit Org." on Permit

NONPROFIT
U.S. POSTAGE PAID
WASHINGTON, DC
Permit No. 1

"Nonprofit" on Permit

Note: Many of the markings may appear with any of the permit types (i.e., AUTO may appear with a Nonprofit Organization, Nonprofit Org., or Nonprofit permit or meter strip.)

Also, AUTO may appear in the permit area in the top right-hand corner of the mail piece.

AUTO

NONPROFIT ORGANIZATION
U.S. Postage Paid
ANYWHERE USA
PERMIT #0

**********AUTO
JANE DOE
123 MAIN STREET
ANYWHERE, USA 99999-9999

"AUTO" above address

Hint: Find closest match

Nonprofit Organization Mail Examples

Note: Many of the markings may appear with any of the permit types (i.e., CAR-RT SORT may appear with a Nonprofit Organization, Nonprofit Org., or Nonprofit permit or meter strip).

Also, Carrier Route Presort or CAR-RT SORT may appear in the permit area in the top right-hand corner of the mail piece.

Carrier Route Presort or CAR-RT SORT

NONPROFIT ORG.
U.S. Postage Paid
ANYWHERE USA
PERMIT #0

******Carrier Route Presort**C-013
JANE DOE
123 MAIN STREET
ANYWHERE, USA 99999-9999

"Carrier Route Presort" above address

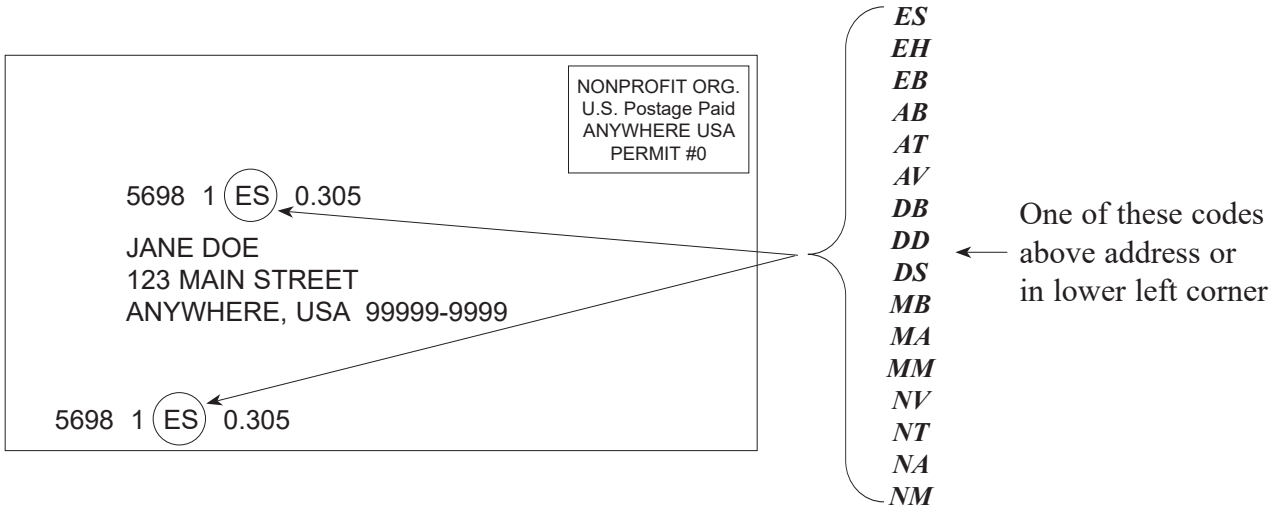
NONPROFIT ORGANIZATION
U.S. Postage Paid
ANYWHERE USA
PERMIT #0

**********CAR-RT SORT**C-0004
JANE DOE
123 MAIN STREET
ANYWHERE, USA 99999-9999

"CAR-RT SORT" above address

Note: Many of the markings may appear with any of the permit types (i.e., ES may appear with a Nonprofit Organization, Nonprofit Org., or Nonprofit permit or meter strip).

ES, EH, EB, AB, AT, AV, DB, DD, DS, MB, MA, MM, NV, NT, NA, NM

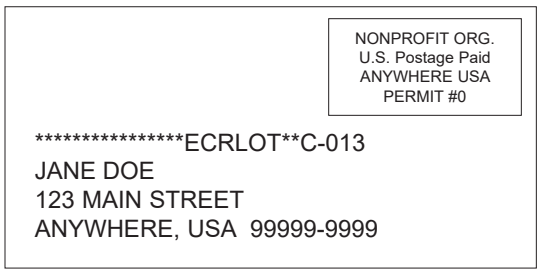


Hint: Find closest match

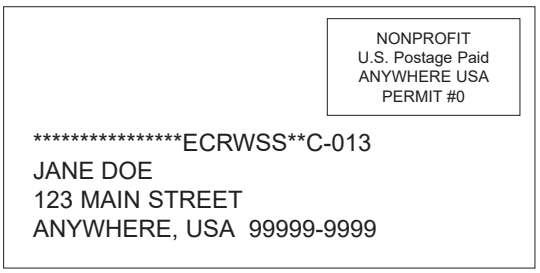
Nonprofit Organization Mail Examples

Note: Many of the markings may appear with any of the permit types (i.e., ECR may appear with a Nonprofit Organization, Nonprofit Org., or Nonprofit permit or meter strip).

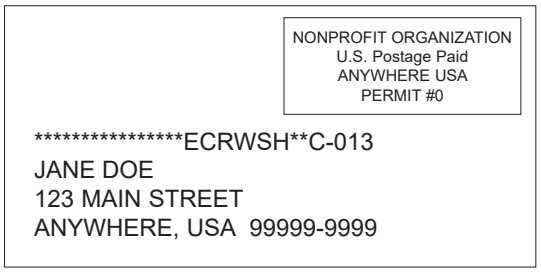
ECR with LOT, WSS, or WSH



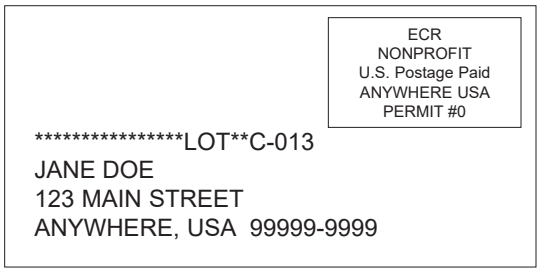
"ECRLOT" above address



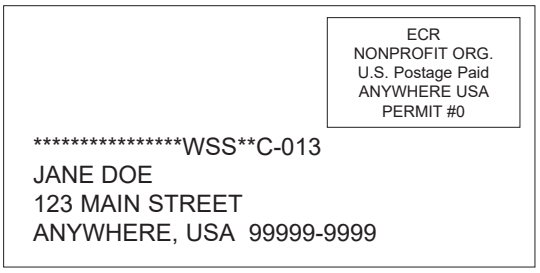
"ECRWSS" above address



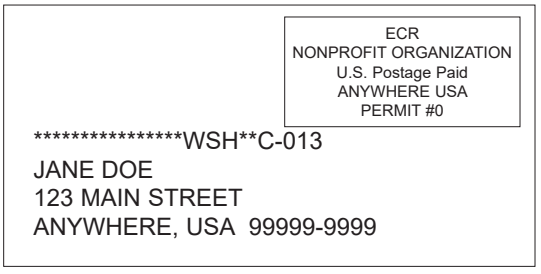
"ECRWSH" above address



"ECR" on Permit *and* "LOT" above address



"ECR" on Permit *and* "WSS" above address



"ECR" on Permit *and* "WSH" above address

Hint: Find closest match

Packages & Expedited Materials Received & Sent (Green)

Use the following to help you determine if your mail piece should be recorded under this type:

Packages (even if marked First-Class, Presorted Standard, etc.):

- Include ALL packages or boxes received or sent via the U.S. Postal Service (USPS) as well as packages delivered by any other organization, such as the United Parcel Service (UPS), FedEx, etc. Be careful to distinguish between packages delivered by the U.S. Postal Service (USPS) whose markings include an Eagle, and those delivered by the United Parcel Service (UPS) whose markings have a shield.

- Include all **packages and parcels** even if marked "First-Class", "PRSRT STD", or "Non-Profit".

- Include catalogs that are marked "**Bound Printed Matter**" or "**PRSRT BPM**", or other packages marked "**Parcel Select**", "**PS Lightweight**", "**Media Mail**", or "**Standard Post**".

- Record all personal packages received and sent at home and other locations such as work, or at the U.S. Post Office, etc. (Do not include packages sent and received on behalf of a household members place of employment or a business.)

Product Samples:

- Include product samples that were delivered by any organization, except those included in the newspaper.

Expedited Letters, Packages, and Boxes:

- Include letters, packages, and boxes that were delivered by any expedited mail carrier (**see examples on the next page**), which include the U.S. Postal Service (USPS), United Parcel Service (UPS), or FedEx.

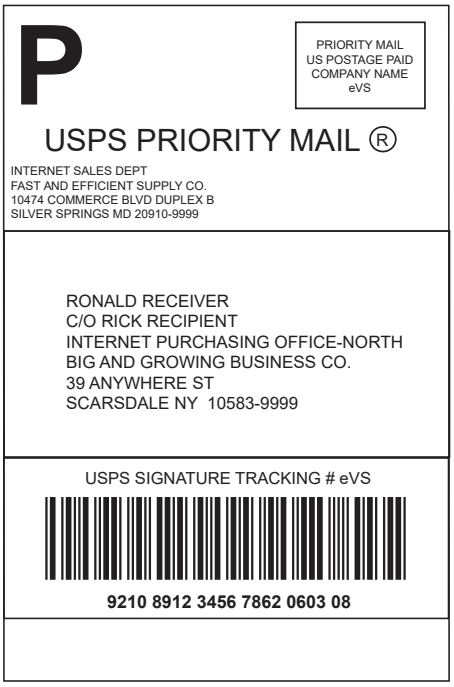
- You may see terms such as Priority Mail Express, Priority Mail, Overnight, 2-day, 3-day, Next Day Air, 2nd Day Air, etc.

Package & Expedited Examples

Priority Mail Express



Priority Mail



PS Lightweight



Marked "PS Lightweight"
or "Parcel Select Lightweight"

Bound Printed Matter



Marked "BPM" or "Bound Printed Matter"

Parcel Select



Marked "Parcel Select"

UPS NEXT DAY AIR®

FedEx®

Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals (Yellow)

Use the following to help you determine if a Magazine, Newspaper, or other Periodical should be recorded under this type:

- Examples include daily, weekly, and monthly magazines; alumni or fraternal magazines; and newspapers or other publications that household members may subscribe to.

- Include magazines, newspapers, or other periodicals marked "**Periodicals Postage Paid**."

- **Only** include magazines, newspapers, or other periodicals that are delivered by the U.S. Postal Service (USPS) and that are NOT marked First-Class, Presorted Standard, or Nonprofit Organization. If they are marked with any of these other postage types, record them under the section for that mail type.

Do not include the following items under this section:

- Newspapers delivered by your local news carrier. (Do not include these in the diary study.)

- Magazines and newspapers you bought at the store or a newsstand. (Do not include these in the diary study.)

- Catalogs, which are typically sent “Presorted Standard (PRSRT STD).” (Check the postage type; these will likely be recorded in the Presorted Standard section.)

- Catalogs marked "PRSRT BPM" or "Presorted Bound Printed Matter" will be recorded in the Packages and Expedited Materials (Green pages).

Unaddressed Mail
(Pink)

Use the following to help you determine if your mail piece should be recorded under this type:

- Only include mail delivered by the U.S. Postal Service (USPS). **Do not include** advertising material that has been left at your door, or material hung on your doorknob or left on your car.

- Include mail pieces that don't have any postage or an address label. If a mail piece is labeled "Occupant" or "Resident," do not include it in this section because it most likely is marked "PRST STD" or "Presorted Standard."

- Typically, Unaddressed Mail will only be weekly advertising flyers/circulars that are folded or grouped together and do not have an address label or postage on each piece. Simply record the whole group as ONE mail piece. They are usually accompanied by a detached label card marked "PRST STD" or "Presorted Standard."

(Please refer to page 9 in this booklet for additional information on recording unaddressed mail that comes along with a detached label card.)

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Photo Quick Start

PHOTO QUICK START







Postage & Mail Markings can be:

- in the top right-hand corner,
- above or below the address, or
- inside the window of an envelope.

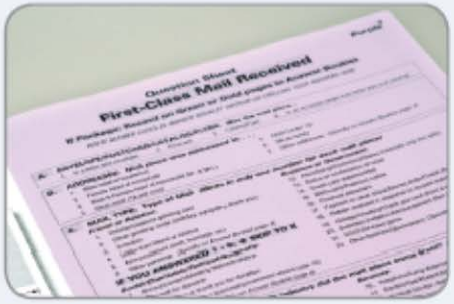
Use the Postage & Mail Markings on your mail to help you sort!



1 Sort your mail each day into the 6 types of mail listed on page 1 of the **Instruction Booklet.**

2 Label and number each mail piece within the 6 types of mail. (Photo shows First-Class only).







3 Open the **Answer Booklet** for Monday (or first mail day) to page 1 - Summary Page.

Record the total number of mail pieces you received that day for each mail type.

4 Open the **Question Booklet** to page 3 - First-Class Mail Received.

If you didn't receive any First-Class Mail that day, skip to page 5: First-Class Mail Sent, or page 7: Presorted Standard Mail, or other pages for mail types you did receive.

5 Write your answers to the questions from the Question Booklet in the **Answer Booklet**.

Be sure to record mail for each mail type you receive (Monday-Sunday) on the color-coded pages for that mail type.

Questions? **Visit the project web page: www.nustats.com/uspsstudy.htm, call our USPS Hotline at: 1-888-441-USPS (8777), or e-mail your question to USPS@nustats.com**

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Question Booklet

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

3

Question Booklet

Use with Answer Booklets (Monday-Sunday)

Questions? Call our toll-free hotline at:

1-888-441-USPS (8777)

Available 11am - 9pm Central Standard Time (Mon - Wed)
11am - 5pm Central Standard Time (Thu & Fri)
12pm - 5pm Central Standard Time (Sat & Sun)

OR

e-mail your question to:

USPS@nustats.com

OR

visit the project web page at:

www.nustats.com/uspsstudy.htm

Table of Contents

	Color	Page
Example	White	1
Mail Piece Size Template	White	2
Question Sheets:		
First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received	Purple	3
First-Class Mail Sent	Purple	5
Presorted Standard Mail Received	Blue	7
Nonprofit Organization Mail Received	Gray	9
Packages & Expedited Materials Received	Green	11
Packages & Expedited Materials Sent	Green	13
Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals	Yellow	15
Unaddressed Mail Received	Pink	17

Example

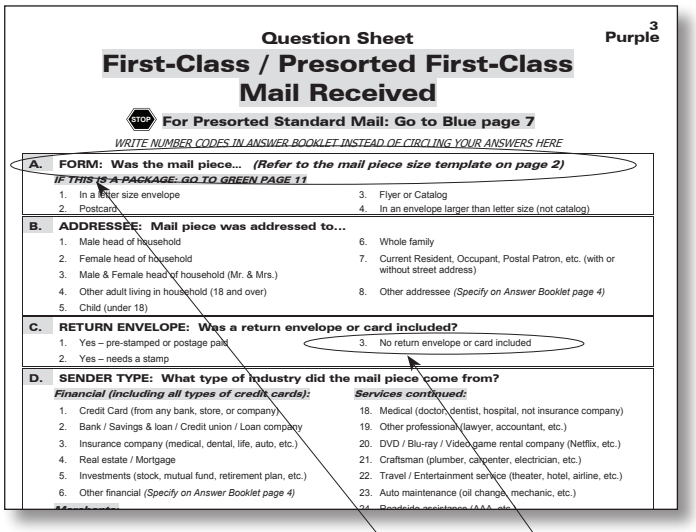
Once you've sorted and numbered your mail pieces, you are ready to begin recording information. Remember to use the postage and the mail markings on the mail piece to help you determine the mail type ***(see page 1 of the Instruction Booklet for how to sort and number your mail)***.

You need both this Question Booklet and the Answer Booklet. Open both this Question Booklet and the Answer Booklet to the color-coded pages for the type of mail you have (e.g., purple pages are First-Class Mail, blue pages are Standard Mail, etc.).

Each question sheet contains both questions (letters A, B, C, etc.) and answer codes (numbers 1, 2, 3, etc.). **Don't record your answers in this Question Booklet; instead, use the corresponding daily Answer Booklet.** Record the number that best matches your response.

Answer the questions about each mail piece down the answer sheet. For example, if you receive four (4) First-Class mail pieces on Monday, you will record answers to all questions about mail piece #1 in the first column, and about mail piece #2 in the second column, mail piece #3 in the third column, and #4 in the fourth column.

Question Sheet (in Question Booklet)



Question Sheet — Purple 3

First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received

STOP **For Presorted Standard Mail: Go to Blue page 7**

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. FORM: Was the mail piece... ***(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)***

IF THIS IS A PACKAGE: GO TO GREEN PAGE 11

1. In a letter size envelope
2. Postcard
3. Flyer or Catalog
4. In an envelope larger than letter size (not catalog)

B. ADDRESSEE: Mail piece was addressed to...

1. Male head of household
2. Female head of household
3. Male & Female head of household (Mr. & Mrs.)
4. Other adult living in household (18 and over)
5. Child (under 18)
6. Whole family
7. Current Resident, Occupant, Postal Patron, etc. (with or without street address)
8. Other addressee *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

C. RETURN ENVELOPE: Was a return envelope or card included?

1. Yes – pre-stamped or postage paid
2. Yes – needs a stamp
3. No return envelope or card included

D. SENDER TYPE: What type of industry did the mail piece come from?

Financial (including all types of credit cards):

1. Credit Card (from any bank, store, or company)
2. Bank / Savings & loan / Credit union / Loan company
3. Insurance company (medical, dental, life, auto, etc.)
4. Real estate / Mortgage
5. Investments (stock, mutual fund, retirement plan, etc.)
6. Other financial *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

Services continued:

18. Medical (doctor, dentist, hospital, not insurance company)
19. Other professional (lawyer, accountant, etc.)
20. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental company (Netflix, etc.)
21. Craftsman (plumber, carpenter, electrician, etc.)
22. Travel / Entertainment service (theater, hotel, airline, etc.)
23. Auto maintenance (oil change, mechanic, etc.)

When completing your Answer Booklet, please print clearly as in the example:

1 OR 20

Use a pen in black or blue ink
DO NOT USE PENCIL

Answer Sheet (in Answer Booklet)

Question

Code

Mail Piece #1

Mail Piece #2

Answer Sheet — Purple

First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns. There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. FORM	2	1	2	1	1							
B. ADDRESSEE	1	2	1	3	3							
C. RETURN ENVELOPE	3	3	3	2	3							
D. SENDER TYPE	10	32	16	1	27							

Mail Piece Size Template

Use the guide below to help you determine the size of your mail piece. This will help answer the FORM question.

LETTER SIZE ENVELOPE - Maximum Length 11 1/2"

If the envelope fits within these margins, it is letter size.

If the envelope extends more than 1/2" off the edge of this page, OR is taller than 6 1/8," it is larger than letter size.

LETTER SIZE ENVELOPE - Maximum Height 6 1/8"

POSTCARD - Maximum Length 6"

A postcard is a single, unfolded piece that is NOT in an envelope, AND fits within these margins.

POSTCARD - Maximum Height 4 1/4"

FLYER

A flyer is a folded or unfolded piece that is larger than a postcard AND is NOT in an envelope.

Question Sheet

First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received



For Presorted Standard Mail: Go to Blue page 7

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. FORM: Was the mail piece... ***(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)***

IF THIS IS A PACKAGE: GO TO GREEN PAGE 11

1. In a letter size envelope
2. Postcard
3. Flyer or Catalog
4. In an envelope larger than letter size (not catalog)

B. ADDRESSEE: Mail piece was addressed to...

1. Male head of household
2. Female head of household
3. Male & Female head of household (Mr. & Mrs.)
4. Other adult living in household (18 and over)
5. Child (under 18)
6. Whole family
7. Current Resident, Occupant, Postal Patron, etc. (with or without street address)
8. Other addressee *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

C. RETURN ENVELOPE: Was a return envelope or card included?

1. Yes – pre-stamped or postage paid
2. Yes – needs a stamp
3. No return envelope or card included

D. SENDER TYPE: What type of industry did the mail piece come from?

Financial (including all types of credit cards):

1. Credit Card (from any bank, store, or company)
2. Bank / Savings & loan / Credit union / Loan company
3. Insurance company (medical, dental, life, auto, etc.)
4. Real estate / Mortgage
5. Investments (stock, mutual fund, retirement plan, etc.)
6. Other financial *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

Merchants:

7. Supermarket / Grocery store
8. Department / Discount store
9. Other store (electronics, shoes, clothes, hardware, etc.)
10. Mail order company
11. Restaurant (incl. fast food, pizza delivery, etc.)
12. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
13. Auto dealership (not manufacturer or service department)
14. Individual seller (on eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site)
15. Other merchants *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

Services:

16. Telephone / Cell / Cable / Satellite / Internet
17. Electric / Gas / Water / Utility company

Services continued:

18. Medical (doctor, dentist, hospital, not insurance company)
19. Other professional (lawyer, accountant, etc.)
20. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental company (Netflix, etc.)
21. Craftsman (plumber, carpenter, electrician, etc.)
22. Travel / Entertainment service (theater, hotel, airline, etc.)
23. Auto maintenance (oil change, mechanic, etc.)
24. Roadside assistance (AAA, etc.)
25. Other services *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

Manufacturers:

26. All manufacturers (makers of automobiles, computers, etc.)

Government:

27. Federal (Social Security, VA, IRS, Medicare, etc.)
28. State and Local (not a utility company)

Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political:

29. Educational (public & private schools, universities, etc.)
30. Political (campaign, political action committee, political party, etc.)
31. All other nonprofit organizations

Friend or Relative:

32. Friend or Relative (not from a business)

E. PURPOSE: What was the MAIN purpose of the mail piece? ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Holiday / Seasons greeting card
2. Other greeting cards (birthday, sympathy, thank you)
3. Invitation or announcement from friend or relative **→ SKIP TO J**
4. Letter from friend or relative **→ SKIP TO J**
5. Bill / Invoice / Premium (not for a credit card)
6. Financial statement (not for a credit card)
7. Credit card bill / Credit card statement
8. Notice / Announcement / Business invitation (no bills)
9. Advertising / Promotional / Sales only (no bills) **→ SKIP TO G**
10. Insurance explanation of benefits
11. Tax related (information, forms, etc.)
12. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental
13. Request for donation (money, time, blood drive, goods, etc.)
14. Confirmation or thank you for donation
15. Rebate received in response to coupon submitted
16. Direct deposit receipts or check stub (not a payment)
17. New or replacement credit or debit card
18. Payment or other check / Money order / Credit (no rebate)
19. Survey / Questionnaire
20. Sweepstakes / Contest promotion
21. Newsletter
22. Prospectus
23. Social Security related (information, statement, etc.)
24. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

More questions on back of page →

First-Class Mail Received *cont.* Purple

STOP IF THIS MAIL PIECE WAS FROM A FRIEND OR RELATIVE, SKIP TO J

F. ADVERTISING: Did this mail piece contain any advertising or promotional material?

1. Yes
2. No → **SKIP TO J**

G. READING: Was the advertising... ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Read by a member of the household
2. Read by more than one member of the household
3. Looked at but not read by any member of the household
4. Discarded without being read
5. Set aside for reading later

H. REACTION: Would this advertising be described as...

1. Useful information we like to receive
2. Interesting or enjoyable, but not useful
3. Neither interesting, enjoyable, nor useful
4. Objectionable or offensive

I. RESPONSE: Is anyone in your household considering responding to the advertisement?

1. Yes
2. No
3. Maybe

J. CLASS: Tell us what type of markings are on the mail piece. ***(OK to choose more than one)***

For example of First-Class Mail, see pages 5-8 of the Instruction Booklet.
Look at markings in top right-hand corner, above or below the address, & inside the window.
Remember – packages and items marked Presorted Standard, Nonprofit or Periodicals do not belong in the First Class mail type.

1. Presorted First-Class, **or** PRSRT, **or** FP
2. First-Class Postage
3. Forever Stamp
4. AUTO
5. AB, **or** AF, **or** MB, **or** AV
6. Single Piece, **or** SNGLP, **or** SP
7. Mail from outside the U.S.
8. Federal Government Mail with Official Signature (FRANKED)
9. Other Federal Government Mail
10. Other classification *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

Please mark all mail pieces for this day & place in the daily envelope.

Question Sheet
First-Class Mail Sent

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. FORM: Was the mail piece... ***(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)***

IF THIS IS A PACKAGE: GO TO GREEN PAGE 13

1. In a letter size envelope
2. Postcard
3. In an envelope larger than letter size
4. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

B. ADDRESSEE TYPE: What type of industry did you send the mail piece to?

Financial (including all types of credit cards):

1. Credit Card (from any bank, store, or company)
2. Bank / Savings & loan / Credit union / Loan company
3. Insurance company (medical, dental, life, auto, etc.)
4. Real estate / Mortgage
5. Investments (stock, mutual fund, retirement plan, etc.)
6. Other financial *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

Merchants:

7. Supermarket / Grocery store
8. Department / Discount store
9. Other store (electronics, shoes, clothes, hardware, etc.)
10. Mail order company
11. Restaurant (incl. fast food, pizza delivery, etc.)
12. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
13. Auto dealership (not manufacturer or service department)
14. Individual seller (on eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site)
15. Other merchants *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

Services:

16. Telephone / Cell / Cable / Satellite / Internet
17. Electric / Gas / Water / Utility company

Services continued:

18. Medical (doctor, dentist, hospital, not insurance company)
19. Other professional (lawyer, accountant, etc.)
20. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental company (Netflix, etc.)
21. Craftsman (plumber, carpenter, electrician, etc.)
22. Travel / Entertainment service (theater, hotel, airline, etc.)
23. Auto maintenance (oil change, mechanic, etc.)
24. Roadside assistance (AAA, etc.)
25. Other services *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

Manufacturers:

26. All manufacturers (makers of automobiles, computers, etc.)

Government:

27. Federal (Social Security, VA, IRS, Medicare, etc.)
28. State and Local (not a utility company)

Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political:

29. Educational (public & private schools, universities, etc.)
30. Political (campaign, political action committee, political party, etc.)
31. All other nonprofit organizations

Friend or Relative:

32. Friend or Relative (not to a business)

C. PURPOSE: What was the MAIN purpose of the mail piece? ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Holiday / Seasons greeting card
2. Other greeting cards (birthday, sympathy, thank you)
3. Invitation / Announcement (birth, marriage, etc.)
4. Letter / Correspondence (written by you – not a form)
5. Order
6. Inquiry
7. Payment (bill payment, dues, membership fees, etc.)
8. Donation
9. Survey / Questionnaire response
10. Sweepstakes / Contest entry
11. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game return
12. Proxy vote response
13. Election materials (absentee ballot, registration, etc.)
14. Rebate request
15. Tax related
16. Completed form / Application / Paperwork (not a tax form)
17. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*



IF THIS MAIL PIECE WAS TO A FRIEND OR RELATIVE, SKIP TO G

D. AD RESPONSE: Was the mail piece sent in response to advertising or solicitation for funds?

1. Yes
2. No → **SKIP TO F**

E. AD MATERIAL: Was the advertising / promotional / solicitation material...

1. Received in mail (not in magazine)
2. Seen in magazine
3. Seen in newspaper
4. Seen on television
5. Heard on radio
6. Received over telephone
7. Seen on the Internet
8. Other advertising *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

More questions on back of page →

First-Class Mail Sent *cont.* — Purple

F. RETURN ENVELOPE: Did you use your own envelope or card?

1. Yes
2. No – a return envelope or card **with postage** was provided
3. No – a return envelope or card **without postage** was provided

G. SPECIAL SVCS: Did the mail piece have any of the following special services? ***(OK to choose more than one)***

1. Certified
2. Registered
3. Insured
4. Return Receipt Requested
5. Certificate of Mailing
6. Restricted Delivery
7. COD
8. No special services
9. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

H. PO BOX: Was this mail piece sent to a PO Box?

1. Yes
2. No

I. POSTAGE TYPE: What type of postage was used? ***(Either postage that you put on yourself or postage that was already on the envelope or card)***

1. Business Reply Mail (no postage necessary)
2. Permit Reply Mail (no postage necessary)
3. Forever Stamp
4. Regular postage stamp
5. Meter stamp
6. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

Question Sheet

Presorted Standard Mail Received



For Presorted First-Class Mail: Go to Purple page 3

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. ADDRESSEE: Mail piece was addressed to...

1. Specific member(s) of the household
2. Current Resident, Occupant, Postal Patron, etc. (with or without street address)
3. Someone not living at this address

B. FORM: Was the mail piece... ***(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)***

IF THIS IS A PACKAGE: GO TO GREEN PAGE 11

1. In a letter size envelope
2. In an envelope larger than letter size (not catalog)
3. Catalog in envelope
4. Catalog not in envelope
5. Detached label card
6. Postcard
7. Addressed flyers / Circulars / Folded piece (no envelope)
8. Newspapers / Magazines / Newsletters
9. Can't classify type *(Please describe on Answer Booklet pg. 8)*

C. MULTIPLE: Did the mail piece contain...

1. Material from one organization only
2. Material from several organizations → **SKIP TO F**

D. SENDER TYPE: What type of industry did the mail piece come from?

Financial (including all types of credit cards):

1. Credit Card (from any bank, store, or company)
2. Bank / Savings & loan / Credit union / Loan company
3. Insurance company (medical, dental, life, auto, etc.)
4. Real estate / Mortgage
5. Investments (stock, mutual fund, retirement plan, etc.)
6. Other financial *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 8)*

Merchants:

7. Supermarket / Grocery store
8. Department / Discount store
9. Other store (electronics, shoes, clothes, hardware, etc.)
10. Mail order company
11. Restaurant (incl. fast food, pizza delivery, etc.)
12. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
13. Auto dealership (not manufacturer or service department)
14. Individual seller (on eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site)
15. Other merchants *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 8)*

Services:

16. Telephone / Cell / Cable / Satellite / Internet
17. Electric / Gas / Water / Utility company
18. Medical (doctor, dentist, hospital, not insurance company)
19. Other professional (lawyer, accountant, etc.)

Services continued:

20. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental company (Netflix, etc.)
21. Craftsman (plumber, carpenter, electrician, etc.)
22. Travel / Entertainment service (theater, hotel, airline, etc.)
23. Auto maintenance (oil change, mechanic, etc.)
24. Roadside assistance (AAA, etc.)
25. Other services *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 8)*

Manufacturers:

26. All manufacturers (makers of automobiles, computers, etc.)

Government:

27. Federal (Social Security, VA, IRS, Medicare, etc.)
28. State and Local (not a utility company)

Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political:

29. Educational (public & private schools, universities, etc.)
30. Political (campaign, political action committee, political party, etc.)
31. Union or professional organization
32. Church / Religious organization
33. Veterans (VFW, American Legion, DAV, etc.)
34. Charity
35. AARP (for AARP insurance plans, record code 3)
36. Other nonprofit, etc. *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 8)*

E. FAMILIARITY: Was this mail piece from an organization someone in household...

1. Does or has done business with
2. Knows, but no one does business with
3. Organization no one in household knows

F. RETURN ENVELOPE: Was a return envelope or card included?

1. Yes – pre-stamped or postage paid
2. Yes – needs a stamp
3. No return envelope or card included

More questions on back of page →

Presorted Standard Mail Received *cont.* Blue

G. READING: Was the mail piece... ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Read by a member of the household
2. Read by more than one member of the household
3. Looked at but not read by any member of the household
4. Discarded without being read
5. Set aside for reading later

H. REACTION: Would this mail piece be described as...

1. Useful information we like to receive
2. Interesting or enjoyable, but not useful
3. Neither interesting, enjoyable, nor useful
4. Objectionable or offensive

I. COUPONS: Did this mail piece contain coupons?

1. Yes
2. No

J. PURPOSE: What was the MAIN purpose of the mail piece? ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Advertisement for item(s) or service(s) to be purchased (credit card offers, etc.)
2. Request for donation (money, time, blood drive, goods, etc.)
3. Political materials
4. Newsletter / Newspaper / Magazine
5. Subscription renewal notice (for a publication)
6. Financial materials (report, proxy vote, prospectus, privacy or terms notice, etc.) NOTE: for credit card offers, record code 1
7. Invitation / Announcement / Schedule
8. General information
9. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 8)*

K. RESPONSE: Is anyone in your household considering responding to the mail piece?

1. Yes
2. No
3. Maybe

L. CLASS: Tell us what markings are on the mail piece. ***(OK to choose more than one)***

For examples of Presorted Standard Mail, see pages 9 – 13 of the Instruction Booklet.
Look at markings in top right-hand corner, above or below the address, & inside the window.

1. Presorted Standard, **or** PRSRT STD, **or** Standard, **or** STD
2. AUTO
3. Carrier Route Presort, **or** CAR–RT SORT
4. ECR **with** LOT, **or** WSS, **or** WSH
5. ES, **or** EH, **or** EB, **or** AB, **or** AT, **or** AV, **or** DB, **or** DD, **or** DS, **or** MB, **or** MA, **or** MM, **or** NV, **or** NT, **or** NA, **or** NM
6. CUSTOMIZED MARKETMAIL, **or** CUST MKTMAIL, **or** CMM
7. Not Flat-Machinable, **or** NFM
8. Federal Government Mail with Official Signature (FRANKED)
9. Other Federal Government Mail
10. Can't classify type *(Please mark & place in envelope along with other mail pieces for this day)*

Question Sheet

Nonprofit Organization Mail Received

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. ADDRESSEE: Mail piece was addressed to...

1. Specific member(s) of the household
2. Current Resident, Occupant, Postal Patron, etc. (with or without street address)
3. Someone not living at this address

B. FORM: Was the mail piece... ***(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)***

IF THIS IS A PACKAGE: GO TO GREEN PAGE 11

1. In a letter size envelope
2. In an envelope larger than letter size (not catalog)
3. Catalog in envelope
4. Catalog not in envelope
5. Detached label card
6. Postcard
7. Addressed flyers / Circulars / Folded piece (no envelope)
8. Newspapers / Magazines / Newsletters
9. Can't classify type *(Please describe on Answer Booklet pg. 10)*

C. MULTIPLE: Did the mail piece contain...

1. Material from one organization only
2. Material from several organizations → **SKIP TO F**

D. SENDER TYPE: What type of industry did the mail piece come from?

Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political:

1. Educational (public & private schools, universities, etc.)
2. Political (campaign, political action committee, political party, etc.)
3. Union or professional organization
4. Church / Religious organization
5. Veterans (VFW, American Legion, DAV, etc.)
6. Charity
7. AARP
8. Animal welfare organization (ASPCA, Humane Society, etc.)
9. Environmental / Wildlife organization (WWF, Sierra Club, etc.)
10. Public broadcasting
11. YMCA / YWCA
12. Museum
13. Other nonprofit, etc. *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 10)*

Merchants:

14. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
15. Other merchants *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 10)*

Services:

16. Medical (doctor, dentist, hospital, not insurance company)
17. Travel / Entertainment service (theater, hotel, airline, etc.)
18. Roadside assistance (AAA, etc.)
19. Other services *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 10)*

Government:

20. Federal (Social Security, VA, IRS, Medicare, etc.)
21. State and Local

E. FAMILIARITY: Was this mail piece from an organization someone in household...

1. Does or has done business with
2. Knows, but no one does business with
3. Organization no one in household knows

F. RETURN ENVELOPE: Was a return envelope or card included?

1. Yes – pre-stamped or postage paid
2. Yes – needs a stamp
3. No return envelope or card included

G. READING: Was the mail piece... ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Read by a member of the household
2. Read by more than one member of the household
3. Looked at but not read by any member of the household
4. Discarded without being read
5. Set aside for reading later

H. REACTION: Would this mail piece be described as...

1. Useful information we like to receive
2. Interesting or enjoyable, but not useful
3. Neither interesting, enjoyable, nor useful
4. Objectionable or offensive

I. COUPONS: Did this mail piece contain coupons?

1. Yes
2. No

More questions on back of page →

Nonprofit Organization Mail Received *cont.* Gray

J. PURPOSE: What was the MAIN purpose of the mail piece? ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Advertisement for item(s) or service(s) to be purchased
2. Request for donation (money, time, blood drive, goods, etc.)
3. Political materials
4. Newsletter / Newspaper / Magazine
5. Subscription renewal notice (for a publication)
6. Course catalog (college classes, etc.)
7. Invitation / Announcement / Schedule
8. General information
9. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 10)*

K. RESPONSE: Is anyone in your household considering responding to the mail piece?

1. Yes
2. No
3. Maybe

L. CLASS: Tell us what markings are on the mail piece. ***(OK to choose more than one)***

For examples of Nonprofit Mail see pages 14 – 17 of the Instruction Booklet.
Look at markings in top right-hand corner, above or below the address, & inside the window.

1. Nonprofit Organization, **or** Nonprofit Org., **or** Nonprofit
2. AUTO
3. Carrier Route Presort, **or** CAR–RT SORT
4. ECR **with** LOT, **or** WSS, **or** WSH
5. ES, **or** EH, **or** EB, **or** AB, **or** AT, **or** AV, **or** DB, **or** DD, **or** DS, **or** MB, **or** MA, **or** MM, **or** NV, **or** NT, **or** NA, **or** NM
6. CUSTOMIZED MARKETMAIL, **or** CUST MKTMAIL, **or** CMM
7. Not Flat-Machinable, **or** NFM
8. Federal Government Mail with Official Signature (FRANKED)
9. Other Federal Government Mail
10. Can't classify type *(Please mark & place in envelope along with other mail pieces for this day)*

Question Sheet

Packages & Expedited Materials Received

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. FORM: Was the mail piece... *(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)*

1. SMALL envelope or padded mailer (11 ½" X 6 1/8" or smaller)
2. LARGE envelope or padded mailer (larger than 11 ½" X 6 1/8")
3. Box or other 3 dimensional packaging
4. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

B. ADDRESSEE: Package / mail piece was addressed to...

1. Male head of household
2. Female head of household
3. Male & Female head of household (Mr. & Mrs.)
4. Other adult living in household (18 and over)
5. Child (under 18)
6. Whole family
7. Other addressee *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

C. CONTENTS: Did this package / mail piece contain... *(OK to choose more than one)*

1. Clothing / Footwear / Shoes / Jewelry / Accessories
2. Travel products or information
3. Computer hardware, software, or accessories
4. Electronic equipment
5. Household / Kitchen / Lawn and garden products
6. Book(s) (include telephone books)
7. CD / DVD / Blu-ray / Video game
8. Toys
9. Food products
10. Checkbooks
11. Health / Medical / Dental / Vision products
12. Cosmetics / Beauty products / Toiletries
13. Photos / Film
14. Credit card (new, replacement, or return of lost card)
15. Notice / Announcement / Business invitation
16. Letter
17. Advertising / Promotional materials
18. Other contents *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

D. SENDER TYPE: What type of industry did the package / mail piece come from?

1. Friend or Relative (not from a business) **➔ SKIP TO L**
2. Financial (credit card, bank, stockbroker, insurance, mortgage, etc.)
3. Merchant (all stores, publisher, mail order company, auto dealer, eBay seller, etc.)
4. Service (telephone, cable TV, Internet, medical, travel, Netflix, etc.)
5. Manufacturer (makers of automobiles, computers, etc.)
6. Government (local or federal government, including Medicare, IRS, USPS, Social Security, VA, etc.)
7. Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political (all schools, charities, political candidates, religious and social organizations, etc.)
8. Can't classify type *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

E. FROM: Was the package / mail piece from...

1. Business – ordered by household member
2. Business – ordered by a friend or relative for you **➔ SKIP TO G**
3. Unsolicited sample **➔ SKIP TO G**
4. Individual seller (on eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site)
5. Business – for other reasons *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)* **➔ SKIP TO G**

F. REASON ORDERED: I ordered this item because... *(OK to choose more than one)*

1. I saw it in a print catalog
2. I saw it online
3. I saw it in a local store
4. I saw it on a direct mail piece (not a catalog)
5. I saw it on television
6. I heard about it on the radio
7. I need it for medical reasons
8. Some other way *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

G. RETURN ENVELOPE: Was a return envelope or card included?

1. Yes – pre-stamped or postage paid
2. Yes – needs a stamp
3. No return envelope or card included

More questions on back of page →

Packages & Expedited Materials Received *cont.* Green

H. ADVERTISING: Was any advertising or promotional material enclosed?

1. Yes
2. No ➔ **SKIP TO L**

I. READING: Was the advertising... *(Write in one number only)*

1. Read by a member of the household
2. Read by more than one member of the household
3. Looked at but not read by any member of household
4. Discarded without being read
5. Set aside for reading later

J. REACTION: Would this advertising be described as...

1. Useful information we like to receive
2. Interesting or enjoyable, but not useful
3. Neither interesting, enjoyable, nor useful
4. Objectionable or offensive

K. RESPONSE: Is anyone in your household considering responding to the advertisement?

1. Yes
2. No
3. Maybe

L. SPECIAL SVCS: Did the package / mail piece have any of the following special services? *(OK to choose more than one)*

1. Return Receipt Requested
2. Delivery Confirmation
3. Signature Confirmation
4. Insured
5. COD
6. Stamped "Special Handling"
7. Certificate of Mailing
8. Restricted Delivery
9. No special services
10. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

M. CLASS: Package / Mail Classification *(OK to choose more than one)*

USPS Ground Packages:

1. First-Class (Package or Parcel) (up to 13 oz.)
2. Standard or Presorted Standard (PRSRT STD)
3. Standard Post
4. Nonprofit
5. Parcel Select
6. PS Lightweight / Parcel Select Lightweight
7. Bound Printed Matter or BPM
8. Media Mail
9. Package received from outside the U.S.

Non-USPS Ground Packages:

10. UPS (Ground, 3 Day Select)
11. FedEx (Ground, Express Saver, SmartPost)

Expedited Mail & Packages:

12. Express Mail/Priority Mail Express (delivered by USPS)
13. Priority Mail (delivered by USPS)
14. UPS Next Day Air
15. UPS 2nd Day Air
16. FedEx Overnight
17. FedEx 2Day

Other:

18. Other classification *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

Packages & Expedited Materials Sent

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. FORM: Was the mail piece… *(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)*

1. SMALL envelope or padded mailer (11 ½" X 6 1/8" or smaller)
2. LARGE envelope or padded mailer (larger than 11 ½" X 6 1/8")
3. Box or other 3 dimensional packaging
4. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

B. CONTENTS: Did this package / mail piece contain… *(OK to choose more than one)*

1. Clothing / Footwear / Shoes / Jewelry / Accessories
2. Travel products or information
3. Computer hardware, software, or accessories
4. Electronic equipment
5. Household / Kitchen / Lawn and garden products
6. Book(s) (include telephone books)
7. CD / DVD / Blu-ray / Video game
8. Toys
9. Food products
10. Checkbooks
11. Health / Medical / Dental / Vision products
12. Cosmetics / Beauty products / Toiletries
13. Photos / Film
14. Greeting card (holiday, birthday, thank you, etc.)
15. Invitation
16. Letter
17. Completed forms (insurance forms, proxy vote, etc.)
18. Other contents *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

C. ADDRESSEE TYPE: What type of industry did you send the package / mail piece to?

1. Friend or Relative (not to a business) **→ SKIP TO F**
2. Financial (credit card, bank, stockbroker, insurance, mortgage, etc.)
3. Merchant (all stores, publisher, mail order company, auto dealer, eBay buyer or seller, etc.)
4. Service (telephone, cable TV, Internet, medical, travel, Netflix, etc.)
5. Manufacturer (makers of automobiles, computers, etc.)
6. Government (local or federal government, including Medicare, IRS, USPS, Social Security, VA, etc.)
7. Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political (all schools, charities, political candidates, religious and social organizations, etc.)
8. Can't classify type *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

D. AD RESPONSE: Was the package / mail piece sent in response to advertising or solicitation for funds?

1. Yes
2. No **→ SKIP TO F**

E. AD MATERIAL: Was the advertising / promotional / solicitation material…

1. Received in mail (not in magazine)
2. Seen in magazine
3. Seen in newspaper
4. Seen on television
5. Heard on radio
6. Received over telephone
7. Seen on the Internet
8. Other advertising *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

F. DISTANCE: How far away did you send this package / mail piece?

Local:

1. Local

Out of town:

2. 50 miles or less
3. 51 to 150 miles
4. 151 to 300 miles
5. 301 to 600 miles
6. 601 to 1,000 miles
7. 1,001 to 1,400 miles
8. 1,401 to 1,800 miles
9. More than 1,800 miles
10. Out of the United States

G. REASON: Why did you send this package / mail piece?

1. Gift or other item sent to friend or relative
2. Returning merchandise ordered
3. Returning unsolicited merchandise
4. Sending item sold on eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site
5. Other reason *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

More questions on back of page →

Packages & Expedited Materials Sent *cont.* Green

H. SPECIAL SVCS: Did you send this package / mail piece with any of the following special services? *(OK to choose more than one)*

1. Return Receipt Requested
2. Delivery Confirmation
3. Signature Confirmation
4. Insured
5. COD
6. Stamped "Special Handling"
7. Certificate of Mailing
8. Restricted Delivery
9. No special services
10. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

I. CLASS: Package / Mail Classification *(OK to choose more than one)*

USPS Ground Packages:

1. First-Class (Package or Parcel) (up to 13 oz.)
2. Standard Post
3. Bound Printed Matter or BPM
4. Media Mail
5. Mail sent outside the U.S.

Non-USPS Ground Packages:

6. UPS (Ground, 3 Day Select)
7. FedEx (Ground, Express Saver, SmartPost)

Expedited Mail and Packages:

8. Express Mail/Priority Mail Express (sent by USPS)
9. Priority Mail (sent by USPS)
10. UPS Next Day Air
11. UPS 2nd Day Air
12. FedEx Overnight
13. FedEx 2Day

Other:

14. Other classification *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

Question Sheet

Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals Received



Periodicals cannot have First-Class, Presorted Standard, or Nonprofit postage markings.

Record only if delivered by the U.S. Postal Service.

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. TYPE: This periodical is...

1. Daily newspaper
2. Weekly newspaper
3. Other newspaper
4. Weekly magazine
5. Monthly magazine
6. Other magazine
7. Newsletter
8. Other periodical *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 16)*

B. SENDER TYPE: Was the periodical from...

1. Union
2. Religious organization
3. Veterans' organization
4. Charitable organization
5. Educational organization
6. Professional organization – someone in household is member
7. Any other organization
8. Any other publisher

C. SUBSCRIPTION: Type of subscription?

1. Paid - ordered by household member
2. Free - ordered by household member
3. Free - not ordered by household member
4. Free - came with membership
5. Gift subscription from a friend or relative
6. Other subscription *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 16)*

D. ARRIVAL TIME: This periodical...

1. Arrived earlier than expected
2. Arrived on day expected
3. Arrived later than expected
4. Was not expected to arrive on any special day

E. DELIVERY: This periodical...

1. Could arrive later and not cause difficulty/inconvenience
2. Comes on the proper day and shouldn't come any later
3. Doesn't have a regular delivery day
4. Arrives so late that it causes difficulty/inconvenience
5. Delivery date is not important
6. Other delivery need *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 16)*

Question Sheet

Unaddressed Mail Received

Unaddressed mail has no postage markings and no address information.

Packets of advertisements that are folded together are considered a single mail piece.

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. CONTENTS: Did the mail piece contain...

1. Coupons from a single organization
2. Coupons from multiple organizations → **SKIP TO D**
3. Advertising from a single organization
4. Advertising from multiple organizations → **SKIP TO D**
5. Both coupons and advertising from a single organization
6. Both coupons and advertising from multiple organizations → **SKIP TO D**
7. Political materials
8. Product samples (with or without coupons)

B. SENDER TYPE: What type of industry did the mail piece come from?

Financial (including all types of credit cards):

1. Credit Card (from any bank, store, or company)
2. Bank / Savings & loan / Credit union / Loan company
3. Insurance company (medical, dental, life, auto, etc.)
4. Real estate / Mortgage
5. Investments (stock, mutual fund, retirement plan, etc.)
6. Other financial *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 18)*

Merchants:

7. Supermarket / Grocery store
8. Department / Discount store
9. Other store (electronics, shoes, clothes, hardware, etc.)
10. Mail order company
11. Restaurant (incl. fast food, pizza delivery, etc.)
12. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
13. Auto dealership (not manufacturer or service department)
14. Individual seller (on eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site)
15. Other merchants *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 18)*

Services:

16. Telephone / Cell / Cable / Satellite / Internet
17. Electric / Gas / Water / Utility company
18. Medical (doctor, dentist, hospital, not insurance company)
19. Other professional (lawyer, accountant, etc.)

Services continued:

20. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental company (Netflix, etc.)
21. Craftsman (plumber, carpenter, electrician, etc.)
22. Travel / Entertainment service (theater, hotel, airline, etc.)
23. Auto maintenance (oil change, mechanic, etc.)
24. Roadside assistance (AAA, etc.)
25. Other services *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 18)*

Manufacturers:

26. All manufacturers (makers of automobiles, computers, etc.)

Government:

27. Federal (Social Security, VA, IRS, Medicare, etc.)
28. State and Local (not a utility company)

Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political:

29. Educational (public & private schools, universities, etc.)
30. Political (campaign, political action committee, political party, etc.)
31. Union or professional organization
32. Church / Religious Organization
33. Veterans (VFW, American Legion, DAV, etc.)
34. Charity
35. AARP (for AARP insurance plans, record code 3)
36. Other nonprofit, etc. *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 18)*

C. FAMILIARITY: Was this mail piece from an organization someone in household...

1. Does or has done business with
2. Knows, but no one does business with
3. Organization no one in household knows

D. READING: Was the mail piece... ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Read by a household member
2. Read by more than one household member
3. Looked at but not read by any household member
4. Discarded without being read
5. Set aside for reading later

E. REACTION: Would this mail piece be described as...

1. Useful information we like to receive
2. Interesting or enjoyable, but not useful
3. Neither interesting, enjoyable, nor useful
4. Objectionable or offensive

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Answer Booklet

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

4a

Answer Booklet for:

MONDAY

Use with the Question Booklet

Please send us your mail pieces with your completed Answer Booklets.
(keep the contents of the mail piece if it's something you need)

Thanks for your Help!

222891

Summary Page

Please print clearly as in the example below:

1 OR 20

Use a pen in black or blue ink
DO NOT USE PENCIL

Did not Receive or Send any Mail/Packages Today: → ☐

(If no mail received or sent, mark the box above with an "X." You are done for today.)

Mail RECEIVED Monday: ☐ Total # Received

Record the total number of mail received above and then record for each mail type below.

1. **First-Class:** ☐ **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 3 (PURPLE)*
2. **Presorted Standard:** ☐ **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 7 (BLUE)*
3. **Nonprofit Organization:** ☐ **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 9 (GRAY)*
4. **Packages & Expedited:** ☐ **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 11 (GREEN)*
5. **Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals:** ☐ **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 15 (YELLOW)*
6. **Unaddressed Mail:** ☐ **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 17 (PINK)*

Mail SENT Monday: ☐ Total # Sent

Envelopes (First-Class): ☐ **Total # Sent**

Postcards (First-Class): ☐ **Total # Sent**

} *GO TO PAGE 5 (PURPLE)*

Packages & Expedited: ☐ **Total # Sent** → *GO TO PAGE 13 (GREEN)*

- Total number of **Bill Payments** made today (include by Mail, Online, Automatic Deduction, etc.) : ☐
- Total number of **Bills Received** today (include bills received by Mail and Online) : ☐
- Total number of **Statements Received** today (include statements received by Mail and Online) : ☐

Note: Credit Card Statements received should be counted under bills only

Answer Sheet Example

Please print clearly as in the example: 1 OR 20

Use a pen in black or blue ink
DO NOT USE PENCIL

As an example, let's say you received four First-Class mail pieces on Monday. Mail Piece #1 is a First-Class postcard from a mail order company, and Mail Piece #2 is a personal letter.

1. Open the **Question Booklet** to purple page 3, **First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received**.
2. For question A, your number code is either: 1 (envelope), 2 (postcard), 3 (flyer or catalog), or 4 (envelope larger than letter size) as shown on the question sheet.
3. Write a "2" for a postcard in the first column under Mail Piece #1 (see below).
4. Finish answering the remaining questions (B-J) about the postcard.
5. Answer the same questions about Mail Piece #2, the letter from a friend, on the same page in the column under Mail Piece #2, then continue to record Mail Pieces #3 and #4.

Mail Piece #1
Postcard

Mail Piece #2
Personal Letter

Answer Sheet **Purple**

First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Match to question on the First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received "Question Sheet."

See the "Question Sheet" for the list of codes for each question.

For questions where it is "OK to choose more than one," you can record up to four codes.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. FORM	2	1	2	1	1							
B. ADDRESSEE	1	2	1	3	3							
C. RETURN ENVELOPE	3	3	3	2	3							
D. SENDER TYPE	10	32	16	1	27							
E. PURPOSE	9	4	9	7	6							
F. ADVERTISING				1	2							
G. READING	2		1	3								
H. REACTION	3		1	1								
I. RESPONSE	2		1	3								
J. CLASS OK to choose up to 4 codes. *(See example on pg. 2)*	1 4	3	2 5	1 4	1 9 4							

Monday 877714 **Page 3**

First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns. There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. FORM												
B. ADDRESSEE												
C. RETURN ENVELOPE												
D. SENDER TYPE												
E. PURPOSE												
F. ADVERTISING												
G. READING												
H. REACTION												
I. RESPONSE												
J. CLASS **OK to choose up to 4 codes.** *(See example on pg. 2)*												

First-Class /Presorted First-Class Mail Received

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

First-Class Mail Sent

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. FORM												
B. ADDRESSEE TYPE												
C. PURPOSE												
D. AD RESPONSE												
E. AD MATERIAL												
F. RETURN ENVELOPE												
G. SPECIAL SVCS **OK to choose up to 2 codes.**												
H. PO BOX												
I. POSTAGE TYPE												

First-Class Mail Sent

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Presorted Standard Mail Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. ADDRESSEE												
B. FORM												
C. MULTIPLE												
D. SENDER TYPE												
E. FAMILIARITY												
F. RETURN ENVELOPE												
G. READING												
H. REACTION												
I. COUPONS												
J. PURPOSE												
K. RESPONSE												
L. CLASS **OK to choose up to 4 codes.** *(See example on pg. 2)*												

Presorted Standard Mail Received

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Nonprofit Organization Mail Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. ADDRESSEE												
B. FORM												
C. MULTIPLE												
D. SENDER TYPE												
E. FAMILIARITY												
F. RETURN ENVELOPE												
G. READING												
H. REACTION												
I. COUPONS												
J. PURPOSE												
K. RESPONSE												
L. CLASS **OK to choose up to 4 codes.** ***(See example on pg. 2)***												

Nonprofit Organization Mail Received

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Packages & Expedited Materials Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns. There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. FORM												
B. ADDRESSEE												
C. CONTENTS **OK to choose up to 4 codes.** ***(See example on pg. 2)***												
D. SENDER TYPE												
E. FROM												
F. REASON ORDERED **OK to choose up to 4 codes.** ***(See example on pg. 2)***												
G. RETURN ENVELOPE												
H. ADVERTISING												
I. READING												
J. REACTION												
K. RESPONSE												
L. SPECIAL SVCS **OK to choose up to 2 codes.**												
M. CLASS **OK to choose up to 4 codes.** ***(See example on pg. 2)***												

Packages & Expedited Materials Received

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Packages & Expedited Materials Sent

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

	Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A.	FORM												
B.	CONTENTS **OK to choose up to 4 codes.** ***(See example on pg. 2)***												
C.	ADDRESSEETYPE												
D.	AD RESPONSE												
E.	AD MATERIAL												
F.	DISTANCE												
G.	REASON												
H.	SPECIAL SVCS **OK to choose up to 2 codes.**												
I.	CLASS **OK to choose up to 4 codes.** ***(See example on pg. 2)***												

Packages & Expedited Materials Sent

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. TYPE												
B. SENDER TYPE												
C. SUBSCRIPTION												
D. ARRIVAL TIME												
E. DELIVERY												

Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals Received

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Unaddressed Mail Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. CONTENTS												
B. SENDER TYPE												
C. FAMILIARITY												
D. READING												
E. REACTION												

Unaddressed Mail Received

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Daily Envelope

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

5a

MONDAY

Insert your Mail Pieces and completed Answer Booklet for Monday in this envelope.
At the end of your recording week, please send all your Daily envelopes *(with the completed Answer Booklets and Mail Pieces in each)*, in the postage-paid Priority Mail envelope provided.
Thanks for your Help!

Diaryenv_eng_12Q1_new.indd 1 10/4/2011 2:20:50 PM

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Gift Selection Form

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE.

Gift Selection Form

6

In appreciation for your participation, choose ONE of the following gifts*:

- ○ Forty dollars
- ○ 100 First-Class stamps

* Please allow 10-12 weeks for processing

Make any changes to your name and address below (please print clearly):

_____
Name

_____ _____
Street number Street name (include apt. or unit #)

_____
City, State, and Zip

(_____) _____ - _____
Telephone number

Mail this form back with your Mail Pieces and completed Answer Booklets!

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE.

Gift Selection Form

6

In appreciation for your participation, choose ONE of the following gifts*:

- ○ Forty dollars
- ○ 100 First-Class stamps

* Please allow 10-12 weeks for processing

Make any changes to your name and address below (please print clearly):

_____
Name

_____ _____
Street number Street name (include apt. or unit #)

_____
City, State, and Zip

(_____) _____ - _____
Telephone number

Mail this form back with your Mail Pieces and completed Answer Booklets!

Appendix C2: Diary Package – "I'm Done…" Card

I'm done, what do I send back? 7

1. Completed **Answer Booklets** & **Mail Pieces** for each day in the corresponding Daily envelope.



Mail Pieces



Answer Booklets



Daily Envelopes

2. **Gift Selection Form** with your choice of gift selected.



3. Place Daily envelopes and Gift Form in the **postage-paid Priority Mail envelope.** Drop in any public U.S. Postal Service mail box or at your local post office.



I'm done, what do I send back? 7

1. Completed **Answer Booklets** & **Mail Pieces** for each day in the corresponding Daily envelope.



Mail Pieces



Answer Booklets



Daily Envelopes

2. **Gift Selection Form** with your choice of gift selected.



3. Place Daily envelopes and Gift Form in the **postage-paid Priority Mail envelope.** Drop in any public U.S. Postal Service mail box or at your local post office.

